



GOVERNMENT OF INDIA
MINISTRY OF SKILL DEVELOPMENT & ENTREPRENEURSHIP
Skill India Mission | National Council for Innovation & Entrepreneurship



NATIONAL COUNCIL FOR
INNOVATION AND
ENTREPRENEURSHIP
INDIA
EMPOWERING IDEAS.



APEX COMPENDIUM | 281 PAGES MASTER COMPENDIUM

REF: NCIE/DOC/2026/MPC-15

NATIONAL COUNCIL FOR INNOVATION & ENTREPRENEURSHIP (NCIE) INDIA

NCIE Master Policy Compendium

Comprehensive Apex Compendium & Statutory Policy Register

Comprehensive 281-page master compendium integrating all operational frameworks, governance charters, statutory disclosures, institutional guidelines, and national development instruments.

GOVERNMENT OF INDIA MINISTERIAL COORDINATION & ALIGNMENT

MSDE

Skill Development &
Entrepreneurship

MSME

Micro, Small &
Medium Enterprises

MeitY

Electronics &
Information Technology

MCA

Ministry of
Corporate Affairs

Document ID: NCIE/DOC/2026/MPC-15 | Edition: 2026 Master Edition | National Vision: Viksit Bharat @2047 Framework

SUPPORTING NATIONAL INITIATIVES & STRATEGIC ALLIANCES



NCIE INSTITUTIONAL PROFILE

National Council for Innovation & Entrepreneurship (NCIE)

The **National Council for Innovation & Entrepreneurship (NCIE)** is an institutional initiative focused on strengthening **innovation, entrepreneurship, technology, youth development, leadership, skill development and institutional capacity building.**

NCIE seeks to establish structured platforms through which **students, young innovators, aspiring entrepreneurs, educational institutions, industry stakeholders and ecosystem partners** can participate in innovation and entrepreneurship-oriented programmes.

Its programme framework is designed to support the progression from **learning and skill development to innovation, idea validation, mentorship, incubation, entrepreneurship and appropriate ecosystem linkages.**

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73.1 Institutional Focus

NCIE's institutional focus encompasses:

- Innovation and creativity.
- Entrepreneurship development.
- Startup ecosystem development.
- Youth leadership.
- Skill and capacity building.
- Artificial Intelligence and digital skills.
- Technology-oriented learning.
- Industry–academia engagement.
- Institutional innovation.
- Incubation and mentorship.
- Student development.
- Knowledge and awareness.
- Social and economic impact.

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73.2 Vision

To contribute to the development of a strong, inclusive and future-ready innovation and entrepreneurship ecosystem by empowering students, youth, innovators and institutions with knowledge, skills, mentorship, technology exposure and appropriate opportunities for enterprise development.

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73.3 Mission

NCIE's mission is to:

- Promote innovation and entrepreneurial thinking.
- Develop future-ready skills among youth.
- Strengthen institutional innovation ecosystems.
- Facilitate student and youth entrepreneurship.
- Encourage technology-driven problem-solving.
- Connect educational institutions with relevant ecosystem stakeholders.
- Promote mentorship, incubation and industry engagement.
- Facilitate appropriate funding and investment ecosystem linkages.
- Support institutional capacity building.
- Contribute to a culture of innovation and enterprise development.

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73.4 Institutional Objectives

The principal objectives of NCIE include:

1. Promoting innovation and entrepreneurship among students and youth.
2. Strengthening innovation and entrepreneurship capabilities of educational institutions.
3. Supporting skill development and future-ready competencies.
4. Encouraging technology and AI-oriented learning.
5. Facilitating startup idea development and validation.
6. Promoting mentorship and incubation linkages.
7. Strengthening industry–academia interaction.
8. Facilitating appropriate institutional development initiatives.

9. Supporting innovation challenges, hackathons and competitions.
10. Creating opportunities for leadership and professional development.
11. Promoting knowledge-sharing and innovation awareness.
12. Developing scalable programme models for wider institutional participation.

73.5 Core Areas of Intervention

NCIE's interventions are broadly organised around:

Innovation

Design thinking, creativity, problem-solving, innovation projects and technology-oriented solutions.

Entrepreneurship

Entrepreneurship awareness, business development, idea validation and enterprise-oriented learning.

Technology

Artificial Intelligence, digital skills, emerging technologies and technology-enabled innovation.

Youth Development

Leadership, employability, professional development and youth participation.

Institutional Development

Innovation centres, incubation capabilities, entrepreneurship cells and institutional capacity building.

Startup Development

Startup orientation, validation, mentorship, incubation and appropriate ecosystem linkages.

Industry & Ecosystem Engagement

Industry interaction, mentors, incubators, accelerators, CSR organisations and other relevant stakeholders.

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73.6 Programme Portfolio

NCIE's programme portfolio may include:

- Innovation Development Programmes.
- Entrepreneurship Development Programmes.
- Leadership Development Programmes.
- AI & Digital Skills Development Programmes.
- Innovation Challenges, Hackathons & Competitions.
- Mentorship & Incubation Support.
- Faculty Development Programmes.
- Institutional Capacity-Building Initiatives.
- Student Internship and Exposure Programmes.
- Scholarship and Student Support Initiatives.
- Workshops, Seminars and Awareness Programmes.
- Research and Knowledge Initiatives.
- Industry–Academia Engagement.
- Government and Institutional Collaboration Programmes.
- CSR and Social Impact Initiatives.
- Startup Validation and Development Programmes.

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73.7 Flagship Innovation & Entrepreneurship Initiatives

NCIE's programme framework includes specialised initiatives such as:

NCIE Viksit Bharat @2047 Innovation Leadership Programmes

Course-integrated programmes focused on **innovation, technology management, Artificial Intelligence, business understanding, entrepreneurship and leadership development.**

Dr. A.P.J. Abdul Kalam Startup Validation Programme

An innovation-to-enterprise pathway supporting **idea development, prototyping, validation, mentorship, incubation and appropriate investor ecosystem connectivity.**

For selected eligible startup initiatives, the programme framework may provide for **indicative seed-support mechanisms up to ₹5 lakh**, subject to programme guidelines, selection, evaluation and availability of resources.

The programme may also facilitate appropriate engagement with the investor ecosystem, with an **indicative potential investment pipeline of up to ₹25 crore** across eligible and investor-ready opportunities. This represents potential investor connectivity and **does not constitute a guaranteed investment commitment.**

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73.8 Institutional Support Framework

NCIE may facilitate eligible colleges, universities and educational institutions in developing proposals for:

- Innovation Centres.
- Incubation Centres.
- Innovation Laboratories.
- Entrepreneurship Development Cells.
- Student innovation programmes.
- Startup development activities.
- Prototype and proof-of-concept initiatives.
- AI and digital innovation activities.
- Industry–academia programmes.
- Entrepreneurship training.

Where appropriate, NCIE may facilitate linkages with **Government Ministries and Departments, Government-supported programmes, CSR organisations, industry partners, incubators, philanthropic organisations and other eligible funding channels.**

Indicative institutional funding requirements may range from **₹5 lakh to ₹25 lakh**, depending on the project, eligibility, evaluation, funding source, availability of resources and approval of the concerned funding organisation.

Such figures represent a **funding facilitation framework and not an automatic or guaranteed Government, Ministry or CSR grant.**

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73.9 Beneficiary Groups

NCIE programmes may serve:

- School students, where applicable.
- College and university students.
- Technical and professional students.
- Young innovators.
- Aspiring entrepreneurs.
- Early-stage startup founders.
- Faculty members.
- Institutional coordinators.
- Trainers and mentors.
- Educational institutions.
- Industry and ecosystem participants.

Programme-specific eligibility shall be determined according to the respective programme framework.

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73.10 Programme Delivery Model

NCIE programmes may be delivered through:

ONLINE

Digital classes, webinars, virtual training and online mentoring.

OFFLINE

Institution-based training, workshops, seminars and practical activities.

HYBRID

Combination of online and physical learning.

INSTITUTIONAL CENTRES

Programme activities through participating colleges, universities and partner institutions.

REGIONAL / FIELD CENTRES

Regional programme coordination and outreach, where established and applicable.

SEMINARS & EVENTS

Awareness, orientation, expert interaction and ecosystem engagement.

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73.11 Institutional & Ecosystem Network

NCIE seeks to build an interconnected ecosystem involving:

STUDENTS

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INNOVATORS

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COLLEGES & UNIVERSITIES

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FACULTY & MENTORS

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INCUBATORS & ACCELERATORS

↕

INDUSTRY & CORPORATE PARTNERS

↕

CSR ORGANISATIONS

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GOVERNMENT / INSTITUTIONAL STAKEHOLDERS

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INVESTORS & FUNDING ECOSYSTEM

The nature and extent of each relationship shall be governed by applicable agreements, programme requirements and stakeholder roles.

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73.12 Institutional Governance

NCIE shall seek to maintain appropriate governance mechanisms covering:

- Institutional leadership.

- Programme management.
- Advisory and expert engagement.
- Finance and administration.
- Monitoring and evaluation.
- Compliance.
- Documentation.
- Partnerships.
- Human resources.
- Digital systems.
- Internal controls.

Roles and responsibilities shall be defined according to organisational requirements and applicable policies.

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73.13 Monitoring, Evaluation & Impact

NCIE's programmes are supported by structured mechanisms for:

- Beneficiary tracking.
- Management Information Systems.
- Attendance monitoring.
- Programme reporting.
- KPI measurement.
- Output and outcome assessment.
- Impact assessment.
- Institutional performance review.
- Social and economic impact measurement.

The objective is to move beyond participation figures and assess **measurable learning, innovation, entrepreneurship, institutional and ecosystem outcomes**.

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73.14 Transparency & Accountability

NCIE shall seek to maintain appropriate standards of:

- Transparent programme communication.
- Documented programme procedures.

- Evidence-based reporting.
- Financial controls.
- Appropriate record keeping.
- Stakeholder accountability.
- Programme monitoring.
- Responsible data management.
- Applicable legal and regulatory compliance.

Any Government, CSR, industry, investor or institutional association shall be represented based on **appropriate documentary evidence and the actual nature of the relationship**.

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73.15 Strategic Orientation – Viksit Bharat @2047

NCIE's long-term programme orientation is intended to contribute, within its organisational mandate, to broader national development priorities relating to:

- Innovation.
- Entrepreneurship.
- Youth capability.
- Technology.
- Skill development.
- Institutional strengthening.
- Employment and enterprise readiness.
- Self-reliance.
- Inclusive economic participation.

NCIE's programme framework therefore seeks to support the broader aspiration of **Viksit Bharat @2047** through education-linked innovation, entrepreneurship development, technology orientation and youth participation.

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73.16 Institutional Development Pathway

AWARENESS

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LEARNING



73.17 Institutional Profile – At a Glance

Particular	Institutional Focus
Organisation	National Council for Innovation & Entrepreneurship (NCIE)
Primary Focus	Innovation & Entrepreneurship
Key Stakeholders	Students, Youth, Innovators & Institutions
Major Areas	Innovation, Startups, Skills, Technology & Leadership
Institutional Focus	Capacity Building & Ecosystem Development
Delivery Modes	Online, Offline & Hybrid
Ecosystem	Academic, Industry, CSR, Incubation & Other Stakeholders
Startup Support	Validation, Mentorship & Ecosystem Linkages
Institutional Support	Innovation & Entrepreneurship Development

Monitoring	MIS, KPIs, Outcomes & Impact Assessment
Strategic Orientation	Innovation-led Youth & Institutional Development
Long-Term Orientation	Contribution to the broader Viksit Bharat @2047 aspiration

73.18 Institutional Positioning Statement

The National Council for Innovation & Entrepreneurship (NCIE) is positioned as an innovation and entrepreneurship-focused institutional platform working to strengthen the capabilities of students, youth, innovators and educational institutions through structured programmes in innovation, entrepreneurship, technology, skills, leadership, mentorship, incubation and ecosystem engagement. Through institutional partnerships and appropriate collaboration with relevant stakeholders, NCIE seeks to develop scalable pathways from learning and innovation to entrepreneurship, enterprise development and sustainable social and economic participation.

73.19 Institutional Disclaimer

NCIE programme descriptions, funding figures, investment pipelines, partnerships and institutional initiatives shall be understood according to their respective programme documents, agreements, eligibility conditions and applicable approvals. Indicative funding or investment amounts do not constitute guaranteed grants, sanctions or investment commitments. Government, Ministry, CSR, industry or institutional association shall not be represented as formal approval, sponsorship, endorsement or funding unless supported by appropriate documentary evidence.

NCIE Governance & Organisational Structure

NCIE GOVERNANCE & ORGANISATIONAL STRUCTURE

The **National Council for Innovation & Entrepreneurship (NCIE)** shall operate through a structured governance and organisational framework designed to support effective programme management, institutional coordination, financial discipline, compliance, monitoring, partnerships and delivery of its innovation and entrepreneurship initiatives.

The governance framework is intended to establish **clearly defined roles, responsibilities, reporting relationships and decision-making processes** across the organisation and its programme network.

NCIE's organisational structure shall be implemented in accordance with its applicable constitutional documents, internal policies, programme frameworks, agreements and applicable laws and regulations.

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74.1 Governance Objectives

The NCIE governance framework aims to:

- Establish clear institutional authority and responsibility.
- Ensure effective programme planning and implementation.
- Maintain appropriate financial and administrative controls.
- Promote transparency and accountability.
- Support effective institutional and stakeholder coordination.
- Strengthen monitoring and evaluation.
- Facilitate expert and advisory inputs.
- Maintain appropriate documentation and records.
- Ensure responsible management of programmes and resources.
- Support sustainable expansion from regional to national-level programmes.

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74.2 Governance Principles

NCIE's governance approach shall be guided by the following principles:

Accountability

Defined responsibility for decisions, programme delivery and resource utilisation.

Transparency

Appropriate documentation, reporting and communication of programme activities.

Integrity

Responsible and ethical conduct in institutional and programme operations.

Compliance

Adherence to applicable legal, regulatory, contractual and programme requirements.

Efficiency

Effective utilisation of human, financial, technological and institutional resources.

Inclusiveness

Encouragement of participation from students, youth, institutions and relevant ecosystem stakeholders.

Evidence-Based Management

Use of programme data, MIS, KPIs and evaluation findings for decision-making.

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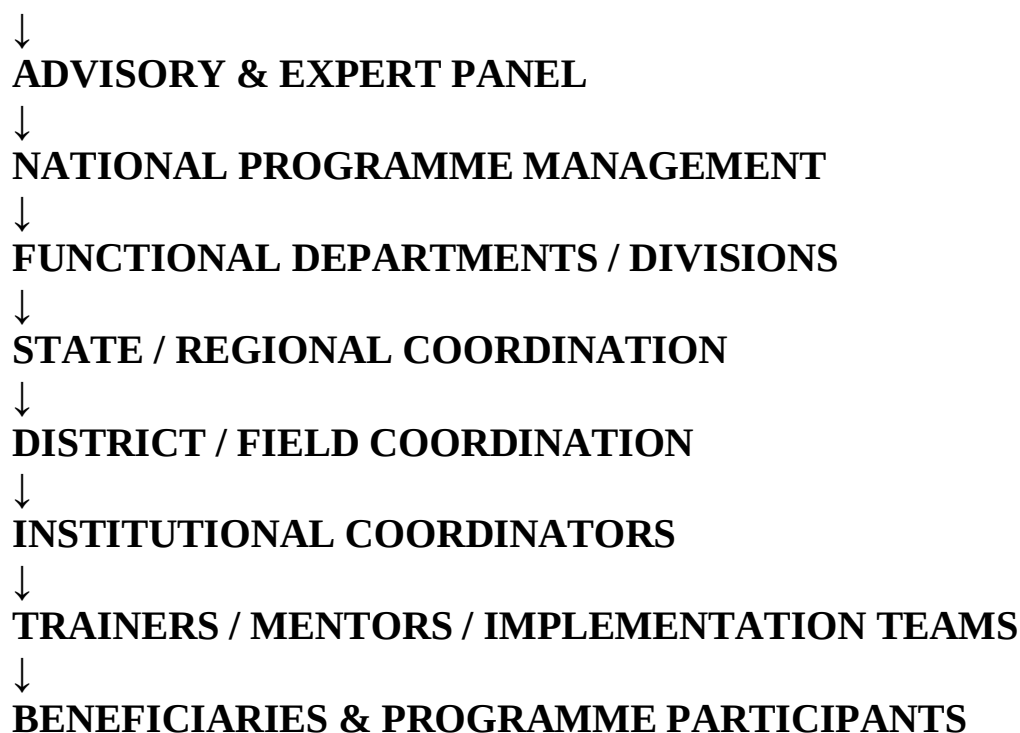
74.3 Proposed Organisational Structure

The NCIE organisational framework may be structured as follows:

GOVERNING / INSTITUTIONAL AUTHORITY

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EXECUTIVE LEADERSHIP



The exact designation and composition of each level may be determined through NCIE's approved organisational policies and programme requirements.

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74.4 Governing / Institutional Authority

The governing or institutional authority shall provide overall strategic direction and institutional oversight in accordance with the applicable constitutional and organisational framework.

Key responsibilities may include:

- Approval of major institutional policies.
- Strategic direction.
- Organisational oversight.
- Approval of major programmes and initiatives.
- Review of institutional performance.
- Oversight of financial and administrative systems.
- Review of compliance and accountability mechanisms.

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74.5 Executive Leadership

Executive leadership shall be responsible for translating institutional objectives into operational programmes and activities.

Key responsibilities may include:

- Strategic implementation.
- Programme supervision.
- Institutional coordination.
- Resource planning.
- Partnership development.
- Organisational performance.
- Management review.
- Risk management.
- Programme expansion.
- Stakeholder engagement.

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74.6 Advisory & Expert Panel

NCIE may constitute advisory and expert panels consisting of individuals with relevant experience in areas such as:

- Innovation.
- Entrepreneurship.
- Technology.
- Artificial Intelligence.
- Education.
- Research.
- Industry.
- Startups.
- Finance.
- Management.
- Skill development.
- Institutional development.

The Advisory & Expert Panel may provide **non-binding technical, academic and strategic advice** to support programme quality and institutional development.

Advisory participation shall not, by itself, constitute Government appointment, Government endorsement or statutory authority.

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74.7 National Programme Management

The National Programme Management function shall coordinate the planning and implementation of NCIE programmes at the overall organisational level.

Major responsibilities may include:

- Annual programme planning.
- Programme design.
- Implementation monitoring.
- Institutional onboarding.
- Resource planning.
- Training coordination.
- Programme reporting.
- KPI monitoring.
- Stakeholder coordination.
- Impact assessment.

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74.8 Functional Departments / Divisions

NCIE may establish specialised departments or divisions according to organisational requirements.

Indicative functions include:

1. Administration & Human Resources

Personnel, administration, office management and organisational support.

2. Finance & Accounts

Budgeting, accounting, financial reporting, internal controls and resource management.

3. Programme Management

Programme planning, implementation and performance monitoring.

4. Innovation & Entrepreneurship

Innovation initiatives, entrepreneurship programmes and startup development.

5. Training & Capacity Building

Curriculum, training delivery, trainer development and learning programmes.

6. Technology & Digital Systems

Digital platforms, MIS, registration systems and technology infrastructure.

7. Partnerships & Institutional Relations

Academic, industry, CSR, institutional and ecosystem relationships.

8. Monitoring, Evaluation & Impact

KPIs, reporting, outcome measurement and impact assessment.

9. Communications & Documentation

Official communications, programme documentation, publications and information management.

10. Compliance & Governance

Internal policies, documentation, compliance monitoring and governance support.

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74.9 State & Regional Coordination

Where NCIE establishes state or regional programme structures, these may coordinate:

- State-level programme implementation.
- Institutional onboarding.

- Regional training activities.
- Stakeholder coordination.
- Programme monitoring.
- Reporting.
- Regional events and workshops.
- Institutional support.

Regional structures shall function within the authority and responsibilities assigned by the appropriate NCIE management level.

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74.10 District / Field Coordination

District or field-level teams may support:

- Institutional outreach.
- Beneficiary mobilisation.
- Programme coordination.
- Local events.
- Training support.
- Data collection.
- Institutional reporting.
- Programme monitoring.

District-level activities shall be implemented according to approved programme procedures.

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74.11 Institutional Coordinators

Participating colleges, universities and other institutions may nominate or designate programme coordinators.

Institutional coordinators may be responsible for:

- Student mobilisation.
- Registration coordination.
- Programme communication.
- Attendance coordination.

- Institutional reporting.
- Trainer / mentor coordination.
- Programme activity support.
- Submission of required documentation.

Institutional coordinators shall not be treated as NCIE employees unless separately appointed under an applicable employment or engagement arrangement.

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74.12 Trainers & Mentors

Trainers and mentors may support programme delivery through:

- Training sessions.
- Workshops.
- Expert sessions.
- Mentorship.
- Project guidance.
- Innovation support.
- Entrepreneurship guidance.
- Startup orientation.
- Participant evaluation, where assigned.

Their engagement may be governed through appropriate appointment, consultancy, volunteer, institutional or programme arrangements.

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74.13 Roles & Responsibilities Matrix

Level / Function	Primary Responsibility
Governing / Institutional Authority	Strategic oversight
Executive Leadership	Organisational leadership
Advisory & Expert Panel	Technical and strategic advice
National Programme Management	Programme planning and coordination

Functional Departments	Specialised programme and administrative functions
State / Regional Teams	Regional implementation
District / Field Teams	Local coordination
Institutional Coordinators	Institution-level programme support
Trainers / Mentors	Training and mentoring
MIS / Monitoring Teams	Data, reporting and performance tracking
Finance & Accounts	Financial management
Participants	Programme participation and completion

74.14 Decision-Making Framework

NCIE shall seek to maintain defined decision-making authority through:

POLICY / STRATEGIC DECISION



EXECUTIVE APPROVAL



PROGRAMME IMPLEMENTATION



MONITORING



REPORTING



REVIEW



CORRECTIVE / IMPROVEMENT ACTION

Major financial, contractual, programme or institutional decisions shall be subject to applicable approval procedures.

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74.15 Programme Governance

Each major programme may have a defined programme governance structure covering:

- Programme Head / Coordinator.
- Programme management team.
- Academic / technical experts.
- Trainers and mentors.
- Institutional coordinators.
- Monitoring personnel.
- Finance / administration support.

Programme-specific responsibilities shall be documented before implementation where appropriate.

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74.16 Financial Governance

Financial governance shall include appropriate controls covering:

- Budget approval.
- Expenditure authorisation.
- Accounting.
- Documentation.
- Procurement.
- Financial reporting.
- Internal review.
- Funding-condition compliance.
- Audit / financial review where applicable.

Funds received for a specific purpose shall be utilised in accordance with the applicable funding terms and organisational procedures.

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74.17 Partnership Governance

NCIE partnerships may be governed through:

- MoUs.
- Agreements.

- Letters of collaboration.
- Project-specific arrangements.
- Institutional partnership frameworks.
- CSR agreements.
- Consultancy / service arrangements.
- Other appropriate contractual documents.

The scope, responsibilities, financial arrangements, deliverables and duration of each partnership should be clearly documented.

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74.18 Monitoring & Accountability

Governance performance may be monitored through:

- Programme KPIs.
- MIS reports.
- Periodic reviews.
- Financial reports.
- Institutional reports.
- Beneficiary feedback.
- Programme completion reports.
- Impact assessments.
- Internal reviews.

Identified gaps may result in corrective actions, capacity-building measures or programme redesign.

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74.19 Risk Management

NCIE may maintain a structured approach to identifying and managing risks relating to:

- Programme implementation.
- Finance.
- Compliance.
- Data and technology.
- Partnerships.

- Human resources.
- Reputation.
- Beneficiary protection.
- Operational continuity.

Risk mitigation measures shall be proportionate to the nature and scale of the relevant programme.

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74.20 Governance Documentation

Key governance records may include:

- Constitutional / institutional documents.
- Governance policies.
- Organisational charts.
- Appointment / engagement records.
- Board / management records where applicable.
- Programme approvals.
- MoUs and agreements.
- Financial records.
- Programme reports.
- Monitoring reports.
- Compliance records.
- Meeting minutes.
- Institutional correspondence.

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74.21 Governance & Programme Delivery Model

GOVERNANCE

Strategic direction & oversight

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MANAGEMENT

Planning & coordination



IMPLEMENTATION

Programme delivery



MONITORING

Data & performance tracking



REPORTING

Documentation & accountability



EVALUATION

Outcomes & impact



IMPROVEMENT

Continuous programme strengthening



74.22 Organisational Expansion Model

NCIE may progressively develop its programme network through:

CENTRAL / NATIONAL COORDINATION



STATE / REGIONAL STRUCTURES



DISTRICT / LOCAL COORDINATION



COLLEGES & UNIVERSITIES



STUDENT & YOUTH NETWORK



INNOVATION & ENTREPRENEURSHIP ECOSYSTEM

Expansion shall be based on **programme capacity, institutional demand, available resources, qualified personnel, partnerships and applicable organisational approvals.**

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74.23 Governance Objective

The NCIE Governance & Organisational Structure is designed to establish a clear, accountable and scalable institutional framework for strategic leadership, programme management, financial administration, technical guidance, institutional coordination, monitoring and stakeholder engagement. The framework seeks to ensure that NCIE programmes are planned and implemented with defined responsibilities, appropriate controls, systematic documentation and continuous performance review.

NCIE Vision 2047

NCIE VISION 2047

Building an Innovation-Driven, Entrepreneurial & Future-Ready India

The NCIE Vision 2047 represents the long-term institutional vision of the **National Council for Innovation & Entrepreneurship (NCIE)** to contribute, within its organisational mandate, to the development of a strong and inclusive **innovation, entrepreneurship, technology and youth development ecosystem**.

The Vision 2047 framework seeks to create structured pathways through which **students, youth, innovators, entrepreneurs, educational institutions, industry and ecosystem stakeholders** can participate in the journey from **learning and skills to innovation, entrepreneurship, enterprise development and sustainable impact**.

NCIE's Vision 2047 is positioned within the broader national aspiration of **Viksit Bharat @2047**, with emphasis on youth capability, innovation, technology, entrepreneurship, institutional strengthening and economic participation.

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75.1 Vision Statement

To contribute to the development of an innovation-driven, entrepreneurial and future-ready India by empowering youth, strengthening educational institutions, nurturing innovators and entrepreneurs, promoting technology and skills, and facilitating appropriate pathways from ideas to innovation, enterprise and sustainable impact by 2047.

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75.2 Mission for 2047

NCIE's long-term mission is to:

- Develop a strong culture of innovation and entrepreneurship.
- Empower students and youth with future-ready knowledge and skills.
- Strengthen innovation capabilities within educational institutions.
- Promote technology-oriented learning and problem-solving.
- Encourage student-led innovation and entrepreneurship.
- Facilitate startup development and appropriate ecosystem linkages.
- Strengthen mentorship, incubation and industry engagement.
- Support institutional capacity building.
- Encourage collaboration among academia, industry, CSR and relevant ecosystem stakeholders.
- Develop scalable programmes capable of reaching institutions and youth across different regions.

- Measure and improve the social and economic outcomes of its programmes.

75.3 NCIE Vision 2047 Pillars

The Vision 2047 framework is structured around **eight strategic pillars**:

1. Youth Empowerment

Developing capable, confident and future-ready youth with knowledge, skills, leadership capabilities and entrepreneurial orientation.

2. Innovation

Encouraging creativity, design thinking, scientific and technological problem-solving and development of practical solutions to real-world challenges.

3. Entrepreneurship

Creating pathways for students and aspiring entrepreneurs to understand, develop, validate and pursue enterprise opportunities.

4. Technology & AI

Promoting awareness and responsible adoption of Artificial Intelligence, digital technologies and emerging technologies.

5. Institutional Strengthening

Supporting colleges, universities and other eligible institutions in developing sustainable innovation and entrepreneurship capabilities.

6. Industry & Ecosystem Connectivity

Strengthening appropriate connections among educational institutions, industry, mentors, incubators, accelerators and other relevant ecosystem stakeholders.

7. Inclusive Development

Encouraging wider participation in innovation, entrepreneurship and skill development, including opportunities across different regions and institutional settings.

8. Sustainable Impact

Focusing on measurable learning, innovation, entrepreneurship, institutional and social-economic outcomes rather than participation alone.

75.4 Vision 2047 Development Pathway

NCIE's long-term development pathway is:

EDUCATE
 ↓
EMPOWER
 ↓
SKILL
 ↓
INNOVATE
 ↓
MENTOR
 ↓
VALIDATE
 ↓
INCUBATE
 ↓
CREATE
 ↓
CONNECT
 ↓
SCALE
 ↓
IMPACT

This pathway represents the intended progression from education and capability building towards innovation, entrepreneurship and sustainable economic participation.

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75.5 Student-to-Enterprise Vision

NCIE seeks to strengthen the pathway:

STUDENT
 ↓
LEARNER
 ↓
INNOVATOR
 ↓
PROBLEM SOLVER
 ↓
ENTREPRENEUR
 ↓
STARTUP FOUNDER
 ↓
ENTERPRISE BUILDER
 ↓
JOB CREATOR / ECONOMIC PARTICIPANT

Not every participant is expected to progress through every stage. The pathway represents a broad

ecosystem model through which participants may access relevant opportunities according to their interests, capabilities and eligibility.

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75.6 Institutional Vision 2047

NCIE envisions educational institutions progressively developing as:

LEARNING INSTITUTIONS

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SKILL DEVELOPMENT CENTRES

↓

INNOVATION CENTRES

↓

ENTREPRENEURSHIP ECOSYSTEMS

↓

INCUBATION & STARTUP SUPPORT ENVIRONMENTS

↓

INDUSTRY-ACADEMIA COLLABORATION HUBS

↓

REGIONAL INNOVATION CONTRIBUTORS

The objective is to encourage institutions to integrate innovation and entrepreneurship into their broader educational and developmental environment.

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75.7 Technology & AI Vision

By 2047, NCIE seeks to contribute to a youth ecosystem that is increasingly capable of understanding and applying:

- Artificial Intelligence.
- Digital technologies.
- Emerging technologies.
- Data-oriented tools.
- Technology-enabled entrepreneurship.
- Digital productivity.
- Responsible technology adoption.
- Technology-based problem-solving.

The focus shall be on **practical capability, responsible use and innovation-oriented application**, rather than technology awareness alone.

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75.8 Innovation-to-Startup Ecosystem

NCIE's Vision 2047 includes strengthening the pathway:

IDEA



PROBLEM IDENTIFICATION



INNOVATION



PROTOTYPE



PROOF OF CONCEPT



VALIDATION



MENTORSHIP



INCUBATION



STARTUP DEVELOPMENT



INDUSTRY / MARKET LINKAGE



INVESTMENT ECOSYSTEM



GROWTH & SCALE

The availability of funding or investment at any stage shall depend on applicable eligibility, evaluation, due diligence, availability of resources and independent decisions of the relevant funding or investment organisation.

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75.9 Dr. A.P.J. Abdul Kalam Innovation & Startup Vision

The **Dr. A.P.J. Abdul Kalam Startup Validation Programme** forms part of NCIE's broader innovation-to-enterprise orientation.

Through appropriate programme mechanisms, NCIE seeks to facilitate:

- Student innovation.
- Idea development.
- Prototype development.
- Startup validation.
- Expert mentorship.
- Incubation linkages.
- Investor readiness.
- Appropriate investment ecosystem connectivity.

The programme framework may provide **indicative seed-support mechanisms up to ₹5 lakh for selected eligible startup initiatives**, subject to applicable programme guidelines and availability of resources.

Where appropriate, validated and investor-ready ventures may also be facilitated towards potential investor engagement through an **indicative investment pipeline of up to ₹25 crore** across eligible opportunities.

These figures represent **programme-level indicative support / ecosystem facilitation frameworks** and do not constitute guaranteed funding or investment commitments.

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75.10 Institutional Innovation Funding Vision

NCIE seeks to facilitate eligible colleges and universities in developing proposals for innovation, entrepreneurship, incubation and technology-related institutional initiatives.

Potential funding pathways may include, subject to eligibility and approval:

- Government schemes and programmes.
- Relevant Ministries and Departments.
- CSR partnerships.
- Industry-supported initiatives.
- Innovation and incubation programmes.
- Institutional development support.
- Philanthropic and development-oriented funding.

Indicative institutional project requirements may fall within the **₹5 lakh–₹25 lakh** range depending on the nature and scale of the proposed intervention.

Such funding shall remain subject to **proposal evaluation, eligibility, applicable guidelines, availability of funds and approval by the relevant funding organisation.**

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75.11 National Youth Innovation Network

NCIE's long-term vision includes development of a connected ecosystem of:



↕
STARTUP ECOSYSTEM
 ↕
INVESTORS

The objective is to facilitate knowledge exchange, mentorship, innovation exposure, entrepreneurship opportunities and institutional collaboration.

—

75.12 Regional-to-National Expansion

NCIE may progressively expand its programmes through:

INSTITUTION
 ↓
LOCAL / DISTRICT
 ↓
REGIONAL
 ↓
STATE
 ↓
MULTI-STATE
 ↓
NATIONAL NETWORK

Expansion shall be based on organisational capacity, institutional demand, available resources, programme quality, qualified personnel and appropriate partnerships.

—

75.13 Digital Vision 2047

NCIE seeks to progressively develop a technology-enabled programme ecosystem supporting:

- Online registration.
- Digital learning.
- Hybrid programme delivery.
- Attendance management.
- Digital assessments.
- Certification.
- Beneficiary tracking.
- Institutional dashboards.
- Programme MIS.
- Innovation project tracking.
- Mentorship coordination.
- Monitoring and evaluation.
- Impact reporting.

Digital systems shall be developed with appropriate attention to **data security, privacy, access controls and applicable legal requirements.**

75.14 Partnerships for Vision 2047

The achievement of NCIE's long-term objectives may involve appropriate collaboration with:

- Educational institutions.
- Universities.
- Government and public-sector stakeholders.
- Industry and corporate organisations.
- CSR organisations.
- Incubators.
- Accelerators.
- Startup ecosystem organisations.
- Research and knowledge institutions.
- NGOs and community organisations.
- Mentors and experts.
- Other eligible ecosystem partners.

Each collaboration shall be governed by its actual nature, documented terms and applicable approvals.

75.15 Social & Economic Contribution

NCIE seeks to contribute to long-term outcomes including:

Social Outcomes

- Youth empowerment.
- Improved skills.
- Innovation culture.
- Leadership development.
- Institutional capacity.
- Digital capability.
- Inclusive participation.

Economic Outcomes

- Entrepreneurship readiness.
- Enterprise development.
- Startup creation and progression.
- Employment readiness.
- Industry engagement.
- Innovation-led economic participation.
- Institutional resource mobilisation.

Impact shall be measured using appropriate indicators and available evidence.

75.16 Vision 2047 Impact Framework

INPUTS

Resources, people, knowledge and partnerships



ACTIVITIES

Training, innovation, mentorship and institutional programmes



OUTPUTS

Participants trained, projects developed and institutions engaged



OUTCOMES

Skills, innovation, entrepreneurship and institutional capability



IMPACT

Social and economic contribution



VISION 2047

A stronger, innovation-driven and entrepreneurial ecosystem



75.17 Long-Term Strategic Priorities

NCIE may progressively focus on the following priorities towards 2047:

1. Expanding access to innovation and entrepreneurship programmes.
2. Strengthening institutional innovation ecosystems.
3. Increasing technology and AI capabilities.
4. Developing student and youth innovation networks.
5. Strengthening mentorship and incubation pathways.
6. Encouraging student entrepreneurship.
7. Facilitating industry–academia engagement.
8. Developing regional innovation capacity.
9. Strengthening evidence-based monitoring and impact assessment.
10. Building sustainable institutional and ecosystem partnerships.



75.18 Vision 2047 Roadmap

2026–2030 | FOUNDATION

- Programme development.
- Institutional onboarding.
- Curriculum and training systems.
- Digital platform development.
- Mentor and trainer networks.
- Initial innovation and entrepreneurship ecosystem.

2030–2035 | EXPANSION

- Wider institutional participation.
- Regional programme expansion.
- Stronger industry and incubation linkages.
- Increased innovation and startup activities.

2035–2040 | CONSOLIDATION

- Mature institutional ecosystems.
- Stronger innovation networks.
- Expanded technology and AI programmes.
- Increased entrepreneurship and enterprise development.

2040–2047 | NATIONAL IMPACT

- Large-scale innovation ecosystem participation.
- Strong institutional innovation capabilities.
- Mature student entrepreneurship pathways.
- Greater industry and ecosystem connectivity.
- Sustainable social and economic outcomes.

These phases represent a **strategic planning framework** and may be revised according to organisational capacity, programme performance, resources and external conditions.

—

75.19 Vision 2047 Success Indicators

Progress towards the NCIE Vision 2047 may be assessed through indicators such as:

- Institutions participating.
- Students and youth reached.
- Participants completing programmes.
- Skills developed.
- Faculty trained.
- Innovation projects developed.
- Prototypes created.
- Startups supported.
- Mentorship engagements.
- Incubation linkages.
- Industry engagements.
- Institutional innovation initiatives.

- Entrepreneurship activities.
- Employment / enterprise-related outcomes, where verifiable.
- Social and economic impact indicators.

75.20 Vision 2047 Commitment

NCIE seeks to build a long-term ecosystem in which education, skills, innovation, technology, entrepreneurship, mentorship, institutions, industry and investment ecosystems are progressively connected to create meaningful opportunities for India's youth and innovation community.

Through its programmes and institutional initiatives, NCIE aims to contribute within its organisational mandate to the broader aspiration of Viksit Bharat @2047 by strengthening youth capabilities, encouraging innovation, supporting entrepreneurship, developing institutional capacity and facilitating appropriate pathways towards sustainable social and economic participation.

75.21 Vision Statement – Short Form

“Empowering Youth. Enabling Innovation. Building Entrepreneurs. Strengthening Institutions. Contributing to Viksit Bharat @2047.”

NCIE Viksit Bharat @2047 Alignment Framework

NCIE VIKSIT BHARAT @2047 ALIGNMENT FRAMEWORK

Contributing to a Developed, Innovative, Entrepreneurial & Future-Ready India

The **National Council for Innovation & Entrepreneurship (NCIE) Viksit Bharat @2047 Alignment Framework** provides a structured framework for aligning NCIE's programmes, institutional initiatives and ecosystem activities with the broader national aspiration of **Viksit Bharat @2047**.

The framework focuses on strengthening **youth capabilities, education, skills, innovation, entrepreneurship, technology, leadership, institutional development and ecosystem collaboration**.

NCIE seeks to translate these broad development priorities into practical programmes through educational institutions, youth networks, innovation initiatives, entrepreneurship programmes, mentorship, technology-oriented learning and appropriate institutional and ecosystem partnerships.

—

1. Alignment Vision

To contribute, within NCIE's organisational mandate, to the development of a skilled, innovative, entrepreneurial, technology-enabled and future-ready India by empowering youth, strengthening educational institutions and facilitating pathways from learning and innovation to entrepreneurship, enterprise development and sustainable impact towards 2047.

—

2. NCIE–Viksit Bharat @2047 Alignment Pillars

Pillar 1 – Youth Empowerment

NCIE programmes seek to empower students and young people through:

- Skills and capacity building
- Leadership development
- Entrepreneurship orientation
- Innovation activities
- Professional development
- Practical learning
- Mentorship
- Career and enterprise readiness

Intended Contribution: Developing capable, confident and future-ready youth.

—

Pillar 2 – Education & Skill Development

NCIE seeks to complement formal education through programmes covering:

- Technical skills
- Digital skills
- Artificial Intelligence
- Emerging technologies
- Communication skills
- Professional skills
- Entrepreneurship
- Leadership
- Industry-oriented learning

Intended Contribution: Strengthening human capital and future-ready capabilities.

—

Pillar 3 – Innovation & Problem Solving

NCIE promotes an innovation-oriented culture through:

- Design thinking
- Innovation challenges
- Hackathons
- Student projects

- Problem-solving activities
- Prototype development
- Proof-of-concept development
- Innovation mentorship

Intended Contribution: Encouraging youth to develop practical solutions to real-world challenges.

—

Pillar 4 – Entrepreneurship & Startup Development

NCIE's entrepreneurship framework includes:

- Entrepreneurship awareness
- Business idea development
- Business model development
- Idea validation
- Startup orientation
- Mentorship
- Incubation linkages
- Investor-readiness
- Industry and ecosystem connectivity

Intended Contribution: Strengthening entrepreneurial capability and enterprise development.

—

Pillar 5 – Technology, AI & Digital Transformation

NCIE promotes awareness and capability development in:

- Artificial Intelligence
- Digital technologies
- Emerging technologies
- Digital productivity
- Technology-enabled entrepreneurship
- AI-enabled innovation
- Responsible technology adoption
- Digital learning

Intended Contribution: Preparing youth and institutions for a technology-driven future.

Pillar 6 – Institutional Innovation & Capacity Building

NCIE seeks to support eligible colleges, universities and educational institutions in strengthening:

- Innovation ecosystems
- Entrepreneurship cells
- Innovation centres
- Incubation capabilities
- Faculty development
- Student innovation programmes
- Institutional training
- Industry interaction

Intended Contribution: Developing stronger institutional environments for innovation and entrepreneurship.

Pillar 7 – Industry–Academia & Ecosystem Connectivity

NCIE seeks to facilitate appropriate engagement among:

STUDENTS



COLLEGES & UNIVERSITIES



FACULTY & MENTORS



INDUSTRY



INCUBATORS & ACCELERATORS



CSR ORGANISATIONS



STARTUP ECOSYSTEM



INVESTORS

Intended Contribution: Creating stronger pathways between education, innovation, industry and enterprise.

–

Pillar 8 – Employment & Enterprise Readiness

NCIE programmes may contribute to:

- Employability skills
- Digital capability
- Professional skills
- Industry exposure
- Entrepreneurship capability
- Startup readiness
- Practical project experience
- Enterprise development

Intended Contribution: Improving readiness for employment, entrepreneurship and economic participation.

–

Pillar 9 – Inclusive & Regional Development

NCIE may expand programme access through:

- Institutional networks
- District-level outreach
- Regional centres
- Online programmes
- Offline programmes
- Hybrid programmes
- Rural and semi-urban institutional participation
- Regional innovation activities

Intended Contribution: Expanding opportunities beyond limited geographic or institutional clusters.

–

Pillar 10 – Sustainable Impact

NCIE seeks to measure programme effectiveness through:

- Beneficiary tracking
- Skill assessments

- Innovation outcomes
- Entrepreneurship outcomes
- Institutional development
- Startup progression
- Industry engagement
- Social impact
- Economic impact

Intended Contribution: Moving from activity-based implementation towards measurable outcomes and impact.

3. NCIE Programme Alignment Matrix

NCIE Programme Area	Viksit Bharat @2047 Contribution Area
Innovation Development	Creativity, problem-solving and innovation
Entrepreneurship Development	Entrepreneurial capability and enterprise readiness
Leadership Development	Youth leadership and responsible participation
AI & Digital Skills	Technology and digital capability
Startup Validation	Innovation-to-enterprise pathway
Mentorship & Incubation	Capability and ecosystem development
Internships	Practical and industry exposure
Faculty Development	Institutional capacity building
Innovation Challenges & Hackathons	Youth-led solution development
Scholarships & Student Support	Student participation and opportunity
Workshops & Seminars	Awareness and knowledge development
Industry Partnerships	Academia–industry connectivity
CSR Programmes	Social development and opportunity

Research & Knowledge
Initiatives

creation

Knowledge development and
dissemination

4. NCIE Viksit Bharat @2047 Innovation Leadership Programmes

The NCIE Viksit Bharat @2047 Innovation Leadership Programmes form part of NCIE's youth, technology, innovation and entrepreneurship framework.

The programmes may provide specialised learning pathways in areas such as:

Innovation & Technology Management

- Innovation processes
- Technology management
- Problem solving
- Emerging technologies
- Innovation strategy
- Technology applications

AI, Business & Startup Innovation

- Artificial Intelligence
- AI applications
- Business innovation
- Entrepreneurial thinking
- Startup innovation
- Technology-enabled enterprise development

The programmes seek to connect **academic learning, technology, innovation, business understanding and leadership development.**

5. Dr. A.P.J. Abdul Kalam Startup Validation Programme

The **Dr. A.P.J. Abdul Kalam Startup Validation Programme** supports the broader NCIE innovation-to-enterprise pathway:

IDEA



INNOVATION



PROTOTYPE



VALIDATION



MENTORSHIP



INCUBATION



INVESTOR READINESS



ECOSYSTEM LINKAGE



STARTUP DEVELOPMENT

For selected eligible initiatives, the programme framework may provide **indicative startup support up to ₹5 lakh**, subject to programme guidelines, selection, evaluation and availability of resources.

Suitable validated and investor-ready ventures may also be facilitated towards potential investor engagement through an **indicative investment pipeline of up to ₹25 crore** across eligible startup opportunities.

These figures represent **indicative programme and ecosystem facilitation frameworks** and do not constitute guaranteed funding or investment commitments.

—

6. Institutional Innovation & Entrepreneurship Funding Facilitation

NCIE may facilitate eligible colleges, universities and educational institutions in developing proposals for:

- Innovation Centres
- Incubation Centres
- Innovation Laboratories
- Entrepreneurship Development Cells
- Student innovation programmes
- Startup development programmes
- Prototype development
- AI and digital innovation
- Entrepreneurship training
- Industry–academia initiatives

Potential funding channels may include, subject to eligibility and approval:

- Government Ministries and Departments
- Government-supported programmes
- CSR organisations
- Corporate and industry partners
- Innovation and incubation programmes
- Philanthropic and development organisations

Indicative Institutional Funding Requirement

₹5 LAKH – ₹25 LAKH

The actual funding amount, source, sanction and utilisation shall depend upon the **institutional proposal, eligibility, evaluation, applicable guidelines, availability of funds and approval of the concerned funding organisation.**

–

7. Government, Ministry & CSR Convergence Model

NCIE may facilitate appropriate institutional linkages through:

COLLEGE / UNIVERSITY



NEED ASSESSMENT



PROJECT / FUNDING PROPOSAL



TECHNICAL & PROGRAMME FACILITATION



ELIGIBLE GOVERNMENT / CSR / INDUSTRY CHANNEL



EVALUATION & APPROVAL



FUNDING / SUPPORT



IMPLEMENTATION



MONITORING & IMPACT ASSESSMENT

This framework is intended to support institutional innovation and entrepreneurship development through appropriate and compliant funding pathways.

—

8. Digital & Technology Alignment

NCIE's digital programme infrastructure may support:

- Online registration
- Digital learning
- Hybrid learning
- Attendance management
- Assessments
- Digital certification
- Beneficiary MIS
- Institutional dashboards
- Innovation project tracking
- Programme reporting
- Impact monitoring

Digital systems shall be developed and operated with appropriate attention to **data security, privacy, access controls and applicable legal requirements**.

—

9. Youth-to-Enterprise Development Pathway

NCIE's broader alignment model can be represented as:

LEARN



SKILL



INNOVATE



LEAD



IDEATE



VALIDATE



INCUBATE



CREATE



CONNECT



SCALE



IMPACT

This pathway represents a broad institutional development model; individual participants may engage with different stages according to their interests, capabilities and eligibility.

—

10. Institutional-to-National Development Pathway

STUDENT DEVELOPMENT



INSTITUTIONAL CAPACITY



INNOVATION ECOSYSTEM



ENTREPRENEURSHIP ECOSYSTEM



STARTUP DEVELOPMENT



INDUSTRY CONNECTIVITY



ECONOMIC PARTICIPATION



SOCIAL & ECONOMIC IMPACT

—

11. Vision 2047 Implementation Roadmap

2026–2030 | FOUNDATION

- Programme development
- Institutional onboarding
- Curriculum development
- Digital infrastructure
- Trainer and mentor networks
- Initial innovation ecosystem

2030–2035 | EXPANSION

- Regional institutional expansion
- Increased student participation
- Stronger industry engagement
- Expanded innovation and entrepreneurship programmes
- Wider technology and AI programmes

2035–2040 | CONSOLIDATION

- Mature institutional ecosystems
- Stronger incubation pathways
- Expanded startup support
- Improved monitoring and impact measurement
- Stronger ecosystem partnerships

2040–2047 | IMPACT

- Large-scale youth participation
- Strong institutional innovation ecosystems
- Expanded entrepreneurship pathways
- Greater technology adoption
- Stronger industry and ecosystem connectivity
- Measurable social and economic outcomes

The roadmap is a **strategic institutional planning framework** and may be revised according to organisational capacity, resources, programme performance and changing priorities.

—

12. Monitoring & Alignment Indicators

NCIE may monitor its contribution through:

- Number of participating institutions
- Number of students and youth reached
- Number of participants trained
- Training completion rates
- Skill development outcomes
- Faculty trained
- Innovation projects developed
- Prototypes developed
- Startups supported
- Mentorship engagements
- Incubation linkages
- Industry engagements
- Institutional innovation initiatives
- Entrepreneurship activities

- Employment or enterprise outcomes where verifiable
- Social and economic impact indicators

—

13. Alignment Measurement Framework

INPUTS

People • Resources • Partnerships • Technology

↓

ACTIVITIES

Training • Innovation • Mentorship • Entrepreneurship

↓

OUTPUTS

Participants • Projects • Institutions • Programmes

↓

OUTCOMES

Skills • Innovation • Entrepreneurship • Institutional Capability

↓

IMPACT

Social • Economic • Institutional

↓

CONTRIBUTION TO VIKSIT BHARAT @2047

—

14. NCIE Institutional Contribution Statement

NCIE seeks to contribute, within its organisational mandate,

to the broader Viksit Bharat @2047 aspiration by empowering youth, strengthening skills, promoting innovation and entrepreneurship, supporting technology-oriented learning, developing institutional capabilities and facilitating appropriate connections among academia, industry and the wider innovation ecosystem.

Through its programme portfolio, NCIE aims to create structured pathways from education and capability building to innovation, entrepreneurship, enterprise development and sustainable impact, while continuously strengthening programme quality, accountability, monitoring and measurable outcomes.

15. Important Alignment & Representation Principle

The NCIE Viksit Bharat @2047 Alignment Framework represents an **institutional and programme-level alignment** with the broader national aspiration of Viksit Bharat @2047.

It should **not** be interpreted by itself as evidence of:

- Government ownership of NCIE
- Statutory Government authority
- Ministry affiliation
- Government accreditation
- Government endorsement
- Government funding
- Official Government implementation status

Any specific Government relationship, funding arrangement, implementation responsibility or official recognition should be represented only where supported by appropriate **official notification, approval, sanction, MoU, agreement or other verifiable documentary evidence.**

16. Strategic Alignment Outcome

**LEARN → SKILL → INNOVATE → LEAD → CREATE → CONNECT →
GROW → IMPACT**

Through this framework, NCIE seeks to contribute to the development of a **skilled, innovative, entrepreneurial, technology-enabled and future-ready youth and institutional ecosystem**, supporting the broader national aspiration of **Viksit Bharat @2047**.

NCIE Government & Policy Alignment Matrix

NCIE GOVERNMENT & POLICY ALIGNMENT MATRIX

The **NCIE Government & Policy Alignment Matrix** provides a structured mapping of NCIE's programme areas with relevant **national policies, missions, programmes and development priorities of the Government of India**.

The purpose of this matrix is to demonstrate how NCIE's organisational activities in **innovation, entrepreneurship, education, skills, technology, youth development and institutional capacity building** can contribute to broader national development priorities.

This alignment represents **programme-level and thematic alignment**. It does not, by itself, establish Government ownership, statutory authority, Ministry affiliation, Government accreditation, Government funding or official implementation status for NCIE.

77.1 Policy Alignment Matrix

S. No.	Government Policy / National Initiative	Relevant National Focus	NCIE Programme Alignment	Expected Contribution
1	Viksit Bharat @2047	Developed India, youth-led development, innovation, skills, entrepreneurship and economic participation	Innovation Leadership, Entrepreneurship, AI & Digital Skills, Startup Development, Youth Leadership	Future-ready youth and innovation ecosystem
2	National Education Policy (NEP) 2020	Holistic education, multidisciplinary learning, skills, innovation,	Student Development, Skill Programmes, Innovation,	Complementary learning and innovation capabilities

		critical thinking and entrepreneurship	Leadership, Faculty Development	
3	Startup India	Entrepreneurship , startup ecosystem, innovation and enterprise development	Startup Validation, Entrepreneurship Development, Mentorship, Incubation & Ecosystem Linkages	Greater startup awareness and entrepreneurial readiness
4	Skill India / Skill Development Priorities	Skill development, employability and future-ready capabilities	AI & Digital Skills, Professional Skills, Internships, Capacity Building	Improved technical and professional capabilities
5	Digital India	Digital empowerment, technology adoption and digital capabilities	Digital Skills, AI Programmes, Digital Learning, Digital Platform & MIS	Increased digital capability and technology awareness
6	Make in India	Manufacturing, innovation, entrepreneurship and domestic capability	Technology Innovation, Student Projects, Entrepreneurship, Industry Engagement	Technology-oriented innovation and enterprise development
7	Atmanirbhar Bharat	Self-reliance, entrepreneurship , innovation,	Startup Development, Entrepreneurship	Entrepreneurial and innovation

		skills and economic participation	p, Innovation, Skill Development	capacity
8	National Innovation Ecosystem	Research, innovation, technology and problem-solving	Innovation Challenges, Hackathons, Prototyping, Mentorship	Development of innovation capabilities
9	Entrepreneurship Development Priorities	Enterprise creation and entrepreneurial capabilities	Entrepreneurship Development, Startup Programmes, Business Skills	Stronger entrepreneurial orientation
10	Youth Development Priorities	Youth participation, leadership, skills and nation-building	Youth Leadership, Internships, Innovation, Entrepreneurship	Increased youth participation and capability
11	AI & Emerging Technology Priorities	Artificial Intelligence, emerging technologies and technology capabilities	AI & Digital Skills, AI Business & Startup Innovation	Future-ready technology capabilities
12	Research & Innovation Priorities	Research, knowledge creation and technology development	Research, Innovation Projects, Knowledge Initiatives	Research and innovation orientation
13	Industry–Academia Engagement	Practical learning, industry exposure and	Industry Partnerships, Internships, Expert Sessions,	Stronger academia–industry connectivity

		knowledge exchange	Projects	
14 CSR & Social Development Framework	Education, skills, livelihood, social development and eligible CSR activities	CSR Programmes, Institutional Development, Skill & Innovation Initiatives	Social-impact and institutional development opportunities	
15 Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs)	Inclusive development, education, skills, employment and sustainable growth	Education, Skills, Youth, Innovation, Entrepreneurship & Social Impact	Contribution to selected SDG-related outcomes	

77.2 Viksit Bharat @2047 Alignment

National Priority

Viksit Bharat @2047

NCIE Contribution Areas

- Youth empowerment
- Education and skills
- Innovation
- Entrepreneurship
- Technology
- Leadership
- Institutional development
- Industry engagement
- Digital capability
- Economic participation

Contribution Pathway

EDUCATION



SKILLS



INNOVATION



ENTREPRENEURSHIP



ENTERPRISE DEVELOPMENT



ECONOMIC PARTICIPATION



SOCIAL & ECONOMIC IMPACT

—

77.3 National Education Policy 2020 Alignment

NCIE's programmes can complement themes associated with **NEP 2020**, particularly:

- Holistic development
- Critical thinking
- Creativity
- Innovation
- Skill development
- Experiential learning
- Multidisciplinary exposure
- Entrepreneurship
- Technology-enabled learning
- Faculty development

NCIE Programme Linkages

NEP 2020 Themes



Student Development



Innovation & Creativity

↓
 Skill Development
 ↓
 Experiential Learning
 ↓
 Entrepreneurship
 ↓
 Future-Ready Capabilities

NCIE's programmes should be described as **complementary initiatives** unless a specific formal Government/educational authority arrangement exists.

—

77.4 Startup India Alignment

NCIE's startup-oriented programmes align thematically with entrepreneurship and startup ecosystem development through:

- Startup awareness
- Idea development
- Business model development
- Startup validation
- Mentorship
- Incubation linkages
- Investor readiness
- Industry engagement
- Enterprise development

Startup Development Pathway

IDEA

↓

VALIDATION

↓

PROTOTYPE

↓

MENTORSHIP

↓

INCUBATION



INVESTOR READINESS



STARTUP DEVELOPMENT



77.5 Skill Development Alignment

NCIE's skill-development portfolio focuses on:

- Digital skills
- Artificial Intelligence
- Emerging technologies
- Professional skills
- Communication
- Leadership
- Entrepreneurship
- Industry exposure
- Practical project development

Intended Contribution

Developing future-ready capabilities that complement formal education and improve preparedness for employment, entrepreneurship and technology-enabled economic participation.



77.6 Digital India Alignment

NCIE's digital initiatives may include:

- Online registration
- Digital learning
- Hybrid learning
- Digital attendance
- Online assessments
- Digital certification
- Beneficiary MIS

- Institutional dashboards
- Digital programme management
- Innovation project tracking

These initiatives support NCIE's objective of improving **digital access, technology awareness and technology-enabled programme delivery**.

—

77.7 Make in India Alignment

NCIE can contribute at the programme level through:

- Technology innovation
- Product development
- Prototyping
- Student innovation
- Entrepreneurship
- Industry engagement
- Technology-oriented projects
- Startup development

Innovation-to-Enterprise Pathway

IDEA

→ DESIGN

→ PROTOTYPE

→ VALIDATE

→ DEVELOP

→ ENTERPRISE

—

77.8 Atmanirbhar Bharat Alignment

NCIE's entrepreneurship and innovation programmes may contribute to broader self-reliance objectives through:

- Entrepreneurial capability
- Skill development
- Innovation

- Technology adoption
- Startup development
- Enterprise readiness
- Youth economic participation

The emphasis is on enabling individuals and institutions to **develop capabilities, solutions and enterprise opportunities**.

—

77.9 AI & Emerging Technology Alignment

NCIE's **AI, Business & Startup Innovation** and **Innovation & Technology Management** programmes provide a framework for:

- AI awareness
- AI applications
- Technology management
- Digital innovation
- Emerging technology awareness
- Technology entrepreneurship
- Responsible technology adoption

The objective is to develop **technology-aware and future-ready learners and innovators**.

—

77.10 Government & Institutional Programme Engagement

NCIE may seek appropriate engagement with:

- Government Ministries
- Central Government Departments
- State Government Departments
- Public institutions
- Universities
- Educational institutions
- Government-supported programmes

- Other eligible institutional stakeholders

Any programme implemented through a Government collaboration shall be governed by the **actual approval, agreement, MoU, notification, sanction or programme framework applicable to that collaboration.**

—

77.11 CSR Alignment

Where programmes fall within applicable CSR requirements, NCIE may facilitate appropriate institutional and corporate partnerships relating to areas such as:

- Education
- Skill development
- Youth development
- Innovation
- Entrepreneurship
- Digital capability
- Institutional capacity building
- Community-oriented development

CSR funding shall remain subject to **applicable CSR provisions, company policies, project eligibility, due diligence, approvals and the independent decision of the CSR contributor.**

—

77.12 SDG Alignment

NCIE's programmes may contribute to selected Sustainable Development Goal themes, particularly:

SDG	Theme	NCIE Contribution Area
SDG 4	Quality Education	Skills, training, innovation and learning
SDG 5	Gender Equality	Inclusive participation and opportunity

SDG 8	Decent Work & Economic Growth	Employability and entrepreneurship
SDG 9	Industry, Innovation & Infrastructure	Innovation, technology and startups
SDG 10	Reduced Inequalities	Wider access and regional participation
SDG 11	Sustainable Communities	Community-oriented innovation
SDG 17	Partnerships	Institutional and ecosystem collaboration

The SDG mapping represents **thematic programme alignment**, not certification or endorsement by the United Nations.

—

77.13 Policy-to-Programme Delivery Model

NCIE may translate broad policy themes into programme activities through:

NATIONAL POLICY / DEVELOPMENT PRIORITY



NCIE THEMATIC ALIGNMENT



PROGRAMME DESIGN



CURRICULUM & TRAINING



INSTITUTIONAL IMPLEMENTATION



STUDENT / YOUTH PARTICIPATION



INNOVATION / ENTREPRENEURSHIP OUTPUTS



OUTCOME MEASUREMENT



IMPACT ASSESSMENT

77.14 Policy Alignment Governance

NCIE shall seek to ensure that policy-aligned programmes are:

- Clearly documented.
- Based on defined programme objectives.
- Implemented through appropriate institutional arrangements.
- Supported by applicable agreements where required.
- Monitored through defined indicators.
- Documented through reports and records.
- Subject to appropriate financial and administrative controls.
- Represented accurately without implying Government status where none exists.

77.15 Alignment Documentation

For every programme described as aligned with a Government policy, mission or initiative, NCIE should maintain appropriate supporting documentation wherever applicable, including:

- Programme concept note
- Programme guidelines
- Curriculum
- Institutional approval
- MoU / collaboration agreement
- Government correspondence, where applicable
- Funding / sanction documentation, where applicable
- Implementation reports
- Beneficiary records
- Monitoring reports
- Outcome and impact reports

This creates a clear distinction between **policy alignment** and **formal Government collaboration**.

77.16 Government Policy Alignment Principle

NCIE's reference to Government policies, national missions and development priorities is intended to demonstrate thematic and programme-level alignment with relevant national objectives. Such references shall not be presented as evidence of Government ownership, statutory authority, Ministry affiliation, Government accreditation, Government endorsement, Government funding or official Government implementation unless supported by specific and verifiable official documentation.

—

77.17 Overall Alignment Framework

NATIONAL DEVELOPMENT PRIORITIES

Viksit Bharat @2047

Education & Skills

Innovation & Technology

Entrepreneurship & Startups

Digital Transformation

Youth Development

Institutional Strengthening

↓

NCIE PROGRAMMES

Innovation

Entrepreneurship

AI & Digital Skills

Leadership

Startup Validation

Mentorship & Incubation

Faculty Development

Industry Engagement

Student Support



OUTPUTS

Skilled Participants
Innovation Projects
Prototypes
Startup Opportunities
Institutional Capacity
Industry Connections



OUTCOMES

Improved Capabilities
Innovation Readiness
Entrepreneurial Readiness
Technology Adoption
Institutional Strengthening



CONTRIBUTION TO INDIA'S DEVELOPMENT JOURNEY TOWARDS 2047

NCIE Programme Framework

NCIE PROGRAMME FRAMEWORK

The **National Council for Innovation & Entrepreneurship (NCIE) Programme Framework** provides an integrated structure for the design, delivery, management, monitoring and continuous improvement of NCIE's programmes and institutional initiatives.

The framework is intended to create a consistent pathway through which **students, youth, innovators, aspiring entrepreneurs, educational institutions, faculty members and partner organisations** can progress from awareness and learning to **skill development, innovation, leadership, entrepreneurship, incubation and ecosystem engagement**.

NCIE programmes may be delivered through **online, offline, hybrid, institutional, regional and seminar-based formats**, depending on programme objectives, participant requirements, institutional arrangements and available resources.

—

1. Programme Framework Objectives

The NCIE Programme Framework aims to:

- Promote innovation and creative problem-solving.
- Develop technical, digital, professional and entrepreneurial skills.
- Encourage entrepreneurship and startup-oriented thinking.
- Develop youth leadership and professional capabilities.
- Strengthen innovation and entrepreneurship ecosystems within educational institutions.
- Facilitate mentorship, incubation and appropriate ecosystem linkages.
- Promote industry–academia engagement.
- Support institutional capacity building.
- Provide structured opportunities for practical learning and project development.
- Establish measurable programme outcomes and impact.

—

2. NCIE Programme Architecture

NCIE's programmes are organised into interconnected programme streams:

A. Student & Youth Development

- Student Innovation Programmes
- Internships
- Fellowships
- Leadership Development
- Scholarship & Student Support Initiatives
- Career and Employability Development

B. Innovation Development

- Innovation Programmes
- Design Thinking
- Innovation Challenges
- Hackathons
- Competitions
- Prototype Development
- Technology Innovation

C. Entrepreneurship & Startup Development

- Entrepreneurship Development Programmes
- Startup Orientation
- Startup Validation
- Business Model Development
- Startup Mentorship
- Incubation Linkages
- Investor Readiness

D. Technology & Digital Development

- AI & Digital Skills Development
- AI, Business & Startup Innovation
- Innovation & Technology Management
- Emerging Technology Programmes
- Digital Productivity

E. Institutional Development

- Faculty Development
- Entrepreneurship Development Cells
- Innovation Centres
- Incubation Support
- Institutional Capacity Building
- Institutional Innovation Programmes

F. Ecosystem & Partnership Development

- Government & Public-Sector Engagement
- Academic Partnerships
- Industry Partnerships
- CSR Partnerships
- Incubator & Accelerator Partnerships
- NGO & Community Partnerships

—

3. NCIE Programme Lifecycle

Every programme may follow a structured lifecycle:

NEED IDENTIFICATION



PROGRAMME CONCEPT DEVELOPMENT



OBJECTIVE & OUTCOME DEFINITION



CURRICULUM / PROGRAMME DESIGN



INSTITUTIONAL / PARTNER ENGAGEMENT



RESOURCE PLANNING



REGISTRATION & MOBILISATION



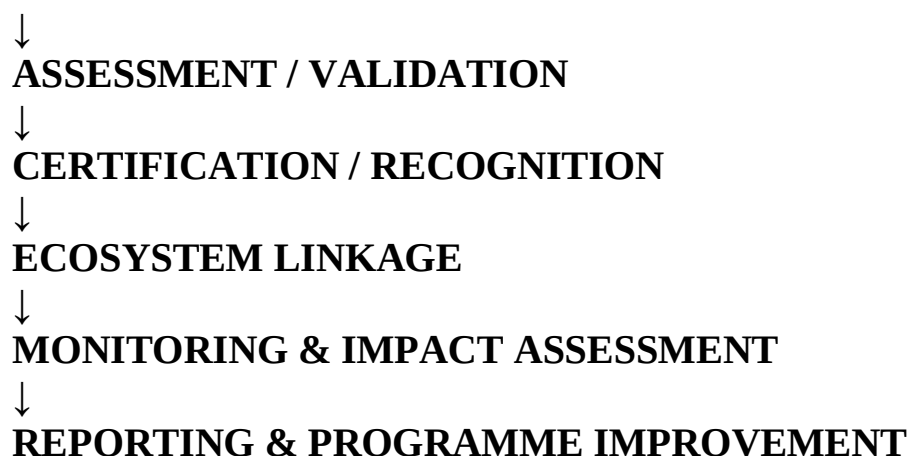
TRAINING / PROGRAMME DELIVERY



PRACTICAL ACTIVITIES



MENTORSHIP & GUIDANCE



4. Programme Development Model

NCIE programmes may be developed using the following sequence:

1. Identify

Identify the needs of the target beneficiaries and participating institutions.

2. Design

Develop programme objectives, curriculum, delivery methodology, duration and assessment framework.

3. Mobilise

Engage eligible participants and institutions through appropriate communication and outreach.

4. Deliver

Provide training, workshops, practical activities, mentoring and project-based learning.

5. Assess

Evaluate participation, learning, project development and programme outcomes.

6. Connect

Where appropriate, connect eligible participants and institutions with

mentors, industry, incubators, accelerators and other relevant ecosystem stakeholders.

7. Measure

Track outputs, outcomes and measurable impact.

8. Improve

Use monitoring and evaluation findings to strengthen future programme cycles.

—

5. Programme Delivery Formats

NCIE may use multiple delivery formats depending on programme requirements.

Online

Suitable for:

- Digital learning
- Webinars
- Online classes
- Expert sessions
- Assessments
- Digital mentorship

Offline

Suitable for:

- Classroom training
- Workshops
- Innovation activities
- Institutional programmes
- Practical sessions
- Hackathons

Hybrid

Combines:

ONLINE LEARNING + OFFLINE ACTIVITIES

Suitable for programmes requiring both digital learning and practical institutional engagement.

Seminars & Conferences

Used for:

- Awareness
- Knowledge dissemination
- Expert interaction
- Policy discussions
- Innovation showcases
- Entrepreneurship orientation

Institution-Based Programmes

Delivered through participating:

- Colleges
- Universities
- Schools
- Training institutions
- Innovation centres
- Other eligible organisations

Regional Centre Model

NCIE may establish or utilise appropriate **regional programme centres** to support:

- Local programme delivery
- Institutional outreach
- Trainer coordination
- Mentorship
- Student mobilisation
- Regional innovation activities

—

6. Training & Learning Framework

NCIE programmes may combine:

THEORY



PRACTICAL LEARNING



PROJECT WORK



MENTORSHIP



ASSESSMENT



APPLICATION

The learning approach may incorporate:

- Lectures
- Workshops
- Case studies
- Demonstrations
- Group activities
- Projects
- Presentations
- Expert interaction
- Problem-solving exercises

—

7. Innovation-to-Enterprise Pathway

For innovation and startup-oriented programmes, NCIE may follow:

PROBLEM IDENTIFICATION



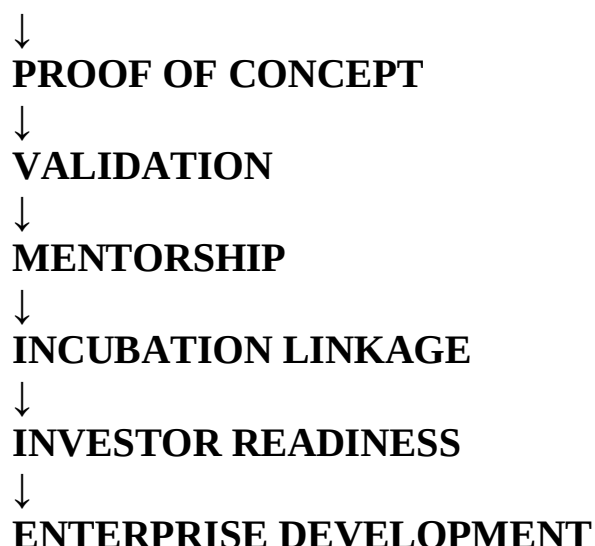
IDEA GENERATION



DESIGN & INNOVATION



PROTOTYPE



8. Dr. A.P.J. Abdul Kalam Startup Validation Programme

The **Dr. A.P.J. Abdul Kalam Startup Validation Programme** forms part of the startup and innovation stream.

It may support:

- Idea development
- Prototype development
- Startup validation
- Business model development
- Mentorship
- Incubation linkage
- Investor readiness
- Industry connectivity

For selected eligible startup initiatives, the programme framework may provide **indicative support up to ₹5 lakh**, subject to applicable programme guidelines, selection, evaluation and availability of resources.

Suitable investor-ready ventures may also be facilitated towards potential investor engagement through an **indicative investment pipeline of up to ₹25 crore** across eligible opportunities.

These figures are **indicative programme targets/facilitation**

frameworks and are not guaranteed funding or investment commitments.

—

9. Institutional Innovation & Entrepreneurship Framework

NCIE may support eligible colleges and universities in developing stronger innovation and entrepreneurship ecosystems through:

- Innovation Centres
- Incubation Centres
- Innovation Laboratories
- Entrepreneurship Development Cells
- Student innovation programmes
- Startup development activities
- AI and digital innovation initiatives
- Faculty development
- Industry–academia programmes

Potential funding pathways may include eligible **Government programmes, Ministry/Department schemes, CSR partnerships, industry support and other appropriate funding mechanisms.**

Where applicable, institutional funding requirements may be developed in the indicative range of:

₹5 LAKH – ₹25 LAKH

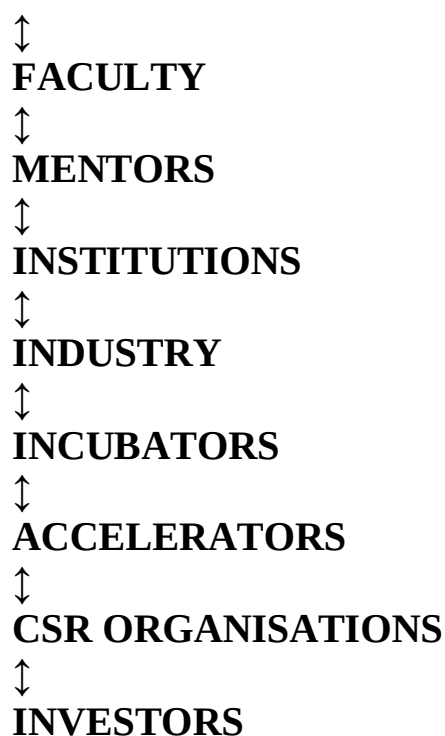
Actual funding remains subject to **eligibility, proposal evaluation, applicable guidelines, availability of funds and approval by the relevant funding organisation.**

—

10. Mentorship & Ecosystem Framework

NCIE may establish structured connections among:

STUDENTS



The purpose is to facilitate appropriate opportunities for **knowledge, mentoring, innovation, incubation, industry exposure and entrepreneurship development.**

—

11. Institutional Onboarding Framework

Participating institutions may progress through:

EXPRESSION OF INTEREST / APPLICATION



INSTITUTIONAL INFORMATION REVIEW



PROGRAMME DISCUSSION



ELIGIBILITY / REQUIREMENT ASSESSMENT



PROGRAMME PLAN



INSTITUTIONAL COORDINATOR DESIGNATION



ONBOARDING



PROGRAMME IMPLEMENTATION



REPORTING & REVIEW

Where a formal collaboration exists, the relationship should be governed by the applicable **MoU, agreement, approval or programme document**.



12. Trainer & Mentor Framework

NCIE may maintain a pool of appropriately qualified:

- Trainers
- Faculty members
- Subject-matter experts
- Industry professionals
- Entrepreneurs
- Startup mentors
- Technology experts
- Academic experts

Trainer and mentor engagement may consider:

- Relevant qualifications
- Professional experience
- Subject expertise
- Programme requirements
- Availability
- Performance and feedback



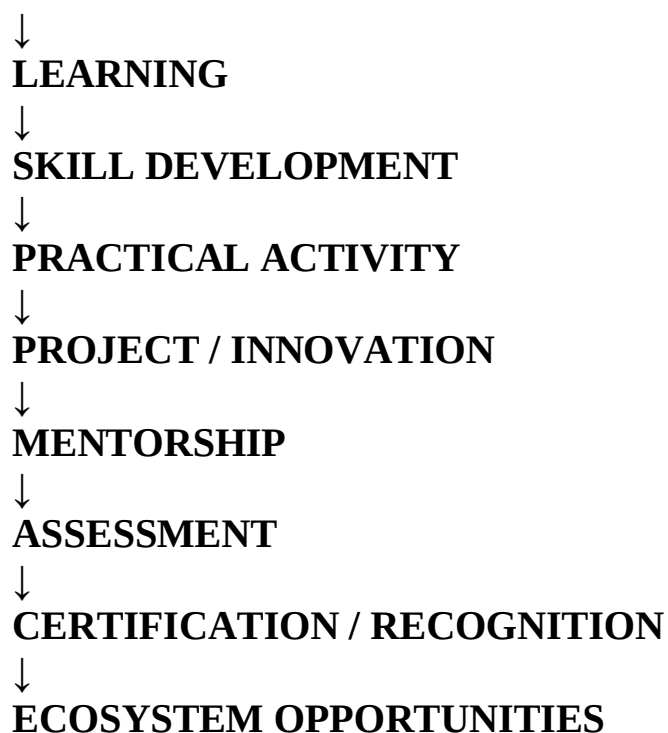
13. Participant Journey

A participant may progress through:

REGISTRATION



ORIENTATION



Participation in later stages may depend on **eligibility, performance, selection and programme-specific criteria.**

—

14. Digital Programme Infrastructure

NCIE's digital programme infrastructure may support:

- Online registration
- Participant database
- Attendance management
- Learning resources
- Assessments
- Digital certificates
- Institutional dashboards
- Beneficiary MIS
- Programme reporting
- Project tracking
- Monitoring and evaluation

Appropriate measures should be maintained for **data protection, access control, information security and privacy.**

15. Assessment & Certification Framework

Depending on the programme, assessment may include:

- Attendance
- Knowledge assessments
- Assignments
- Practical activities
- Project work
- Presentations
- Innovation projects
- Mentor evaluation
- Final assessment

Certificates or recognition may be issued according to **programme-specific eligibility and completion requirements**.

Certification should accurately describe the nature of participation and should not imply Government accreditation or recognition unless separately supported by appropriate official documentation.

16. Monitoring & Evaluation

NCIE may monitor programmes through:

Input Indicators

- Resources
- Trainers
- Mentors
- Institutions
- Programme infrastructure

Output Indicators

- Participants registered
- Participants trained
- Institutions onboarded

- Sessions conducted
- Projects completed
- Mentorship sessions delivered

Outcome Indicators

- Skills developed
- Innovation projects progressed
- Startup readiness
- Institutional capacity strengthened
- Industry engagement
- Entrepreneurship participation

Impact Indicators

- Employment or enterprise outcomes where verifiable
- Startup progression
- Institutional innovation outcomes
- Long-term beneficiary outcomes
- Social and economic contribution

—

17. Programme Governance

Programme implementation may be supported through:

NCIE GOVERNANCE

↓

PROGRAMME MANAGEMENT

↓

PROGRAMME COORDINATORS

↓

REGIONAL / INSTITUTIONAL COORDINATORS

↓

TRAINERS & MENTORS

↓

PARTICIPANTS

Roles and responsibilities should be documented for each programme.

—

18. Programme Quality Framework

NCIE should seek to maintain programme quality through:

- Standardised programme objectives
- Defined curriculum
- Trainer selection
- Mentor quality
- Participant feedback
- Assessment mechanisms
- Documentation
- Periodic review
- Outcome measurement
- Corrective action and continuous improvement

—

19. Partnership Framework

NCIE may engage with eligible:

- Educational institutions
- Government and public-sector stakeholders
- Industry
- CSR organisations
- NGOs
- Incubators
- Accelerators
- Startups
- Professional organisations
- Experts and mentors
- Other ecosystem partners

Each partnership should be represented according to the **actual nature and documentary basis of the relationship**.

—

20. Financial & Resource Framework

Programme resources may be mobilised through appropriate:

- Programme fees, where applicable
- Institutional contributions
- CSR support
- Sponsorships
- Grants, where eligible
- Government-supported funding opportunities
- Industry partnerships
- Philanthropic support
- Other lawful sources

All funding should be managed through appropriate **financial controls, budgeting, documentation, approvals, utilisation records and reporting mechanisms.**

—

21. Transparency & Compliance Principle

NCIE programmes shall be presented transparently, including clear information regarding:

- Programme purpose
- Eligibility
- Fees, if any
- Duration
- Delivery format
- Certification requirements
- Selection criteria
- Funding conditions
- Partnership status
- Government alignment
- Disclaimer regarding non-guaranteed funding or investment

Government policies and national initiatives may be referenced for **thematic alignment**, but such references should not imply Government ownership, endorsement, accreditation or funding unless supported by specific official documentation.

—

22. Overall NCIE Programme Framework

**LEARN → SKILL → INNOVATE → LEAD → VALIDATE
→ INCUBATE → CREATE → CONNECT → SCALE →
IMPACT**

The NCIE Programme Framework is designed to establish an integrated ecosystem in which **students and youth acquire knowledge and skills, develop innovative ideas, receive appropriate mentorship, explore entrepreneurship opportunities and connect with relevant institutional and ecosystem stakeholders.**

Through its programmes, NCIE seeks to strengthen **innovation, entrepreneurship, technology, leadership and institutional capabilities**, contributing within its organisational mandate to the broader national development aspiration of **Viksit Bharat @2047**.

700/-

NCIE VIKSIT BHARAT @2047 INNOVATION LEADERSHIP PROGRAMME

Programme Overview

The NCIE Viksit Bharat @2047 Innovation Leadership Programme is a structured, course-integrated programme designed to develop **innovation, technology, Artificial Intelligence, entrepreneurship, business and leadership capabilities** among students and young professionals.

The programme is intended particularly for participants from the **engineering and technology domain**, while providing a broader framework for developing future-ready innovation and entrepreneurial capabilities.

The programme connects academic learning with **practical projects, innovation activities, technology awareness, entrepreneurship and leadership development**, contributing within NCIE's organisational framework to the broader national aspiration of **Viksit Bharat @2047**.

Programme Tracks

1. Innovation & Technology Management

Focus areas include:

- Innovation management
- Technology management
- Design thinking
- Problem-solving
- Emerging technologies
- Innovation strategy
- Technology-enabled solutions
- Project-based innovation

2. AI, Business & Startup Innovation

Focus areas include:

- Artificial Intelligence awareness
- AI applications
- AI-enabled business solutions
- Digital innovation

- Entrepreneurial thinking
- Startup innovation
- Business model development
- Technology-enabled entrepreneurship

Programme Objectives

The programme aims to:

- Develop innovation and leadership capabilities.
- Build awareness of emerging technologies.
- Introduce participants to Artificial Intelligence and its applications.
- Develop entrepreneurial and business-oriented thinking.
- Encourage practical problem-solving.
- Promote innovation projects and technology-based solutions.
- Connect academic learning with practical applications.
- Develop future-ready professional capabilities.
- Encourage students to explore entrepreneurship and startup opportunities.

Programme Delivery

The programme may be delivered through:

- Online classes
- Offline institutional sessions
- Hybrid learning
- Workshops
- Seminars
- Expert sessions
- Practical activities
- Project-based learning
- Mentorship

Delivery may be organised through participating educational institutions and appropriate regional programme arrangements.

Programme Learning Pathway

LEARN



UNDERSTAND



INNOVATE**BUILD****APPLY****LEAD****Programme Components****Innovation**

Participants explore innovation methodologies, problem identification and solution development.

Technology

Participants gain exposure to technology management and emerging technology applications.

Artificial Intelligence

Participants develop foundational awareness and application-oriented understanding of AI.

Business

Participants explore business fundamentals, opportunity identification and technology-enabled business models.

Entrepreneurship

Participants are introduced to startup thinking, idea development and entrepreneurial opportunities.

Leadership

Participants develop communication, teamwork, decision-making and leadership capabilities.

Practical Learning

Where applicable, participants may undertake:

- Innovation projects
- Technology projects
- Business case studies
- AI-based activities
- Startup ideas
- Presentations
- Innovation challenges
- Team projects

Registration

One-Time Registration Fee: ₹700 per course

The ₹700 amount is presented as the **one-time registration fee for the applicable course/programme track**. The exact course structure, duration, eligibility and participation requirements should be stated in the applicable programme circular or registration notice.

Target Participants

The programme may be intended for:

- Engineering students
- Technology students
- Undergraduate students
- Young professionals
- Student innovators
- Aspiring entrepreneurs
- Innovation-oriented learners
- Participants interested in AI and emerging technologies

Expected Outcomes

Participants may develop:

- Innovation awareness
- Technology awareness
- AI literacy
- Entrepreneurial thinking
- Business understanding
- Leadership capabilities
- Problem-solving skills

- Project development experience
- Startup orientation

Viksit Bharat @2047 Contribution

The programme is designed around the development of **future-ready youth, innovation capabilities, technology awareness and entrepreneurship**, contributing within NCIE's organisational framework to the broader aspiration of **Viksit Bharat @2047**.

Contribution Pathway

EDUCATION



SKILLS



INNOVATION



ENTREPRENEURSHIP



LEADERSHIP



ECONOMIC PARTICIPATION

Programme Position

The programme should be understood according to the applicable NCIE programme documents, circulars and institutional arrangements. Reference to **Viksit Bharat @2047 or Government initiatives represents the stated alignment framework and should not independently be interpreted as Government accreditation, Government employment, statutory Government status or guaranteed Government funding unless supported by specific official documentation.**

DR. A.P.J. ABDUL KALAM STARTUP VALIDATION PROGRAMME

Programme Overview

The **Dr. A.P.J. Abdul Kalam Startup Validation Programme** is an NCIE initiative designed to support **student innovators, aspiring entrepreneurs, early-stage founders and innovation-oriented institutions** in progressing innovative ideas towards validation and startup development.

The programme provides a structured pathway covering:

IDEA → INNOVATION → PROTOTYPE → VALIDATION → MENTORSHIP → INCUBATION → INVESTOR READINESS → STARTUP DEVELOPMENT

Programme Objectives

The programme aims to:

- Encourage innovation and entrepreneurial thinking.
- Identify promising student and youth-led ideas.
- Support development of innovative solutions.
- Provide appropriate mentorship and expert guidance.
- Facilitate prototype and proof-of-concept development.
- Support market and problem validation.
- Develop entrepreneurial capabilities.
- Facilitate appropriate incubation and acceleration linkages.
- Prepare suitable ventures for investor engagement.
- Strengthen institutional innovation and entrepreneurship ecosystems.

Startup Validation Framework

STAGE 1 – IDEA IDENTIFICATION

Identification and initial documentation of innovative ideas addressing:

- Social problems
- Technology challenges
- Business opportunities
- Community needs
- Industry problems
- Emerging market opportunities

STAGE 2 – IDEA DEVELOPMENT

Participants develop:

- Problem statement
- Proposed solution
- Target users
- Value proposition
- Initial business concept

STAGE 3 – PROTOTYPING

Where appropriate, participants may develop:

- Prototype
- Minimum viable product
- Proof of concept
- Demonstration model

STAGE 4 – VALIDATION

The idea may be evaluated against:

- Problem relevance
- Innovation
- Technical feasibility
- Market potential
- User need
- Scalability
- Business viability

STAGE 5 – MENTORSHIP

Suitable participants may receive access to appropriate:

- Startup mentors
- Industry experts
- Technology experts
- Entrepreneurs
- Academic experts

STAGE 6 – INCUBATION LINKAGE

Eligible ventures may be facilitated towards suitable:

- Incubators
- Accelerators

- Innovation centres
- Startup ecosystems
- Industry networks

STAGE 7 – INVESTOR READINESS

Promising ventures may be supported in preparing:

- Business model
- Pitch presentation
- Market information
- Financial assumptions
- Product information
- Startup profile
- Investor-readiness materials

STAGE 8 – ECOSYSTEM & INVESTOR CONNECTIVITY

Suitable and investor-ready ventures may be facilitated for engagement with appropriate:

- Investors
- Incubators
- Accelerators
- Industry partners
- Startup networks
- Funding ecosystems

Indicative Startup Support

The NCIE programme framework provides for **startup seed-support mechanisms of up to ₹5,00,000 for selected eligible startup initiatives**, subject to programme guidelines, evaluation, selection, milestones and availability of resources.

Potential support areas may include:

- Idea validation
- Prototype development
- MVP development
- Proof of concept
- Product development

- Market validation
- Startup mentoring
- Business model development
- Incubation linkage

Investor Ecosystem Linkage

Suitable ventures may be facilitated towards potential investor engagement after appropriate validation and investor-readiness preparation.

Indicative Investment Pipeline

UP TO ₹25 CRORE

The ₹25 crore figure should be presented as an **indicative potential investment pipeline / ecosystem connectivity target across eligible and investor-ready opportunities**, and **not as guaranteed investment capital available to each startup**.

Any investment remains subject to:

- Investor interest
- Due diligence
- Business viability
- Market opportunity
- Technology readiness
- Financial assessment
- Applicable legal and regulatory requirements
- Investment terms
- Independent investor decision

Investor Connectivity Pathway

STARTUP IDEA



VALIDATION



PROTOTYPE / MVP



MENTORSHIP



BUSINESS DEVELOPMENT**INVESTOR READINESS****INCUBATOR / ACCELERATOR LINKAGE****INVESTOR PITCH****DUE DILIGENCE****POTENTIAL INVESTMENT****SCALE-UP****Institutional Innovation & Entrepreneurship Support**

The programme may also support eligible colleges and universities in strengthening their innovation and entrepreneurship ecosystem.

Potential areas include:

- Innovation Centres
- Incubation Centres
- Innovation Laboratories
- Entrepreneurship Development Cells
- Student startup programmes
- Prototype development
- Innovation challenges
- Hackathons
- Entrepreneurship training
- AI and digital innovation
- Faculty development
- Industry–academia initiatives

Institutional Funding Facilitation

NCIE may facilitate eligible institutions in identifying appropriate funding opportunities through applicable:

- Government Ministry / Department programmes
- Government-supported schemes

- CSR partnerships
- Industry-supported initiatives
- Innovation and incubation mechanisms
- Institutional development programmes
- Philanthropic and development organisations

Indicative Institutional Funding Requirement

₹5 LAKH – ₹25 LAKH

This represents an **indicative funding-support range for eligible institutional proposals** and is not an automatic or guaranteed Government, Ministry or CSR grant.

Actual funding depends upon:

**ELIGIBILITY → PROPOSAL → EVALUATION → FUNDING
SOURCE → APPROVAL → AVAILABILITY OF FUNDS**

Institutional Convergence Model

COLLEGE / UNIVERSITY



NEED ASSESSMENT



PROJECT PROPOSAL



TECHNICAL / PROGRAMME FACILITATION



**GOVERNMENT / CSR / INDUSTRY / OTHER ELIGIBLE FUNDING
CHANNEL**



EVALUATION



APPROVAL



FUNDING / SUPPORT



IMPLEMENTATION



MONITORING & IMPACT

Participant Categories

The programme may be relevant to:

- Student innovators
- Student entrepreneurs
- Aspiring entrepreneurs
- Early-stage founders
- Researchers
- Technology innovators
- College and university innovation teams
- Institutional innovation cells

Expected Outcomes

The programme aims to facilitate:

- Validated startup ideas
- Prototypes and proof of concepts
- Entrepreneurial capabilities
- Startup-ready teams
- Mentorship connections
- Incubation opportunities
- Investor readiness
- Industry exposure
- Institutional innovation capacity

Overall Programme Pathway

IDEA

Identify a meaningful problem or opportunity.



INNOVATE

Develop a differentiated solution.



BUILD

Develop prototype / MVP / proof of concept.



VALIDATE

Test technical, user and market assumptions.



MENTOR

Receive appropriate expert and entrepreneurial guidance.



INCUBATE

Connect with suitable incubation and acceleration ecosystems.



INVEST

Facilitate potential investor engagement for suitable ventures.



SCALE

Support appropriate enterprise development and growth.

Programme Disclaimer

The programme's references to startup support, institutional funding and investor connectivity represent **programme frameworks, facilitation mechanisms or indicative opportunities** and do not constitute a guarantee of funding, investment, Government grant, CSR grant or commercial success.

All funding and investment decisions shall remain subject to **eligibility, programme guidelines, proposal evaluation, due diligence, availability of**

resources, applicable laws and regulations, funding terms and the independent decision of the concerned Government authority, CSR organisation, institution, funding agency or investor.

Programme Objective

To create an integrated innovation-to-enterprise pathway that enables students, innovators, early-stage entrepreneurs and eligible institutions to develop, validate and strengthen innovative ideas while facilitating appropriate mentorship, incubation, funding and investor ecosystem connections.

The programme forms part of NCIE's broader **Innovation, Entrepreneurship, Startup Development and Institutional Capacity-Building Framework**, contributing within its organisational mandate to the broader aspiration of **Viksit Bharat @2047**.

NCIE Innovation & Startup Policy

NCIE INNOVATION & STARTUP POLICY

National Council for Innovation & Entrepreneurship (NCIE)

Policy Area: Innovation, Entrepreneurship & Startup Development

Applicable To: Students, Youth, Innovators, Entrepreneurs, Startups, Educational Institutions and Eligible Ecosystem Partners

Policy Status: Institutional Programme Policy

Alignment: Innovation, Entrepreneurship, Technology, Youth Development and the broader national aspiration of **Viksit Bharat @2047**

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1. POLICY PREAMBLE

The **National Council for Innovation & Entrepreneurship (NCIE)** recognises innovation and entrepreneurship as important pathways for developing future-ready skills, creating employment opportunities, strengthening institutions and encouraging technology-led solutions.

The NCIE Innovation & Startup Policy establishes an institutional framework for identifying, developing, validating, mentoring, incubating and facilitating the growth of innovative ideas and early-stage startup opportunities.

The Policy seeks to create a structured ecosystem connecting:

**STUDENTS → INNOVATORS → INSTITUTIONS → MENTORS
→ INDUSTRY → INCUBATORS → ACCELERATORS →
FUNDING ECOSYSTEM → INVESTORS → ENTERPRISE
DEVELOPMENT**

The policy is designed to complement the broader Indian innovation and startup ecosystem. Government initiatives such as Startup India provide pathways covering ideation, validation, mentorship, seed funding and investor connectivity.

—

2. POLICY VISION

To build a structured and inclusive innovation and entrepreneurship ecosystem that enables students, youth, innovators and institutions to transform ideas into validated solutions, startups and sustainable enterprises.

3. POLICY MISSION

NCIE shall seek to:

- Promote innovation and creative problem-solving.
- Encourage entrepreneurship among students and youth.
- Develop technology and business capabilities.
- Facilitate startup idea development and validation.
- Encourage prototyping and proof-of-concept development.
- Provide appropriate mentorship and expert guidance.
- Strengthen institutional innovation ecosystems.
- Facilitate incubation and acceleration linkages.
- Promote industry–academia engagement.
- Facilitate appropriate funding and investor ecosystem connections.
- Encourage responsible and sustainable entrepreneurship.

4. POLICY OBJECTIVES

The objectives of this policy are to:

1. Establish a structured innovation-to-enterprise pathway.
2. Encourage students to identify real-world problems and develop solutions.
3. Support innovators in developing ideas into structured concepts.
4. Facilitate prototype and proof-of-concept development.
5. Provide appropriate mentorship and technical guidance.
6. Encourage entrepreneurship and startup creation.
7. Strengthen innovation and entrepreneurship infrastructure in educational institutions.
8. Facilitate connections with incubators, accelerators and industry.
9. Support investor-readiness of suitable startup initiatives.
10. Facilitate access to appropriate funding opportunities, subject

to eligibility and availability.

11. Promote ethical, responsible and inclusive innovation.
12. Establish measurable innovation and startup outcomes.

—

5. SCOPE OF THE POLICY

This policy may apply to NCIE programmes and initiatives involving:

Students

- School students
- College students
- University students
- Technical and professional students

Innovators

- Student innovators
- Independent innovators
- Researchers
- Technology innovators

Entrepreneurs

- Aspiring entrepreneurs
- Student entrepreneurs
- Early-stage founders
- Innovation-driven enterprises

Institutions

- Colleges
- Universities
- Schools
- Innovation centres
- Incubation centres
- Entrepreneurship development cells
- Other eligible educational and institutional organisations

—

6. NCIE INNOVATION ECOSYSTEM

NCIE shall seek to develop an interconnected ecosystem:

PROBLEM IDENTIFICATION



IDEA GENERATION



INNOVATION



PROTOTYPE



VALIDATION



MENTORSHIP



INCUBATION



BUSINESS DEVELOPMENT



INVESTOR READINESS



INVESTOR / INDUSTRY CONNECTIVITY



STARTUP DEVELOPMENT



SCALE-UP

—

7. INNOVATION DEVELOPMENT FRAMEWORK

NCIE programmes may support innovation through:

- Design thinking
- Problem identification
- Idea generation
- Research orientation
- Technology exploration
- Product development
- Process innovation
- Social innovation
- Digital innovation
- AI-enabled innovation
- Sustainability-oriented innovation

Innovation activities may be delivered through:

- Workshops
- Hackathons
- Competitions
- Innovation challenges
- Projects
- Seminars
- Mentorship programmes
- Institutional innovation programmes

—

8. STUDENT INNOVATION POLICY

NCIE encourages students to participate in innovation activities irrespective of their academic discipline, subject to programme-specific eligibility.

Students may be encouraged to:

- Identify real-world problems.

- Develop innovative solutions.
- Participate in innovation challenges.
- Develop prototypes.
- Present ideas.
- Work in multidisciplinary teams.
- Participate in startup development activities.
- Seek mentorship.
- Explore incubation opportunities.

Student innovation projects may be assessed on:

- Problem relevance
- Originality
- Innovation
- Feasibility
- Technical potential
- Social or economic value
- Scalability
- Sustainability

—

9. STARTUP DEVELOPMENT POLICY

NCIE shall encourage the progression of suitable innovations towards entrepreneurship.

The startup development pathway may include:

STAGE 1 – IDEATION

Identification of a problem, opportunity or innovative concept.

STAGE 2 – VALIDATION

Assessment of the problem, proposed solution and potential users.

STAGE 3 – PROTOTYPING

Development of prototype, MVP or proof of concept.

STAGE 4 – BUSINESS DEVELOPMENT

Development of business model, value proposition and market strategy.

STAGE 5 – MENTORSHIP

Access to appropriate experts, entrepreneurs, academics and industry professionals.

STAGE 6 – INCUBATION

Facilitation towards suitable incubators or startup support ecosystems.

STAGE 7 – INVESTOR READINESS

Preparation for potential investor engagement.

STAGE 8 – SCALE-UP

Facilitation towards appropriate industry, investment and growth opportunities.

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10. DR. A.P.J. ABDUL KALAM STARTUP VALIDATION PROGRAMME

The **Dr. A.P.J. Abdul Kalam Startup Validation Programme** shall operate as a major startup-oriented initiative within the NCIE innovation ecosystem.

The programme may provide a structured pathway covering:

IDEA → PROTOTYPE → VALIDATION → MENTORSHIP → INCUBATION → INVESTOR READINESS → ECOSYSTEM CONNECTIVITY

For selected eligible startup initiatives, the NCIE programme framework may provide **indicative seed support up to ₹5,00,000**, subject to applicable programme guidelines, evaluation, selection, milestones and availability of resources.

–

11. STARTUP VALIDATION FRAMEWORK

Startup proposals may be evaluated against:

- Problem significance
- Innovation
- Technical feasibility
- Product readiness
- Market opportunity
- User need
- Business model
- Team capability
- Scalability
- Sustainability
- Social or economic impact

Validation does not constitute a guarantee of funding, investment or commercial success.

—

12. INCUBATION & ACCELERATION POLICY

NCIE may facilitate suitable innovators and startups towards appropriate:

- Incubators
- Accelerators
- Innovation centres
- Entrepreneurship development cells
- Industry programmes
- Startup support organisations
- Mentorship networks

Selection and admission into an external incubator or accelerator shall remain subject to the respective organisation's eligibility and selection process.

—

13. MENTORSHIP POLICY

NCIE may establish a mentor network comprising:

- Entrepreneurs

- Industry professionals
- Academicians
- Researchers
- Technology experts
- Business professionals
- Startup founders
- Subject-matter experts

Mentorship may cover:

- Product development
- Technology
- Business models
- Market validation
- Intellectual property
- Leadership
- Fundraising readiness
- Business strategy
- Startup operations

Mentorship shall be advisory in nature unless a separate contractual arrangement provides otherwise.

—

14. INNOVATION & TECHNOLOGY MANAGEMENT

NCIE may promote technology-oriented innovation through programmes covering:

- Emerging technologies
- Artificial Intelligence
- Digital transformation
- Technology management
- Product innovation
- Technology entrepreneurship
- Digital business models
- Responsible technology adoption

—

15. AI & STARTUP INNOVATION

NCIE may encourage responsible application of Artificial Intelligence in:

- Business
- Education
- Healthcare
- Agriculture
- Governance
- Social innovation
- Digital services
- Entrepreneurship
- Product development

Participants should be encouraged to consider:

- Data privacy
- Security
- Responsible AI
- Accuracy
- Human oversight
- Ethical use
- Applicable legal requirements

—

16. INSTITUTIONAL INNOVATION POLICY

NCIE may facilitate eligible educational institutions in developing innovation and entrepreneurship ecosystems.

Potential institutional components include:

- Innovation Centres
- Incubation Centres
- Innovation Laboratories
- Entrepreneurship Development Cells
- Startup Clubs
- Innovation Clubs
- Student innovation programmes
- Faculty development
- Entrepreneurship training
- Industry–academia programmes

17. INSTITUTIONAL FUNDING FACILITATION

NCIE may facilitate eligible institutions in identifying and developing proposals for appropriate funding opportunities relating to innovation, entrepreneurship, incubation and institutional capacity building.

Potential funding channels may include:

- Government Ministries and Departments
- Government-supported schemes
- CSR partnerships
- Industry-supported programmes
- Innovation and incubation programmes
- Philanthropic organisations
- Institutional development programmes

Where appropriate, institutional proposals may be developed within an **indicative requirement range of ₹5 lakh to ₹25 lakh.**

This is a **potential funding-support framework and not a guaranteed Government, Ministry or CSR grant.**

Actual funding shall depend upon:

**ELIGIBILITY → PROPOSAL → EVALUATION → FUNDING
SOURCE → APPROVAL → AVAILABILITY OF FUNDS**

18. CSR & INDUSTRY PARTICIPATION

NCIE may engage eligible CSR and industry partners to support:

- Innovation programmes
- Student development
- Entrepreneurship
- Skills
- Technology
- Innovation infrastructure
- Institutional capacity building
- Social-impact innovation

Any CSR funding shall be subject to applicable CSR requirements, project eligibility, due diligence, corporate approval and the independent decision of the CSR contributor.

—

19. INVESTOR CONNECTIVITY POLICY

NCIE may facilitate appropriate investor ecosystem connectivity for suitable and investor-ready startups.

Potential ecosystem stakeholders may include:

- Angel investors
- Venture capital funds
- Family offices
- Corporate investors
- Impact investors
- Startup investment networks
- Incubators
- Accelerators

Investor connectivity may include:

- Investor-readiness sessions
- Pitch preparation
- Demo days
- Startup showcases
- Investor introductions
- Pitch opportunities

—

20. INDICATIVE INVESTMENT PIPELINE

The NCIE startup ecosystem framework may seek to facilitate potential investor connectivity across eligible and investor-ready startup opportunities, with an **indicative investment pipeline of up to ₹25 crore**.

Important

The ₹25 crore figure represents a **potential ecosystem investment**

pipeline / connectivity framework and is **not guaranteed investment capital**.

Investment decisions remain entirely subject to:

- Investor interest
- Due diligence
- Startup quality
- Market potential
- Financial viability
- Technology readiness
- Legal compliance
- Investment terms
- Independent investor decision

—

21. INTELLECTUAL PROPERTY POLICY

NCIE shall encourage innovators to appropriately consider intellectual property protection.

Depending on the nature of the innovation, participants may consider:

- Patents
- Copyright
- Trademarks
- Designs
- Trade secrets
- Other applicable IP protections

Unless separately agreed in writing, participation in an NCIE programme should not automatically be represented as transferring ownership of a participant's intellectual property to NCIE.

Participants should obtain appropriate professional/legal advice for IP protection and ownership matters.

—

22. CONFIDENTIALITY

Participants may be required to protect confidential information relating

to:

- Unpublished inventions
- Business plans
- Technical information
- Customer information
- Financial information
- Proprietary processes
- Other confidential material

Where specific confidentiality obligations are required, they should be established through an appropriate written agreement.

—

23. ETHICAL & RESPONSIBLE INNOVATION

NCIE encourages innovations that are:

- Ethical
- Inclusive
- Safe
- Sustainable
- Legally compliant
- Socially responsible

Projects involving potentially sensitive technologies, personal data, regulated activities or high-risk applications should undergo appropriate review and compliance checks.

—

24. FUNDING & FINANCIAL PRINCIPLES

NCIE shall maintain the following principles:

- No funding shall be represented as guaranteed unless formally sanctioned.
- Funding opportunities shall be subject to eligibility.
- Financial assistance shall be subject to applicable programme rules.
- Investment opportunities shall remain subject to investor decisions.
- Appropriate documentation shall be maintained.

- Financial transactions shall follow approved procedures.
- Utilisation of programme funds shall be appropriately recorded.

25. GOVERNMENT POLICY ALIGNMENT

The policy may be aligned thematically with national priorities relating to:

- Innovation
- Entrepreneurship
- Startup development
- Skill development
- Digital transformation
- Youth development
- Technology
- Industry–academia collaboration

Startup India officially identifies areas including **funding support, mentorship, industry–academia partnership, incubation and investor connectivity** within the startup ecosystem.

The policy may also complement educational and technology priorities reflected in national education initiatives, including technology-enabled learning and AI-related initiatives under the NEP 2020 ecosystem.

Such alignment **does not by itself establish Government ownership, statutory authority, Government accreditation, Ministry affiliation, Government endorsement or Government funding for NCIE.**

26. PARTNERSHIP FRAMEWORK

NCIE may develop appropriate partnerships with:

Academic Institutions

Colleges, universities, schools and research institutions.

Industry

Companies, technology organisations and professional organisations.

Incubators & Accelerators

Innovation and startup ecosystem organisations.

Government & Public Institutions

Subject to applicable approvals, agreements and programme frameworks.

CSR Organisations

Eligible corporate CSR contributors.

NGOs & Community Organisations

For social innovation and community-oriented entrepreneurship.

Investors

Subject to independent investor interest and due diligence.

–

27. INNOVATION CHALLENGES & HACKATHONS

NCIE may organise:

- Hackathons
- Innovation competitions
- Idea challenges
- Startup challenges
- Prototype competitions
- Innovation showcases
- Entrepreneurship competitions

Evaluation may consider:

- Innovation
- Problem relevance
- Technical feasibility
- Market potential
- Social impact
- Presentation
- Team capability
- Scalability

28. STUDENT STARTUP SUPPORT

Students may be provided with opportunities for:

- Startup orientation
- Innovation training
- Mentorship
- Prototype development
- Business model development
- Startup validation
- Incubation linkage
- Investor-readiness development

Participation in startup support programmes does not automatically establish startup recognition or Government recognition. Where applicable, startups may independently seek recognition under the relevant official framework, such as DPIIT Startup Recognition.

29. INSTITUTIONAL INNOVATION SCORECARD

NCIE may develop an institutional assessment framework covering:

Area	Indicative Assessment
Innovation infrastructure	Innovation / incubation facilities
Student participation	Innovation and startup participation
Faculty engagement	Mentoring and project support
Entrepreneurship	Startup activities
Industry engagement	Industry interaction
Innovation projects	Projects and prototypes
Startup outcomes	Validated ventures

Events	Hackathons and challenges
Mentorship	Expert engagement
Impact	Measurable outcomes

—

30. MONITORING & EVALUATION

NCIE may monitor:

Inputs

- Trainers
- Mentors
- Institutions
- Resources
- Programme infrastructure

Outputs

- Participants
- Innovation projects
- Prototypes
- Mentorship sessions
- Workshops
- Institutions onboarded

Outcomes

- Skills developed
- Ideas validated
- Startups progressed
- Institutional capacity strengthened
- Industry connections developed

Impact

- Startup progression
- Employment / enterprise outcomes where verifiable
- Innovation adoption
- Institutional ecosystem development
- Social and economic contribution

31. DATA & DIGITAL GOVERNANCE

Programme information may be maintained through appropriate digital systems for:

- Registration
- Attendance
- Project tracking
- Mentorship
- Assessment
- Certification
- Institutional records
- MIS
- Monitoring

NCIE should implement appropriate controls relating to:

- Access
- Data accuracy
- Privacy
- Security
- Retention
- Authorisation

32. GRIEVANCE & FEEDBACK MECHANISM

Participants and institutions may be provided appropriate channels for:

- Programme feedback
- Complaints
- Grievances
- Technical issues
- Certification issues
- Institutional concerns
- Programme-related queries

Complaints should be recorded and addressed through an appropriate designated process.

—

33. GOVERNANCE & RESPONSIBILITY

The implementation of this policy may involve:

NCIE GOVERNANCE

↓

PROGRAMME MANAGEMENT

↓

INNOVATION & STARTUP PROGRAMME TEAM

↓

INSTITUTIONAL / REGIONAL COORDINATORS

↓

TRAINERS & MENTORS

↓

PARTICIPANTS

Roles and responsibilities should be documented through applicable programme guidelines and internal procedures.

—

34. POLICY REVIEW

This policy should be periodically reviewed to consider:

- Programme outcomes
- Stakeholder feedback
- Regulatory developments
- Technology changes
- Startup ecosystem developments
- Institutional requirements
- Funding environment

- Emerging innovation opportunities

Policy amendments should be approved through the appropriate NCIE governance mechanism.

—

35. CORE POLICY PRINCIPLES

NCIE's Innovation & Startup Policy shall be guided by:

INNOVATE

Encourage new ideas and solutions.

VALIDATE

Test ideas against real-world needs.

MENTOR

Provide appropriate guidance.

INCUBATE

Connect suitable ventures with support ecosystems.

CONNECT

Build industry, institutional and investor relationships.

CREATE

Promote entrepreneurship and enterprise development.

SCALE

Support suitable ventures towards growth opportunities.

IMPACT

Measure meaningful outcomes.

—

36. NCIE INNOVATION-TO-ENTERPRISE MODEL

LEARN

Knowledge and awareness



INNOVATE

Ideas and solutions



BUILD

Prototype and proof of concept



VALIDATE

Technical and market assessment



MENTOR

Expert guidance



INCUBATE

Ecosystem support



CONNECT

Industry and investor ecosystem



CREATE

Startup / enterprise development



SCALE

Growth and expansion



IMPACT

—

37. POLICY STATEMENT

NCIE is committed to fostering an enabling environment for innovation and entrepreneurship by providing structured learning, mentorship, validation, institutional support and appropriate ecosystem linkages for students, youth, innovators, startups and educational institutions.

The NCIE Innovation & Startup Policy seeks to establish a responsible and transparent pathway from idea generation to innovation, validation, incubation, entrepreneurship and potential investment connectivity, while ensuring that all funding, investment and institutional support remain subject to applicable eligibility criteria, due diligence, approvals, availability of resources and independent decisions of the relevant funding or investment stakeholders.

—

38. FINAL POLICY FRAMEWORK

NCIE INNOVATION & STARTUP ECOSYSTEM

STUDENTS & YOUTH



INNOVATION



INNOVATION-LED IMPACT

Policy Alignment

NCIE INNOVATION & STARTUP POLICY

- **Innovation**
- **Entrepreneurship**
- **Technology**
- **Youth Development**
- **Institutional Strengthening**
- **Startup Ecosystem Development**
- **Viksit Bharat @2047 Contribution**

NCIE Collaboration & Partnership Framework

NCIE COLLABORATION & PARTNERSHIP FRAMEWORK

National Council for Innovation & Entrepreneurship (NCIE)

Policy Area: Collaboration, Partnerships & Institutional Engagement

Applicable To: Government & Public Institutions, Educational Institutions, Industry, CSR Organisations, Incubators, Accelerators, Investors, NGOs, Knowledge Partners and Other Eligible Organisations

—

1. INTRODUCTION

The **NCIE Collaboration & Partnership Framework** establishes a structured approach for developing and managing collaborations with organisations that can contribute to **innovation, entrepreneurship, technology, skill development, youth development, institutional strengthening, research, incubation and startup ecosystem development**.

The framework is intended to create meaningful institutional relationships through which participating organisations can contribute their respective **expertise, infrastructure, knowledge, networks, resources and programme capabilities**.

NCIE may enter into appropriate collaboration arrangements based on the nature, scope, objectives and requirements of each proposed partnership.

—

2. VISION

To establish a collaborative ecosystem connecting institutions, Government and public-sector stakeholders, academia, industry, CSR organisations, innovation ecosystems and knowledge partners to strengthen innovation and entrepreneurship opportunities for students, youth, innovators and institutions.

—

3. COLLABORATION OBJECTIVES

The framework aims to:

- Develop strategic institutional partnerships.
- Promote innovation and entrepreneurship.
- Strengthen industry–academia engagement.
- Facilitate student and youth development.
- Support institutional innovation ecosystems.
- Facilitate technology and knowledge exchange.
- Encourage research and project collaboration.
- Develop mentorship and expert networks.
- Facilitate incubation and startup ecosystem connectivity.
- Explore appropriate CSR and development partnerships.
- Facilitate suitable Government and public-sector engagement.
- Create opportunities for innovation, skills and entrepreneurship programmes.

–

4. PARTNERSHIP PRINCIPLES

NCIE collaborations shall be guided by the following principles:

Mutual Value

Partnerships should provide meaningful value to participating organisations and beneficiaries.

Transparency

Roles, responsibilities and deliverables should be clearly documented.

Accountability

Each party should remain responsible for its agreed commitments.

Compliance

Activities shall be undertaken in accordance with applicable laws, regulations, institutional policies and agreements.

Non-Exclusivity

Unless specifically agreed otherwise, collaboration should not automatically create exclusivity.

Quality

Programmes and activities should maintain appropriate quality standards.

Impact

Partnerships should seek measurable educational, innovation, entrepreneurial or social outcomes.

Sustainability

Collaborations should be designed for practical and sustainable implementation.

—

5. PARTNERSHIP CATEGORIES

NCIE may develop partnerships across the following categories:

1. Government & Public-Sector Partnerships
2. Academic & Institutional Partnerships
3. Industry Partnerships
4. CSR Partnerships
5. Incubator & Accelerator Partnerships
6. Startup Ecosystem Partnerships
7. Investor Ecosystem Partnerships
8. Research & Knowledge Partnerships
9. NGO & Community Partnerships
10. Technology & Digital Partnerships
11. Media & Outreach Partnerships
12. International / Global Knowledge Partnerships, where appropriate

—

6. GOVERNMENT & PUBLIC-SECTOR COLLABORATION

NCIE may engage with eligible Government Ministries, Departments,

public institutions and other public-sector stakeholders for appropriate programmes.

Potential areas include:

- Innovation programmes
- Skill development
- Youth development
- Entrepreneurship
- Institutional capacity building
- Technology awareness
- Research and knowledge initiatives
- Programme implementation
- Public awareness
- Community development

Such collaboration shall be based on appropriate **official communication, approval, agreement, MoU, sanction or other applicable documentation**, wherever required.

Important

A collaboration proposal, meeting, correspondence or MoU shall not by itself be represented as Government endorsement, Government ownership, statutory authority or Government funding unless such status is expressly established through appropriate official documentation.

—

7. MINISTRY & DEPARTMENT ENGAGEMENT

Where relevant to programme objectives, NCIE may approach appropriate Ministries and Departments for:

- Programme collaboration
- Technical guidance
- Institutional engagement
- Scheme convergence
- Capacity-building initiatives
- Innovation and entrepreneurship programmes
- Youth development programmes
- Skill initiatives

Any Government funding or programme support shall remain subject to the **concerned Ministry/Department's eligibility requirements, proposal evaluation, approval process, applicable guidelines and availability of funds.**

—

8. ACADEMIC & INSTITUTIONAL PARTNERSHIPS

NCIE may collaborate with:

- Universities
- Colleges
- Engineering institutions
- Technical institutions
- Professional institutions
- Schools
- Research institutions
- Training institutions
- Innovation centres

Potential activities include:

- Student innovation programmes
- Entrepreneurship programmes
- Leadership development
- AI and digital skills
- Workshops
- Seminars
- Hackathons
- Internships
- Mentorship
- Faculty development
- Startup programmes
- Innovation challenges
- Institutional capacity building

—

9. INSTITUTIONAL ONBOARDING

Eligible institutions may be onboarded through a structured process:

EXPRESSION OF INTEREST



INSTITUTIONAL DISCUSSION



REQUIREMENT / NEED ASSESSMENT



PARTNERSHIP PROPOSAL



DUE DILIGENCE



ROLE & RESPONSIBILITY DEFINITION



APPROVAL



MoU / AGREEMENT, WHERE REQUIRED



PROGRAMME IMPLEMENTATION



MONITORING & REVIEW



10. INDUSTRY PARTNERSHIPS

NCIE may engage with companies and industry organisations to facilitate:

- Industry exposure
- Expert sessions

- Mentorship
- Technology awareness
- Industry projects
- Skill development
- Internships
- Entrepreneurship programmes
- Innovation challenges
- Industry–academia collaboration
- Startup ecosystem engagement

Industry partners may contribute through expertise, technology, mentorship, infrastructure, programme support or other mutually agreed mechanisms.

—

11. CSR PARTNERSHIP FRAMEWORK

NCIE may engage eligible corporate organisations for CSR-supported programmes in accordance with applicable CSR requirements and the organisation's CSR policy.

Potential areas include:

- Education
- Skill development
- Innovation
- Entrepreneurship
- Digital capability
- Youth development
- Institutional development
- Innovation infrastructure
- Social-impact initiatives

CSR support shall be subject to:

CSR ELIGIBILITY → PROJECT PROPOSAL → DUE DILIGENCE → CORPORATE REVIEW → APPROVAL → AGREEMENT → IMPLEMENTATION → REPORTING

CSR support shall not be represented as guaranteed unless formally approved and documented by the concerned CSR organisation.

12. INCUBATOR & ACCELERATOR PARTNERSHIPS

NCIE may develop partnerships with eligible:

- Incubators
- Accelerators
- Innovation centres
- Startup support organisations
- Entrepreneurship development centres

Potential areas include:

- Startup referrals
- Mentorship
- Incubation
- Acceleration
- Prototype development
- Business development
- Investor readiness
- Demo days
- Startup showcases

Admission into any external incubator or accelerator shall remain subject to that organisation's independent eligibility and selection process.

13. STARTUP ECOSYSTEM PARTNERSHIPS

NCIE may collaborate with startup ecosystem organisations to support:

- Startup awareness
- Entrepreneurship education
- Idea validation
- Prototype development
- Mentorship
- Incubation
- Market access
- Industry connections
- Investor readiness

The objective is to create a structured pathway from **student innovation to enterprise development**.

—

14. INVESTOR ECOSYSTEM CONNECTIVITY

NCIE may facilitate appropriate connectivity between suitable and investor-ready startups and potential:

- Angel investors
- Venture capital organisations
- Corporate investors
- Impact investors
- Investment networks
- Family offices
- Startup funds
- Other eligible investment ecosystem participants

Potential activities may include:

- Investor-readiness workshops
- Pitch preparation
- Startup showcases
- Demo days
- Investor introductions
- Pitch opportunities

Investment Disclaimer

Investor connectivity does not constitute a guarantee of investment.

Any investment shall remain subject to:

- Due diligence
- Startup quality
- Market potential
- Financial viability
- Legal compliance
- Investor interest
- Investment terms
- Independent investor decision

15. RESEARCH & KNOWLEDGE PARTNERSHIPS

NCIE may collaborate with research and knowledge organisations for:

- Research projects
- Studies
- Publications
- Knowledge resources
- Innovation reports
- Seminars
- Conferences
- Policy discussions
- Best-practice documentation
- Technology and innovation research

Research partnerships should clearly define ownership, publication rights, confidentiality and intellectual property responsibilities where applicable.

16. NGO & COMMUNITY PARTNERSHIPS

NCIE may collaborate with eligible NGOs, foundations and community organisations for:

- Youth development
- Community innovation
- Entrepreneurship
- Skills
- Digital literacy
- Social innovation
- Inclusive development
- Community-oriented programmes

Such partnerships may support outreach to underserved and emerging communities.

17. TECHNOLOGY PARTNERSHIPS

NCIE may collaborate with technology organisations for:

- Digital platforms
- Artificial Intelligence
- Cloud technologies
- Learning technologies
- Innovation tools
- Digital skills
- Technology demonstrations
- Startup technology support

Technology partnerships shall be governed by appropriate agreements covering implementation, security, data protection, licensing and responsibilities where applicable.

—

18. KNOWLEDGE PARTNER FRAMEWORK

Knowledge partners may contribute:

- Subject-matter expertise
- Curriculum support
- Research
- Faculty resources
- Training
- Mentoring
- Publications
- Technical guidance

Knowledge partnerships may be established with academic institutions, research organisations, industry experts and professional bodies.

—

19. COLLABORATION MODELS

NCIE may use different collaboration models depending on programme requirements.

Model 1 – MoU Partnership

A formal Memorandum of Understanding defining broad areas of cooperation.

Model 2 – Programme Agreement

A specific agreement for implementation of a defined programme.

Model 3 – Project Partnership

A project-specific collaboration with defined outputs and timelines.

Model 4 – Institutional Partnership

Long-term collaboration with an eligible college, university or organisation.

Model 5 – CSR Partnership

A CSR-supported project arrangement subject to applicable requirements.

Model 6 – Knowledge Partnership

Collaboration focused on knowledge, research, training and expertise.

Model 7 – Ecosystem Partnership

Connectivity among startups, incubators, industry, mentors and investors.

–

20. MoU & AGREEMENT FRAMEWORK

Where a formal partnership is required, the agreement may specify:

- Parties
- Purpose
- Scope
- Objectives
- Activities
- Roles and responsibilities
- Deliverables
- Timeline
- Financial arrangements
- Intellectual property

- Confidentiality
- Data protection
- Branding and communications
- Monitoring
- Reporting
- Termination
- Dispute resolution
- Applicable law

No party should represent a collaboration beyond the authority and scope granted under the applicable agreement.

—

21. PARTNER SELECTION & DUE DILIGENCE

Potential partners may be assessed based on:

- Legal status
- Institutional credibility
- Relevant experience
- Technical capabilities
- Financial capacity where relevant
- Programme expertise
- Compliance record
- Infrastructure
- Reputation
- Strategic relevance

NCIE may conduct appropriate documentation and due-diligence procedures before formalising significant partnerships.

—

22. PARTNER ROLES & RESPONSIBILITIES

Each collaboration should clearly identify:

NCIE Responsibilities

Depending on the agreement:

- Programme coordination
- Institutional facilitation
- Participant mobilisation
- Training coordination
- Mentorship coordination
- Monitoring
- Documentation
- Reporting

Partner Responsibilities

Depending on the agreement:

- Resources
- Experts
- Infrastructure
- Technology
- Funding
- Mentorship
- Industry exposure
- Programme implementation
- Reporting

Specific responsibilities shall be determined by the relevant agreement or programme document.

—

23. FUNDING & RESOURCE CONTRIBUTION

Partnership contributions may include:

- Financial contributions
- CSR support
- Infrastructure
- Technology
- Experts
- Mentors
- Training resources
- Scholarships
- Equipment
- Research support

- Programme management support

All financial commitments should be documented appropriately.

A partnership or MoU should not be interpreted as a financial commitment unless the relevant financial terms are expressly documented.

—

24. FUNDING FACILITATION FOR INSTITUTIONS

Where appropriate, NCIE may facilitate eligible colleges and universities in developing proposals for innovation and entrepreneurship support.

Potential funding channels may include:

- Government schemes
- Ministry / Department programmes
- CSR organisations
- Industry partners
- Innovation programmes
- Incubation mechanisms
- Philanthropic organisations

Potential institutional requirements may fall within an indicative **₹5 lakh–₹25 lakh** range depending on project scope.

The amount is an **indicative programme planning range and not a guaranteed grant or funding commitment.**

—

25. PROGRAMME COLLABORATION LIFECYCLE

IDENTIFICATION

↓

PARTNER MAPPING

↓

INITIAL DISCUSSION



DUE DILIGENCE



PROPOSAL DEVELOPMENT



TECHNICAL / PROGRAMME REVIEW



APPROVAL



MoU / AGREEMENT



IMPLEMENTATION



MONITORING



REPORTING



REVIEW



RENEWAL / SCALE-UP / CLOSURE

—

26. PARTNERSHIP GOVERNANCE

Significant collaborations should have designated:

- NCIE programme coordinator
- Partner coordinator
- Institutional nodal officer, where applicable
- Programme implementation team
- Monitoring mechanism
- Reporting mechanism

For larger programmes, a joint coordination mechanism may be established through the relevant agreement.

—

27. MONITORING & PERFORMANCE REVIEW

Partnership performance may be measured through:

Input Indicators

- Resources mobilised
- Experts engaged
- Institutions onboarded
- Funding committed

Output Indicators

- Programmes conducted
- Participants reached
- Training hours
- Innovation projects
- Mentorship sessions

Outcome Indicators

- Skills developed
- Ideas validated
- Startups progressed
- Institutional capabilities strengthened
- Industry connections created

Impact Indicators

- Startup development
- Employment / enterprise outcomes where verifiable

- Innovation adoption
- Institutional ecosystem development
- Social and economic impact

—

28. PARTNERSHIP REPORTING

Depending on the nature of the partnership, reporting may include:

- Programme reports
- Participant data
- Attendance
- Activity reports
- Financial utilisation information
- Photographic documentation
- Outcome reports
- Impact reports
- Partner performance reports

Reports should be prepared according to applicable programme and agreement requirements.

—

29. BRANDING & COMMUNICATION

Use of NCIE or partner logos, names, marks and institutional identities should be subject to applicable permissions and agreement terms.

Neither party should use the other party's name or logo in a manner that falsely implies:

- Government ownership
- Government endorsement
- Accreditation
- Statutory authority
- Funding commitment
- Exclusive partnership

unless such status is formally established and documented.

—

30. DATA, PRIVACY & CONFIDENTIALITY

Partnerships involving participant or institutional information should establish appropriate procedures for:

- Data collection
- Consent where applicable
- Access control
- Data security
- Confidentiality
- Data retention
- Information sharing

Sensitive or confidential information should be handled according to applicable legal and institutional requirements.

—

31. INTELLECTUAL PROPERTY

Partnership agreements should specify ownership and permitted use of:

- Research outputs
- Innovations
- Software
- Content
- Designs
- Publications
- Trademarks
- Patents
- Other intellectual property

Ownership should not be assumed solely because an organisation participated in a collaborative programme.

—

32. CONFLICT OF INTEREST

NCIE and participating partners should identify and appropriately manage potential conflicts of interest.

Where a conflict exists, the concerned person or organisation may be

required to disclose the conflict and follow applicable procedures.

—

33. PARTNERSHIP ETHICS

NCIE collaborations should promote:

- Integrity
- Transparency
- Non-discrimination
- Professional conduct
- Responsible innovation
- Fair participation
- Accountability
- Compliance

Partners should not make misleading claims regarding programme outcomes, funding, Government association or investment opportunities.

—

34. PARTNERSHIP RISK MANAGEMENT

Potential risks may include:

- Regulatory risk
- Financial risk
- Reputational risk
- Operational risk
- Data risk
- Technology risk
- Partnership-performance risk
- Conflict-of-interest risk

Appropriate mitigation measures should be incorporated into significant partnership arrangements.

—

35. PARTNERSHIP DATABASE

NCIE may maintain a structured partnership database containing, as appropriate:

- Partner name
- Organisation type
- Contact information
- Partnership category
- Agreement details
- Programme area
- Start date
- Review date
- Status
- Activities
- Outcomes
- Documentation

—

36. PARTNERSHIP RECOGNITION

Where appropriate, NCIE may recognise participating organisations as:

- Institutional Partners
- Academic Partners
- Knowledge Partners
- Industry Partners
- CSR Partners
- Innovation Partners
- Ecosystem Partners
- Programme Partners

Such recognition should accurately reflect the nature and scope of the actual collaboration.

—

37. STRATEGIC ECOSYSTEM MODEL

NCIE's collaboration ecosystem may be represented as:

GOVERNMENT & PUBLIC INSTITUTIONS



NCIE



COLLEGES & UNIVERSITIES



INDUSTRY



CSR ORGANISATIONS



INCUBATORS & ACCELERATORS



MENTORS & KNOWLEDGE PARTNERS



STARTUPS & INNOVATORS



INVESTOR ECOSYSTEM



COMMUNITY & DEVELOPMENT ORGANISATIONS

—

38. PARTNERSHIP OUTCOME FRAMEWORK

The overall collaboration model follows:

CONNECT

Build institutional relationships.



COLLABORATE

Develop programmes and projects.



CAPACITATE

Build skills and institutional capabilities.



INNOVATE

Develop ideas and solutions.



INCUBATE

Support suitable startup development.



CONNECT TO ECOSYSTEM

Facilitate industry, funding and investor connectivity.



CREATE IMPACT

Measure educational, entrepreneurial, social and economic outcomes.



39. REVIEW & RENEWAL

Partnerships may be periodically reviewed based on:

- Performance
- Programme outcomes
- Partner contribution
- Beneficiary feedback
- Compliance
- Strategic relevance
- Sustainability

Based on the review, partnerships may be:

- Continued
- Renewed
- Expanded
- Modified
- Suspended
- Concluded



40. FRAMEWORK STATEMENT

The NCIE Collaboration & Partnership Framework seeks to establish a transparent, structured and outcome-oriented ecosystem through which Government and public-sector stakeholders, academic institutions, industry, CSR organisations, incubators, accelerators, investors, NGOs and knowledge partners can contribute to innovation, entrepreneurship, technology, skill development and institutional strengthening.

NCIE may facilitate appropriate programme, institutional, funding and ecosystem linkages within the scope of its organisational mandate. All Government collaboration, funding, CSR support, investment and institutional assistance shall remain subject to applicable eligibility requirements, formal approvals, agreements, due diligence, availability of resources and the independent decisions of the respective Government authority, funding organisation, corporate partner, institution or investor.

NCIE COLLABORATION MODEL

PARTNER

- CONNECT
- COLLABORATE
- IMPLEMENT
- MONITOR
- MEASURE
- SCALE
- IMPACT

**Together for Innovation. Entrepreneurship. Skills.
Institutions. Startups. Impact.**

NCIE CSR Partnership Framework

NCIE CSR PARTNERSHIP FRAMEWORK

National Council for Innovation & Entrepreneurship (NCIE)

Framework Area: Corporate Social Responsibility, Institutional Development & Social Impact

Applicable To: Eligible Companies, CSR Foundations, Corporate Trusts, Educational Institutions, Innovation Ecosystem Partners and Other Eligible Stakeholders

—

1. INTRODUCTION

The **NCIE CSR Partnership Framework** establishes a structured mechanism for developing and managing Corporate Social Responsibility partnerships in areas relevant to NCIE's organisational mandate, including **education, innovation, entrepreneurship, skill development, technology, youth empowerment, institutional capacity building and social-impact development.**

The framework is intended to facilitate collaboration among **corporates, CSR foundations, educational institutions, innovation ecosystems, industry partners and other eligible stakeholders** for the design and implementation of measurable, sustainable and outcome-oriented initiatives.

CSR partnerships shall be undertaken in accordance with **applicable legal provisions, CSR policies of the concerned company, project eligibility, due diligence requirements, approved project documents and formal agreements.**

—

2. VISION

To build a responsible and outcome-oriented CSR ecosystem that mobilises corporate expertise, resources, technology and institutional partnerships to strengthen innovation, entrepreneurship, skills, education and youth development.

3. OBJECTIVES

The NCIE CSR Partnership Framework aims to:

- Develop structured CSR partnerships.
- Support education and student development.
- Promote innovation and entrepreneurship.
- Strengthen youth skills and employability capabilities.
- Support AI, digital and emerging technology programmes.
- Strengthen institutional innovation ecosystems.
- Facilitate innovation and incubation infrastructure.
- Encourage student innovation and startup development.
- Promote measurable social-impact programmes.
- Strengthen collaboration between corporates and educational institutions.
- Facilitate sustainable and scalable CSR-supported interventions.

4. CSR PARTNERSHIP PRINCIPLES

NCIE CSR partnerships shall be guided by:

Compliance

Programmes shall be undertaken subject to applicable CSR requirements and corporate approvals.

Transparency

Project objectives, budgets, responsibilities and reporting requirements should be clearly documented.

Accountability

Resources should be utilised for approved programme purposes.

Need-Based Planning

Projects should respond to identifiable beneficiary or institutional needs.

Measurable Outcomes

CSR interventions should have defined outputs, outcomes and impact indicators.

Sustainability

Projects should seek long-term institutional or beneficiary value.

Inclusiveness

Programmes may seek to improve participation among eligible beneficiaries across different social and geographic contexts.

—

5. PRIORITY CSR THEMATIC AREAS

Subject to applicable CSR eligibility, NCIE may develop programmes across the following areas:

Education & Student Development

- Educational support
- Scholarships
- Student development
- Career readiness
- Digital learning
- Mentorship

Innovation

- Student innovation
- Innovation challenges
- Hackathons
- Prototype development
- Proof-of-concept support
- Innovation laboratories

Entrepreneurship

- Entrepreneurship development

- Business-model training
- Startup orientation
- Student enterprise development
- Startup validation
- Mentorship

Skill Development

- Digital skills
- Artificial Intelligence
- Emerging technologies
- Employability skills
- Professional development
- Entrepreneurship skills

Institutional Capacity Building

- Innovation centres
- Incubation centres
- Entrepreneurship Development Cells
- Digital infrastructure
- Faculty development
- Institutional innovation programmes

Youth Empowerment

- Leadership development
- Career awareness
- Professional skills
- Innovation leadership
- Entrepreneurship orientation

—

6. CSR PARTNER CATEGORIES

NCIE may engage with eligible:

- Companies
- Corporate groups
- CSR foundations

- Corporate trusts
- Corporate social-impact organisations
- Industry organisations
- Other eligible CSR contributors

The eligibility and nature of the CSR contribution shall be determined by the concerned corporate organisation in accordance with applicable requirements.

—

7. CSR PROJECT DEVELOPMENT PROCESS

CSR projects may be developed through the following process:

NEED IDENTIFICATION

↓

BENEFICIARY / INSTITUTION ASSESSMENT

↓

CSR PRIORITY MAPPING

↓

PROJECT CONCEPT NOTE

↓

DETAILED PROJECT PROPOSAL

↓

BUDGET & IMPLEMENTATION PLAN

↓

CORPORATE DUE DILIGENCE

↓

CSR REVIEW & APPROVAL

↓

AGREEMENT / SANCTION

↓

IMPLEMENTATION

↓

MONITORING & REPORTING

↓

IMPACT ASSESSMENT

—

8. CSR PROJECT PROPOSAL COMPONENTS

A CSR project proposal may include:

- Project background
- Need assessment
- Objectives
- Target beneficiaries
- Geographic coverage
- Programme activities
- Implementation methodology
- Timeline
- Budget
- Human-resource requirements
- Monitoring indicators
- Output indicators
- Outcome indicators
- Impact indicators
- Reporting framework
- Sustainability plan
- Risk-management framework

—

9. CSR SUPPORT FOR EDUCATIONAL INSTITUTIONS

NCIE may facilitate eligible colleges, universities and educational institutions in developing CSR proposals for initiatives such as:

- Innovation Centres
- Incubation Centres
- Innovation Laboratories
- Entrepreneurship Development Cells
- Student Innovation Programmes
- AI & Digital Innovation Labs
- Startup Development Programmes
- Prototype Development Facilities
- Entrepreneurship Training
- Faculty Development
- Industry–Academia Engagement
- Skill Development Facilities

10. INDICATIVE INSTITUTIONAL CSR SUPPORT

Depending on project scale, eligibility and the priorities of the concerned CSR organisation, institutional project requirements may be developed within an indicative range of:

₹5 LAKH – ₹25 LAKH

Potential use areas may include:

- Infrastructure
- Technology
- Equipment
- Training
- Innovation activities
- Startup support
- Faculty development
- Mentorship
- Programme delivery
- Monitoring and impact assessment

The stated range represents an **indicative project requirement framework** and does not constitute a guaranteed CSR grant or funding commitment.

11. STUDENT INNOVATION & STARTUP CSR SUPPORT

CSR-supported innovation programmes may include:

- Student innovation challenges
- Prototype development
- Proof-of-concept support
- Mentoring
- Entrepreneurship training
- Startup validation
- Incubation support
- Technology development

For selected eligible startup initiatives, programme proposals may include **indicative seed-support requirements up to ₹5 lakh per startup**, subject to applicable project guidelines, evaluation, selection, resource availability and approval of the concerned CSR or funding organisation.

—

12. CSR–ACADEMIA–INDUSTRY CONVERGENCE

NCIE may facilitate a collaborative model involving:

CSR ORGANISATION

↓

NCIE

↓

COLLEGE / UNIVERSITY

↓

STUDENTS & FACULTY

↓

INNOVATION / ENTREPRENEURSHIP PROGRAMME

↓

INDUSTRY / MENTOR / INCUBATION SUPPORT

↓

MEASURABLE OUTCOMES

This model is intended to combine corporate resources with institutional infrastructure and technical expertise.

—

13. CSR & GOVERNMENT PROGRAMME CONVERGENCE

Where appropriate and legally permissible, NCIE may facilitate complementary linkages among:

- CSR organisations
- Educational institutions
- Government programmes
- Public-sector institutions
- Industry
- Innovation ecosystem organisations

Any Government association shall be represented only where supported by appropriate **official approval, programme documentation, agreement or sanction.**

CSR participation shall not automatically imply Government approval or Government funding.

—

14. CSR PARTNER CONTRIBUTIONS

Depending on the project, CSR partners may contribute:

Financial Support

Approved project funding.

Technology Support

Equipment, software, tools or digital infrastructure.

Knowledge Support

Experts, trainers and technical resources.

Mentorship

Industry, entrepreneurship and technology mentors.

Infrastructure

Training, innovation or incubation facilities.

Scholarship Support

Eligible educational or student-support initiatives.

In-Kind Contributions

Equipment, resources, services or other approved non-cash support.

—

15. NCIE'S ROLE IN CSR PROJECTS

Subject to the specific agreement, NCIE may facilitate:

- Need assessment
- Project conceptualisation
- Proposal development
- Institutional coordination
- Beneficiary mobilisation
- Programme design
- Trainer and mentor coordination
- Implementation support
- Digital programme management
- Monitoring
- Documentation
- Reporting
- Outcome and impact assessment

NCIE's exact responsibilities shall be defined in the applicable CSR project agreement.

—

16. ROLE OF THE CSR PARTNER

Depending on the approved project, the CSR organisation may:

- Review and approve the project
- Define funding conditions
- Provide financial or technical resources
- Participate in governance or review mechanisms
- Monitor implementation
- Review utilisation
- Participate in impact assessment
- Provide expert or industry support

The CSR organisation shall retain its independent authority over its CSR approval and funding decisions.

—

17. ROLE OF THE PARTICIPATING INSTITUTION

Participating educational institutions may support:

- Student mobilisation
- Faculty coordination
- Venue and infrastructure
- Institutional programme implementation
- Attendance
- Beneficiary verification
- Institutional reporting
- Programme monitoring
- Sustainability of supported infrastructure

—

18. CSR DUE DILIGENCE FRAMEWORK

CSR partnerships may be subject to appropriate due diligence covering:

- Legal status
- Organisational documentation
- Governance
- Financial records
- Programme experience
- Compliance status
- Implementation capability
- Institutional credibility
- Project feasibility
- Monitoring capability

The scope of due diligence may vary according to project size and the requirements of the concerned corporate organisation.

—

19. CSR FINANCIAL MANAGEMENT

CSR project funds shall be managed according to applicable:

- Approved budgets
- Funding agreements
- Financial controls
- Accounting procedures
- Utilisation conditions
- Procurement procedures

- Supporting-document requirements
- Reporting obligations

Project expenditure should be traceable to approved project activities.

—

20. PROJECT BUDGETING

CSR project budgets may include:

- Human resources
- Training
- Technology
- Equipment
- Programme materials
- Institutional infrastructure
- Beneficiary support
- Travel and field activities
- Digital systems
- Monitoring
- Evaluation
- Documentation
- Other approved programme costs

Budgets should be linked to the proposed programme outputs and outcomes.

—

21. MONITORING & EVALUATION

CSR projects may be monitored using:

Input Indicators

- Funds allocated
- Personnel deployed
- Technology and infrastructure provided

Output Indicators

- Beneficiaries reached

- Participants trained
- Institutions supported
- Sessions conducted
- Projects developed

Outcome Indicators

- Skills developed
- Innovation capability improved
- Entrepreneurship readiness
- Institutional capacity strengthened

Impact Indicators

- Sustainable innovation ecosystems
- Startup progression
- Employment or enterprise-related outcomes where verifiable
- Social and economic impact

—

22. CSR REPORTING MECHANISM

Reporting may include:

- Monthly progress reports
- Quarterly reports
- Financial utilisation reports
- Beneficiary reports
- Activity documentation
- Output and outcome reports
- Project completion report
- Impact assessment report

The reporting schedule shall be determined in the applicable project agreement.

—

23. UTILISATION & DOCUMENTATION

Where required, NCIE may maintain:

- Funding records
- Expenditure records
- Invoices and bills
- Beneficiary records
- Attendance
- Programme reports
- Procurement records
- Asset records
- Utilisation statements
- Supporting evidence

Documentation requirements may vary according to the funding agreement and applicable legal requirements.

—

24. IMPACT ASSESSMENT

CSR programme impact may be assessed based on:

- Beneficiary reach
- Skills developed
- Student outcomes
- Innovation outputs
- Startup progression
- Institutional development
- Faculty capacity
- Industry engagement
- Programme sustainability
- Social and economic outcomes

For large or qualifying programmes, impact assessment may be undertaken independently where required by applicable law, corporate policy or programme terms.

—

25. CSR PROJECT GOVERNANCE

Larger CSR projects may establish an appropriate governance structure such as:

CSR PARTNER / AUTHORISED REPRESENTATIVE**NCIE PROGRAMME MANAGEMENT****PARTNER INSTITUTION****PROJECT IMPLEMENTATION TEAM****MONITORING & REPORTING FUNCTION**

Specific roles shall be established through the project agreement.

—

26. TRANSPARENCY & ACCOUNTABILITY

NCIE shall seek to maintain:

- Clear project objectives
- Defined budgets
- Written agreements
- Programme records
- Financial documentation
- Beneficiary records
- Monitoring systems
- Outcome reporting
- Appropriate audit and verification

CSR funding shall not be represented as approved until supported by formal corporate approval or other applicable documentation.

—

27. BRANDING & COMMUNICATION

Use of a CSR partner's:

- Name
- Logo
- Trademark
- Corporate identity
- Funding claim

- Sponsorship claim

shall be subject to applicable permissions and agreement terms.

NCIE shall not describe a corporate organisation as a CSR partner unless an appropriate partnership, approval or agreement exists.

—

28. CONFLICT OF INTEREST

NCIE personnel, consultants, evaluators and participating stakeholders should disclose relevant conflicts of interest in:

- Procurement
- Vendor selection
- Beneficiary selection
- Startup selection
- Funding decisions
- Project evaluation

Appropriate measures should be taken to preserve fairness and objectivity.

—

29. DATA & BENEFICIARY PROTECTION

CSR projects involving beneficiary data should incorporate appropriate measures for:

- Data collection
- Authorisation
- Privacy
- Confidentiality
- Access control
- Data security
- Responsible information sharing
- Record retention

—

30. CSR PROJECT RISK MANAGEMENT

Potential risks may include:

- Funding delays
- Lower beneficiary participation
- Procurement delays
- Technology issues
- Implementation delays
- Compliance issues
- Cost escalation
- Programme-quality issues

Each major project may maintain appropriate mitigation measures.

—

31. SUSTAINABILITY FRAMEWORK

CSR-supported initiatives should seek to generate value beyond the initial funding period.

Sustainability measures may include:

- Institutional ownership
- Faculty capacity building
- Reusable digital infrastructure
- Train-the-trainer models
- Shared institutional resources
- Long-term industry partnerships
- Innovation ecosystems
- Continued entrepreneurship programmes

—

32. CSR PARTNERSHIP LIFECYCLE

PARTNER IDENTIFICATION

↓

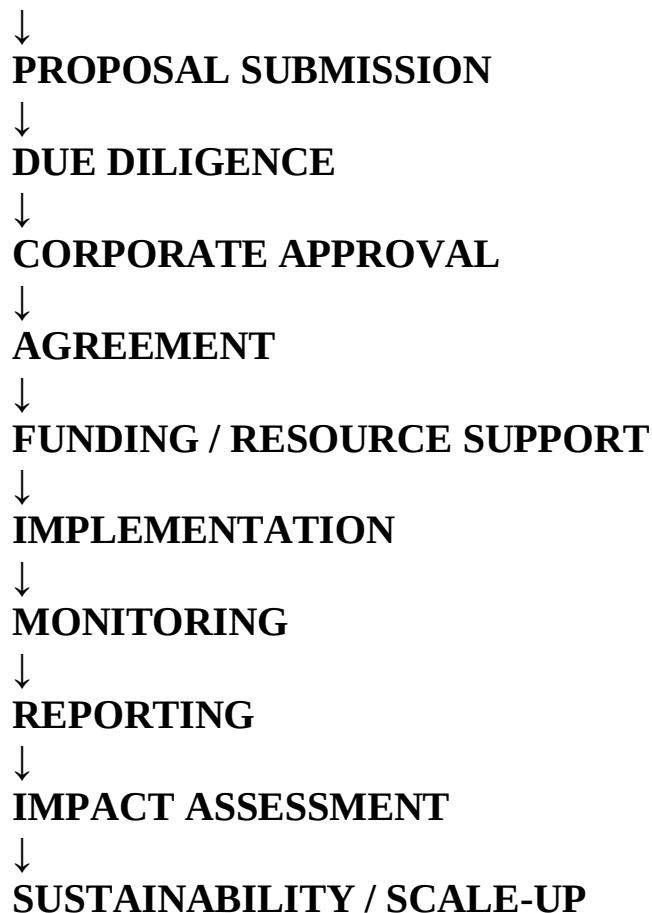
CSR PRIORITY MAPPING

↓

NEED ASSESSMENT

↓

PROJECT DESIGN



33. CSR PARTNERSHIP PERFORMANCE INDICATORS

Indicative KPIs may include:

- CSR partners engaged
- CSR proposals submitted
- Projects approved
- Resources mobilised
- Institutions supported
- Students reached
- Participants trained
- Innovation projects developed
- Faculty trained
- Startups supported
- Mentorship engagements
- Programme completion rate
- Outcome achievement rate
- Impact indicators

34. CSR ECOSYSTEM MODEL

CORPORATES & CSR FOUNDATIONS



NCIE



COLLEGES & UNIVERSITIES



STUDENTS & YOUTH



INNOVATORS & STARTUPS



INDUSTRY & MENTORS



INCUBATORS & ACCELERATORS



COMMUNITIES

This ecosystem is intended to transform CSR resources into **structured educational, innovation, entrepreneurship and institutional-development outcomes**.

35. STRATEGIC ALIGNMENT

Eligible CSR programmes may support NCIE's broader thematic priorities relating to:

- Education
- Innovation
- Entrepreneurship
- Skill development
- Artificial Intelligence and technology
- Youth empowerment
- Institutional development
- Employment and enterprise readiness
- Inclusive development

Where relevant, these interventions may contribute within NCIE's organisational mandate to the broader national aspiration of **Viksit Bharat @2047**.

—

36. CSR PARTNERSHIP STATEMENT

The NCIE CSR Partnership Framework seeks to establish a transparent, accountable and outcome-oriented mechanism for collaboration with eligible corporate and CSR organisations in support of education, innovation, entrepreneurship, skills, technology, youth development and institutional capacity building.

All CSR funding and support shall remain subject to applicable legal requirements, corporate CSR policies, project eligibility, due diligence, formal approval, funding availability and the terms of the relevant agreement. No proposed CSR contribution shall be represented as confirmed funding unless supported by appropriate documentary evidence.

—

37. NCIE CSR IMPACT PATHWAY

IDENTIFY

Recognise beneficiary and institutional needs.

↓

PARTNER

Engage suitable CSR organisations.

↓

INVEST

Mobilise approved financial, technical and institutional resources.



IMPLEMENT

Deliver structured programmes.



MEASURE

Track outputs and outcomes.



IMPACT

Generate sustainable educational, innovation, entrepreneurship and social value.

**CSR → INNOVATION → SKILLS → ENTREPRENEURSHIP →
INSTITUTIONAL CAPACITY → SUSTAINABLE IMPACT**

NCIE Funding & Resource Mobilisation Framework

NCIE FUNDING & RESOURCE MOBILISATION FRAMEWORK

National Council for Innovation & Entrepreneurship (NCIE)

Framework Area: Funding, Resource Mobilisation, Institutional Support & Financial Sustainability

—

1. INTRODUCTION

The **NCIE Funding & Resource Mobilisation Framework** establishes a structured approach for identifying, developing, mobilising and managing financial and non-financial resources required for the implementation and expansion of NCIE programmes and institutional initiatives.

The framework is designed to support programmes relating to **innovation, entrepreneurship, skill development, Artificial Intelligence and digital technologies, youth leadership, student development, institutional capacity building, incubation, startup development and social-impact initiatives.**

NCIE may mobilise resources directly where legally and operationally appropriate and may also **facilitate eligible institutions, projects and programme stakeholders in accessing suitable Government, CSR, industry, philanthropic, institutional and ecosystem funding opportunities.**

—

2. VISION

To establish a diversified, transparent and sustainable resource mobilisation ecosystem that enables NCIE programmes and partner institutions to expand innovation, entrepreneurship, skills, technology and youth-development opportunities.

—

3. OBJECTIVES

The framework aims to:

- Develop diversified funding and resource channels.
- Reduce dependence on a single funding source.
- Support sustainable programme implementation.
- Facilitate eligible institutional funding opportunities.
- Develop Government and public-sector funding linkages.
- Mobilise CSR and corporate resources.
- Encourage industry-supported programmes.
- Develop philanthropic and development partnerships.
- Facilitate innovation and incubation support.
- Support student innovation and startup development.
- Mobilise technical and knowledge resources.
- Strengthen institutional financial planning.
- Establish transparent financial controls.
- Develop long-term programme sustainability.

—

4. RESOURCE MOBILISATION PRINCIPLES

NCIE's resource mobilisation activities shall follow:

Diversification

Resources should be mobilised through multiple appropriate channels.

Transparency

Funding proposals and financial commitments should be clearly documented.

Compliance

All resource mobilisation activities shall follow applicable laws, regulations, agreements and institutional requirements.

Purpose-Specific Utilisation

Resources should be utilised for the purposes approved under the relevant project or funding arrangement.

Accountability

Financial and programme performance should be appropriately monitored and reported.

Sustainability

Funding strategies should consider long-term programme continuity.

Impact Orientation

Resources should be directed towards measurable programme outcomes.

—

5. RESOURCE CATEGORIES

NCIE's resource mobilisation framework covers two broad categories:

A. Financial Resources

- Government programme funding
- Ministry / Department schemes
- CSR support
- Corporate sponsorship
- Institutional contributions
- Philanthropic support
- Grants
- Project-based funding
- Programme participation revenue, where applicable
- Donations where legally permissible
- Other eligible funding mechanisms

B. Non-Financial Resources

- Technology
- Infrastructure
- Equipment
- Expert knowledge
- Mentors
- Trainers
- Research support

- Industry access
- Incubation facilities
- Digital platforms
- Scholarships or in-kind support
- Professional services

—

6. PROPOSED FUNDING SOURCES

NCIE may explore and develop funding opportunities through the following channels:

1. Government & Public-Sector Programmes

Potential areas:

- Innovation
- Entrepreneurship
- Skill development
- Youth development
- Technology
- Education
- Institutional capacity building

Any Government funding shall be subject to the concerned authority's **eligibility criteria, application process, evaluation, sanction and availability of funds.**

—

2. CSR Funding

CSR organisations may support eligible projects relating to:

- Education
- Skills
- Innovation
- Entrepreneurship
- Technology
- Youth development
- Institutional development
- Social impact

CSR funding shall be subject to applicable CSR requirements and corporate approval.

—

3. Industry Partnerships

Industry partners may contribute:

- Sponsorship
- Technology
- Equipment
- Experts
- Mentors
- Training
- Infrastructure
- Industry projects
- Programme support

—

4. Institutional Contributions

Partner institutions may contribute:

- Infrastructure
- Faculty resources
- Programme facilities
- Administrative support
- Technology
- Venue
- Human resources

—

5. Philanthropic & Development Partnerships

Where appropriate, NCIE may explore partnerships with eligible:

- Foundations
- Trusts
- Philanthropic organisations
- Development organisations
- Social-impact organisations

6. Innovation & Startup Ecosystem Resources

Potential resources may include:

- Incubation support
- Accelerator programmes
- Startup support
- Mentorship
- Prototype support
- Investor-readiness programmes
- Ecosystem partnerships

7. GOVERNMENT FUNDING FACILITATION

NCIE may facilitate eligible institutions and programme stakeholders in identifying appropriate Government schemes and developing proposals for relevant funding opportunities.

The process may include:

NEED IDENTIFICATION



SCHEME / PROGRAMME MAPPING



ELIGIBILITY ASSESSMENT



PROJECT PROPOSAL



TECHNICAL REVIEW



APPLICATION / SUBMISSION



GOVERNMENT EVALUATION



SANCTION / APPROVAL



IMPLEMENTATION



REPORTING

NCIE shall not represent a Government funding opportunity as sanctioned or guaranteed unless supported by formal documentation from the concerned Government authority.

—

8. CSR RESOURCE MOBILISATION

NCIE may develop CSR proposals aligned with:

- Corporate CSR priorities
- Eligible thematic areas
- Beneficiary needs
- Institutional requirements
- Measurable outcomes

The CSR mobilisation pathway may be:

CSR MAPPING

→ **PROJECT CONCEPT**

→ **DETAILED PROPOSAL**

→ **CORPORATE DUE DILIGENCE**

→ **CSR REVIEW**

→ **APPROVAL**

→ **AGREEMENT**

→ **RESOURCE SUPPORT**

→ **IMPLEMENTATION**

→ **IMPACT REPORTING**

—

9. INSTITUTIONAL FUNDING FACILITATION

NCIE may support eligible colleges, universities and other educational institutions in developing structured proposals for:

- Innovation Centres
- Incubation Centres
- Innovation Laboratories
- Entrepreneurship Development Cells
- AI & Digital Innovation Facilities
- Student Innovation Programmes
- Startup Development
- Prototype Development
- Faculty Development
- Entrepreneurship Training

Indicative Institutional Funding Requirement

₹5 LAKH – ₹25 LAKH

This range represents an **indicative project-planning and funding-facilitation range**.

It does **not** represent a guaranteed Government grant, Ministry allocation, CSR grant or NCIE-funded amount.

Actual support will depend on:

- Project scope
- Institutional eligibility
- Proposal quality
- Funding source
- Evaluation

- Approval
- Availability of resources
- Applicable guidelines

—

10. STUDENT STARTUP & INNOVATION FUNDING

NCIE may facilitate appropriate support mechanisms for selected student innovators and startups.

Potential support areas include:

- Idea development
- Prototype development
- Proof of concept
- Product development
- Market validation
- Business model development
- Mentorship
- Incubation
- Startup readiness

Indicative Startup Support

Up to ₹5,00,000 per selected startup

Any such support shall be subject to the applicable programme framework, selection criteria, evaluation, availability of resources and formal approval.

—

11. INVESTOR ECOSYSTEM CONNECTIVITY

NCIE may facilitate appropriate ecosystem connectivity for suitable, validated and investor-ready startups.

Potential connections may include:

- Angel investors
- Venture capital organisations
- Corporate investors

- Impact investors
- Startup investment networks
- Other eligible investment ecosystem participants

Indicative Investment Pipeline

Up to ₹25 Crore

The ₹25 crore figure represents an **indicative potential investment pipeline across eligible and investor-ready startup opportunities**, rather than a committed investment fund.

Any investment shall be independently determined by investors following:

- Due diligence
- Commercial assessment
- Financial evaluation
- Market assessment
- Legal review
- Investment negotiations
- Investor approval

—

12. CORPORATE & INDUSTRY RESOURCE MOBILISATION

Industry partners may support NCIE programmes through:

Financial Resources

Sponsorship and approved project contributions.

Technical Resources

Technology, software, equipment and technical infrastructure.

Human Resources

Experts, trainers, mentors and professionals.

Knowledge Resources

Curriculum, research, case studies and industry knowledge.

Infrastructure

Labs, innovation facilities, training facilities and other approved resources.

—

13. KNOWLEDGE & EXPERT RESOURCE MOBILISATION

NCIE may develop expert networks comprising:

- Academicians
- Researchers
- Industry professionals
- Entrepreneurs
- Startup founders
- Technology specialists
- Innovation experts
- Leadership professionals

These resources may support:

- Training
- Mentorship
- Workshops
- Curriculum development
- Innovation evaluation
- Startup validation
- Expert advisory activities

—

14. RESOURCE MOBILISATION PIPELINE

NCIE may follow a structured pipeline:

RESOURCE MAPPING

↓

PARTNER IDENTIFICATION

↓

OPPORTUNITY ASSESSMENT



PROJECT CONCEPT DEVELOPMENT



PROPOSAL DEVELOPMENT



PARTNER / FUNDER ENGAGEMENT



DUE DILIGENCE



APPROVAL / SANCTION



AGREEMENT



RESOURCE MOBILISATION



IMPLEMENTATION



MONITORING



REPORTING

—

15. PROJECT PROPOSAL DEVELOPMENT

Funding proposals may include:

- Executive summary
- Background
- Problem statement
- Need assessment
- Objectives
- Target beneficiaries
- Programme design
- Implementation methodology
- Expected outputs
- Expected outcomes
- Impact indicators
- Budget
- Timeline
- Sustainability plan
- Risk management
- Monitoring framework
- Reporting mechanism

—

16. RESOURCE MOBILISATION FOR COLLEGES & UNIVERSITIES

NCIE may facilitate institutions in preparing project proposals for:

Innovation Infrastructure

- Innovation Labs
- Innovation Centres
- Prototype facilities
- Technology infrastructure

Entrepreneurship Infrastructure

- Incubation Centres
- Entrepreneurship Cells
- Startup support facilities

Student Development

- Innovation programmes
- Entrepreneurship programmes
- Hackathons
- Leadership programmes
- Skill development

Faculty Development

- Faculty training
- Innovation orientation
- Entrepreneurship education
- Technology upskilling

—

17. PROGRAMME-WISE RESOURCE ALLOCATION

Resources may be allocated according to:

- Programme priority
- Beneficiary requirement
- Project scale
- Geographic coverage
- Implementation capacity
- Approved budget
- Funding restrictions
- Expected outcomes

Priority should be given to activities that demonstrate clear programme relevance and measurable outcomes.

—

18. FUNDING AGREEMENT & SANCTION CONTROL

No funding should be treated as confirmed until the relevant:

- Approval
- Sanction
- Funding letter
- Grant agreement
- CSR approval

- MoU
- Project agreement
- Other applicable documentation

has been formally issued by the authorised funding organisation.

—

19. FINANCIAL MANAGEMENT

Mobilised resources shall be managed through appropriate financial controls covering:

- Budgeting
- Accounting
- Authorisation
- Expenditure control
- Documentation
- Bank transactions
- Reconciliation
- Utilisation tracking
- Financial reporting
- Audit

—

20. INTERNAL FINANCIAL CONTROLS

NCIE may maintain controls relating to:

- Segregation of responsibilities
- Approval hierarchy
- Budget controls
- Supporting documentation
- Payment authorisation
- Procurement controls
- Periodic reconciliation
- Financial review
- Internal monitoring

—

21. PROCUREMENT & RESOURCE UTILISATION

Where project resources are used for procurement, procedures should consider:

- Approved budget
- Need assessment
- Vendor selection
- Competitive procurement where appropriate
- Documentation
- Quality verification
- Asset recording
- Payment controls

Procurement shall comply with applicable funding-agreement and organisational requirements.

—

22. RESOURCE TRACKING & MIS

NCIE may maintain a digital Resource Mobilisation MIS covering:

- Funding opportunity
- Funding source
- Proposal status
- Amount requested
- Amount approved
- Amount received
- Project
- Institution
- Beneficiaries
- Utilisation
- Reporting status
- Renewal status

—

23. FUNDING STATUS CLASSIFICATION

To maintain transparency, funding opportunities may be classified as:

Pipeline

Potential opportunity identified.

Proposal Submitted

Formal proposal submitted for consideration.

Under Evaluation

Proposal under review by the funding organisation.

Approved

Formal approval received.

Sanctioned

Formal sanction / funding documentation received.

Received

Funds actually received.

Utilised

Funds utilised according to approved purposes.

This classification prevents **proposed funding from being represented as confirmed funding**.

—

24. RESOURCE MOBILISATION KPIs

Indicative KPIs include:

- Funding opportunities identified
- Proposals developed
- Proposals submitted
- Funding approvals
- Funds mobilised
- CSR partnerships
- Government opportunities pursued

- Industry partnerships
- Institutions supported
- Projects funded
- Non-financial resources mobilised
- Technology resources received
- Expert engagements
- Beneficiaries supported

—

25. THREE-LEVEL RESOURCE MOBILISATION MODEL

LEVEL 1 – PROGRAMME RESOURCES

Resources required for individual programmes.

↓

LEVEL 2 – INSTITUTIONAL RESOURCES

Resources required for colleges, universities and innovation ecosystems.

↓

LEVEL 3 – ECOSYSTEM RESOURCES

Large-scale partnerships involving Government, CSR, industry, investors, incubators and other ecosystem stakeholders.

—

26. RESOURCE DIVERSIFICATION STRATEGY

NCIE should seek to maintain a balanced resource portfolio:

GOVERNMENT PROGRAMMES

-

CSR

-

INDUSTRY

-

INSTITUTIONAL CONTRIBUTIONS

-

PHILANTHROPIC SUPPORT

-

PROGRAMME RESOURCES

-

KNOWLEDGE & TECHNOLOGY RESOURCES

-

ECOSYSTEM PARTNERSHIPS



DIVERSIFIED & SUSTAINABLE RESOURCE BASE

—

27. FINANCIAL SUSTAINABILITY

Long-term sustainability may be strengthened through:

- Multi-year partnerships
- Recurring CSR programmes
- Institutional partnerships
- Strategic industry collaborations
- Sustainable programme models
- Cost-efficient digital delivery
- Resource sharing
- Institutional ownership
- Outcome-based programme expansion
- Diversified funding sources

—

28. RISK MANAGEMENT

Potential resource mobilisation risks include:

- Funding rejection
- Funding delays
- Dependency on one funding source
- Regulatory changes
- Budget shortfalls
- Partner withdrawal
- Cost escalation
- Implementation delays

Mitigation measures may include:

- Diversified funding sources
- Multiple project pipelines
- Contingency planning
- Strong documentation
- Regular financial monitoring
- Partner review
- Phased implementation

—

29. TRANSPARENCY & ACCOUNTABILITY

NCIE shall seek to ensure that:

- Funding claims are supported by documentation.
- Proposed funding is clearly distinguished from approved funding.
- Funding utilisation is properly recorded.
- Project expenditure is traceable.
- Partner requirements are followed.
- Reports are prepared appropriately.
- Government and CSR associations are represented accurately.

—

30. RESOURCE MOBILISATION GOVERNANCE

The resource mobilisation function may involve:

NCIE GOVERNANCE / AUTHORISED MANAGEMENT



RESOURCE MOBILISATION FUNCTION



PROGRAMME MANAGEMENT



FINANCE & ACCOUNTS



PROJECT IMPLEMENTATION TEAM



MONITORING & REPORTING

Major funding arrangements should receive appropriate internal review and approval before commitment.



31. PARTNERSHIP-BASED RESOURCE MOBILISATION

NCIE may establish strategic resource partnerships with:

- Government and public institutions
- Colleges and universities
- Corporates
- CSR organisations
- Industry bodies
- Incubators
- Accelerators
- Investors
- Research organisations
- NGOs
- Foundations
- Technology organisations

The objective is to combine **financial, technical, institutional and knowledge resources**.

—

32. RESOURCE MOBILISATION IMPACT PATHWAY

IDENTIFY NEED



DESIGN PROJECT



MOBILISE RESOURCES



IMPLEMENT PROGRAMME



BUILD CAPACITY



CREATE INNOVATION



SUPPORT ENTREPRENEURSHIP



STRENGTHEN INSTITUTIONS



MEASURE IMPACT



SCALE SUCCESSFUL MODELS

—

33. FRAMEWORK STATEMENT

The NCIE Funding & Resource Mobilisation Framework provides a structured approach for identifying, developing, mobilising and managing financial and non-financial resources required for innovation, entrepreneurship, skills, technology, youth development and institutional capacity-building programmes.

NCIE may directly mobilise resources where legally and operationally appropriate and may facilitate eligible institutions and stakeholders in identifying and accessing suitable Government, CSR, industry, philanthropic, institutional and ecosystem opportunities.

All funding figures, including indicative institutional support of ₹5 lakh–₹25 lakh, startup support of up to ₹5 lakh and potential investor connectivity of up to ₹25 crore, shall be treated as programme planning or facilitation frameworks unless and until formally approved, sanctioned, committed or invested by the concerned funding organisation, Government authority, CSR organisation or investor.

—

34. RESOURCE MOBILISATION MODEL

CONNECT → PROPOSE → MOBILISE → IMPLEMENT → MONITOR → REPORT → IMPACT → SCALE

The framework seeks to establish a sustainable resource ecosystem supporting the progression:

EDUCATION

- **SKILLS**
- **INNOVATION**
- **ENTREPRENEURSHIP**
- **STARTUPS**
- **INSTITUTIONAL DEVELOPMENT**
- **EMPLOYMENT & ENTERPRISE**
- **SOCIAL & ECONOMIC IMPACT**

NCIE's resource mobilisation approach is intended to

strengthen the capacity of institutions, innovators, students and entrepreneurs to access appropriate resources and ecosystem opportunities while maintaining transparency, accountability and compliance.

NCIE Monitoring & Evaluation Framework

NCIE MONITORING & EVALUATION FRAMEWORK

National Council for Innovation & Entrepreneurship (NCIE)

Framework Area: Programme Monitoring, Evaluation, Performance Management & Impact Assessment

—

1. INTRODUCTION

The **NCIE Monitoring & Evaluation (M&E) Framework** provides a structured system for monitoring programme implementation, measuring performance, evaluating outcomes and assessing the impact of NCIE initiatives.

The framework is applicable across NCIE programmes relating to **innovation, entrepreneurship, skill development, AI and digital technologies, leadership, student development, institutional capacity building, incubation, startup development, Government and institutional collaboration, CSR-supported programmes and other eligible initiatives.**

The M&E framework is designed to ensure that programmes are:

- Properly planned
- Effectively implemented
- Regularly monitored
- Measurably evaluated
- Properly documented
- Continuously improved
- Focused on beneficiary outcomes and impact

—

2. PURPOSE OF THE FRAMEWORK

The M&E Framework aims to establish a systematic mechanism for:

- Tracking programme implementation.
- Measuring achievement against approved objectives.

- Monitoring beneficiary participation.
- Assessing programme quality.
- Measuring outputs and outcomes.
- Identifying implementation gaps.
- Supporting evidence-based decision-making.
- Improving programme effectiveness.
- Monitoring resource utilisation.
- Measuring institutional development.
- Tracking innovation and startup progression.
- Assessing social and economic impact.

—

3. M&E PRINCIPLES

NCIE monitoring and evaluation shall be guided by:

Transparency

Programme performance should be supported by appropriate records and evidence.

Accountability

Programme teams should remain responsible for agreed deliverables.

Evidence-Based Assessment

Performance should be assessed using verifiable information wherever practical.

Outcome Orientation

Monitoring should move beyond activity counting towards measurable outcomes.

Continuous Improvement

Monitoring findings should be used to improve programme design and implementation.

Inclusiveness

Beneficiary participation and access should be appropriately monitored.

Data Integrity

Programme information should be accurate, consistent and appropriately managed.

Compliance

Monitoring and reporting should follow applicable programme, funding and institutional requirements.

—

4. M&E LOGIC MODEL

NCIE programmes may be monitored through the following results chain:

INPUTS

↓

ACTIVITIES

↓

OUTPUTS

↓

OUTCOMES

↓

IMPACT

Inputs

Resources invested in the programme.

Examples:

- Financial resources
- Human resources
- Trainers
- Mentors
- Technology
- Infrastructure
- Partnerships

Activities

Actions undertaken under the programme.

Examples:

- Training
- Workshops
- Mentoring
- Hackathons
- Innovation challenges
- Institutional activities
- Startup support

Outputs

Immediate measurable deliverables.

Examples:

- Participants trained
- Sessions conducted
- Institutions onboarded
- Projects developed
- Mentorship sessions completed

Outcomes

Changes resulting from programme participation.

Examples:

- Improved skills
- Increased innovation capability
- Improved entrepreneurial readiness
- Ideas validated
- Startups progressed
- Institutional capacity strengthened

Impact

Longer-term contribution.

Examples:

- Innovation ecosystem development

- Enterprise creation
- Employment-related outcomes where verifiable
- Institutional transformation
- Social and economic contribution

—

5. M&E FRAMEWORK

The overall monitoring system follows:

PLAN

↓

IMPLEMENT

↓

MONITOR

↓

VERIFY

↓

EVALUATE

↓

REPORT

↓

IMPROVE

↓

SCALE

—

6. MONITORING LEVELS

NCIE may conduct monitoring at multiple levels.

Level 1 – Participant Monitoring

Tracking:

- Registration
- Attendance
- Participation
- Course completion
- Assessments
- Certification

Level 2 – Programme Monitoring

Tracking:

- Activities
- Sessions
- Trainers
- Mentors
- Outputs
- Timelines
- Programme quality

Level 3 – Institutional Monitoring

Tracking:

- Institutions onboarded
- Institutional activities
- Innovation infrastructure
- Faculty participation
- Student engagement
- Institutional outcomes

Level 4 – Project Monitoring

Tracking:

- Project milestones
- Innovation projects

- Startup development
- Prototype progress
- Funding utilisation where applicable

Level 5 – Impact Monitoring

Assessing:

- Outcomes
- Sustainability
- Innovation results
- Enterprise progression
- Social and economic impact

—

7. KEY PERFORMANCE INDICATORS (KPIs)

NCIE may establish programme-specific KPIs covering:

Participation

- Registrations
- Active participants
- Attendance rate
- Completion rate

Training

- Training sessions
- Training hours
- Participants trained
- Certification rate

Innovation

- Ideas submitted
- Innovation projects
- Prototypes developed
- Projects validated

Entrepreneurship

- Entrepreneurship participants
- Business concepts developed
- Startups formed
- Startups supported

Institutional Development

- Institutions onboarded
- Innovation centres supported
- Innovation labs established
- Faculty trained

Partnerships

- Academic partners
- Industry partners
- CSR partners
- Knowledge partners
- Ecosystem partners

Impact

- Skill improvement
- Innovation progression
- Startup progression
- Institutional capability improvement
- Employment or enterprise outcomes where verifiable

—

8. OUTPUT INDICATORS

Output indicators measure direct programme deliverables.

Examples include:

Programme Area	Indicative Output Indicators
Training	Participants trained, sessions conducted
Internship	Interns enrolled, projects completed
Innovation	Ideas submitted, projects developed

Hackathons	Teams participating, solutions presented
Entrepreneurship	Participants trained, business concepts developed
Mentorship	Mentorship sessions, mentees supported
Incubation	Startups/incubation projects supported
Institution Development	Institutions onboarded, facilities supported
Faculty Development	Faculty trained, workshops completed
Scholarships	Beneficiaries supported, scholarships processed

—

9. OUTCOME INDICATORS

Outcome indicators measure changes resulting from programme participation.

Potential indicators include:

- Improvement in participant knowledge.
- Improvement in technical skills.
- Improvement in digital capability.
- Improvement in entrepreneurial readiness.
- Increased innovation capability.
- Successful idea validation.
- Prototype development.
- Startup progression.
- Increased institutional innovation activity.
- Increased industry engagement.
- Improved mentoring access.

Where outcomes are reported, appropriate evidence should be maintained.

—

10. IMPACT INDICATORS

Longer-term impact may be assessed through:

Economic Impact

- Enterprise development
- Startup progression
- Employment-related outcomes where verifiable
- Entrepreneurial activity

Educational Impact

- Student capability development
- Faculty capacity building
- Institutional innovation activity

Innovation Impact

- Solutions developed
- Prototypes
- Technology adoption
- Innovation projects progressing towards implementation

Social Impact

- Beneficiary reach
- Inclusion
- Community-oriented innovation
- Youth participation

—

11. BASELINE & TARGET SETTING

Where appropriate, programmes should establish:

Baseline

Existing condition before programme intervention.

Target

Expected level of achievement.

Actual

Measured result achieved.

Variance

Difference between target and actual performance.

Example:

Target: 1,000 participants

Actual: 920 participants

Achievement: 92%

This allows programme managers to identify performance gaps and corrective actions.

—

12. PROGRAMME MONITORING CYCLE

NCIE may use:

Daily / Session-Level Monitoring

- Attendance
- Trainer activity
- Session completion
- Participant engagement

Monthly Monitoring

- Programme progress
- KPI achievement
- Institutional participation
- Resource utilisation

Quarterly Review

- Output achievement
- Outcome progress
- Financial performance
- Partner performance
- Implementation challenges

Annual Evaluation

- Programme effectiveness
- Outcome achievement
- Impact
- Sustainability
- Future programme requirements

The actual frequency may vary according to programme size and funding requirements.

—

13. DIGITAL MONITORING & MIS

NCIE may maintain a digital **Management Information System (MIS)** to support:

- Registration
- Attendance
- Participant tracking
- Institution tracking
- Programme activity
- Certification
- Trainer management
- Mentor management
- KPI monitoring
- Project tracking
- Funding tracking
- Reporting

The MIS may provide dashboards for authorised programme-management personnel.

—

14. BENEFICIARY TRACKING

Participant-level information may include, as appropriate:

- Registration details
- Institution

- Programme
- Participation
- Attendance
- Assessment
- Completion
- Certification
- Innovation/project participation
- Mentorship
- Startup progression

Data collection should follow applicable privacy, consent and institutional requirements.

—

15. ATTENDANCE MONITORING

Depending on delivery mode, attendance may be recorded through:

Online

- Digital attendance
- Learning-platform participation
- Session records

Offline

- Physical attendance
- Institutional attendance records
- Programme registers

Hybrid

- Combined digital and physical records.

Attendance requirements should be defined according to the specific programme.

—

16. TRAINING & LEARNING ASSESSMENT

Where applicable, learning effectiveness may be assessed through:

- Pre-assessment
- Post-assessment
- Assignments
- Projects
- Presentations
- Practical activities
- Participant feedback

Learning Improvement

Where comparable assessments are used:

PRE-PROGRAMME PERFORMANCE

→

TRAINING

→

POST-PROGRAMME PERFORMANCE

→

LEARNING GAIN

—

17. INNOVATION PROJECT MONITORING

Innovation projects may be monitored through milestones such as:

IDEA

↓

PROBLEM DEFINITION

↓

SOLUTION DESIGN

↓

PROTOTYPE

↓

TESTING



VALIDATION



PRESENTATION



IMPLEMENTATION / INCUBATION

This framework may be adapted to individual programme requirements.



18. STARTUP PROGRESSION MONITORING

Selected startup initiatives may be tracked through:

- Idea stage
- Validation
- Prototype
- Product development
- Market testing
- Business model
- Incubation
- Investor readiness
- Investment discussions
- Scale-up

Investor discussions should not be recorded as investment unless investment has actually been formally committed or completed.



19. INSTITUTIONAL PERFORMANCE MONITORING

Participating institutions may be monitored against:

- Programme participation
- Student engagement
- Faculty participation

- Innovation activities
 - Entrepreneurship activities
 - Industry interaction
 - Innovation infrastructure
 - Startup activity
 - Institutional outcomes
-

20. PARTNERSHIP PERFORMANCE MONITORING

Partnerships may be reviewed using:

- Agreed deliverables
 - Activities completed
 - Resources contributed
 - Beneficiary reach
 - Programme outcomes
 - Reporting compliance
 - Partner participation
 - Sustainability
-

21. FINANCIAL MONITORING

Where applicable, financial monitoring may include:

- Approved budget
- Expenditure
- Balance
- Budget variance
- Resource utilisation
- Project-wise expenditure
- Funding-source restrictions
- Supporting documentation

Financial monitoring should remain aligned with applicable funding agreements and internal financial controls.

—

22. DATA QUALITY & VERIFICATION

NCIE may establish procedures for:

- Data validation
- Duplicate detection
- Record verification
- Attendance verification
- Beneficiary verification
- Document verification
- Periodic data review

Where programme claims are published, appropriate supporting evidence should be maintained.

—

23. FIELD & INSTITUTIONAL VERIFICATION

Where programmes involve physical implementation, monitoring may include:

- Institutional visits
- Programme observations
- Beneficiary interaction
- Document verification
- Activity verification
- Infrastructure verification
- Photographic documentation where appropriate

—

24. PARTICIPANT FEEDBACK

Feedback may be collected regarding:

- Programme quality
- Trainers
- Mentors
- Curriculum
- Digital platform
- Learning experience

- Institutional support
- Programme relevance

Feedback may be used to improve future programme delivery.

—

25. GRIEVANCE & FEEDBACK MECHANISM

Participants and institutional partners may be provided appropriate channels for:

- Complaints
- Suggestions
- Programme-related issues
- Certification issues
- Registration issues
- Attendance concerns
- Institutional concerns

Complaints should be appropriately recorded and addressed through the designated mechanism.

—

26. EVALUATION METHODS

Depending on programme requirements, evaluation may use:

- Quantitative indicators
- Qualitative assessment
- Participant surveys
- Pre/post assessments
- Interviews
- Focus-group discussions
- Case studies
- Institutional reviews
- Project evaluations
- Outcome tracking

—

27. MID-TERM REVIEW

For longer-duration programmes, an interim review may assess:

- Progress against targets
- Implementation quality
- Resource utilisation
- Beneficiary participation
- Emerging challenges
- Corrective requirements

Findings may be used to modify implementation where appropriate.

—

28. END-OF-PROGRAMME EVALUATION

Programme completion evaluation may assess:

- Objectives achieved
- Outputs delivered
- Outcomes achieved
- Beneficiary satisfaction
- Resource utilisation
- Implementation efficiency
- Challenges
- Sustainability
- Lessons learned

—

29. IMPACT ASSESSMENT

Impact assessment may examine whether programme interventions have contributed to longer-term changes.

Potential areas:

STUDENT DEVELOPMENT



SKILL DEVELOPMENT



INNOVATION CAPABILITY



ENTREPRENEURIAL CAPABILITY



STARTUP DEVELOPMENT



INSTITUTIONAL STRENGTHENING



SOCIAL & ECONOMIC CONTRIBUTION



30. REPORTING FRAMEWORK

NCIE may prepare:

- Session reports
- Monthly reports
- Quarterly progress reports
- Annual programme reports
- Project completion reports
- Financial reports
- Partner reports
- Impact reports

Reporting requirements may be adapted according to the specific programme and funding agreement.



31. M&E REPORTING STRUCTURE

A standard programme report may include:

1. Programme overview
2. Objectives
3. Activities completed
4. Beneficiary details
5. Attendance
6. KPI performance
7. Output achievement
8. Outcome progress
9. Financial status, where applicable
10. Challenges
11. Corrective actions
12. Success stories
13. Evidence
14. Lessons learned
15. Recommendations

—

32. PERFORMANCE DASHBOARD

An NCIE programme dashboard may monitor:

Indicator	Target	Actual	Achievement	Status
Participants	—	—	—	—
Institutions	—	—	—	—
Training Sessions	—	—	—	—
Innovation Projects	—	—	—	—
Mentorship Sessions	—	—	—	—
Startups Supported	—	—	—	—
Partnerships	—	—	—	—

Actual targets should be determined separately for each programme.

—

33. CORRECTIVE ACTION MECHANISM

Where performance falls below agreed targets:

PERFORMANCE GAP



CAUSE ANALYSIS



CORRECTIVE ACTION PLAN



RESPONSIBLE PERSON / TEAM



TIMELINE



FOLLOW-UP



REASSESSMENT

This enables continuous programme improvement.



34. SUCCESS STORY & CASE STUDY FRAMEWORK

Selected programme outcomes may be documented through case studies covering:

- Beneficiary background
- Initial situation
- Programme intervention
- Skills or support received
- Innovation/project development
- Outcome

- Evidence
- Longer-term progression

Case studies should be published only with appropriate permissions and factual verification.

—

35. RISK-BASED MONITORING

Higher-risk programmes or projects may receive enhanced monitoring based on:

- Programme scale
- Funding value
- Geographic coverage
- Implementation complexity
- Number of beneficiaries
- Partner complexity
- Regulatory requirements

—

36. INDEPENDENT EVALUATION

Where appropriate, significant programmes may be subjected to independent evaluation by qualified external experts or organisations.

Independent evaluation may be particularly useful for:

- Large-scale programmes
- Multi-year projects
- CSR-supported programmes
- Institutional development initiatives
- Programmes requiring formal impact assessment

—

37. M&E GOVERNANCE

The monitoring structure may include:

NCIE GOVERNANCE / AUTHORISED MANAGEMENT



PROGRAMME MANAGEMENT



M&E / MONITORING FUNCTION



STATE / REGIONAL / DISTRICT COORDINATION



INSTITUTIONAL NODAL PERSON



TRAINERS / MENTORS / FIELD TEAMS



BENEFICIARY DATA & PROGRAMME RECORDS

Roles shall be defined according to the size and nature of each programme.

—

38. M&E RESPONSIBILITIES

Programme Management

- Define programme targets.
- Monitor implementation.
- Review performance.
- Take corrective action.

M&E Function

- Develop indicators.
- Collect and analyse data.
- Maintain monitoring reports.
- Verify performance information.

Institutional Coordinators

- Maintain participation records.
- Support beneficiary verification.
- Report institutional activities.

Trainers & Mentors

- Record session delivery.
- Assess participant progress.
- Provide feedback.

Finance Function

- Monitor approved budgets.
- Track expenditure.
- Maintain financial documentation.

—

39. M&E DATA FLOW

BENEFICIARY / INSTITUTION



PROGRAMME TEAM



DIGITAL / PHYSICAL RECORD



M&E SYSTEM



DATA VALIDATION



KPI DASHBOARD



MANAGEMENT REVIEW



CORRECTIVE ACTION



PROGRAMME REPORT



40. ANNUAL PROGRAMME REVIEW

An annual review may consider:

- Programme performance
- Beneficiary reach
- KPI achievement
- Output and outcome results
- Financial performance
- Partnership performance
- Impact
- Risks
- Sustainability
- Lessons learned

The review may inform the next year's programme planning and resource allocation.



41. M&E DOCUMENTATION & EVIDENCE

Programme evidence may include:

- Registration records
- Attendance
- Assessment records
- Certificates
- Project reports
- Photographs
- Videos
- Institutional records
- Financial records

- Utilisation documentation
- Partner reports
- Feedback forms
- Impact studies

Documentation should be retained according to applicable organisational, legal and funding requirements.

—

42. DATA PRIVACY & RESPONSIBLE USE

Beneficiary information should be collected and processed responsibly.

Appropriate safeguards should cover:

- Consent where required
- Data minimisation
- Access control
- Confidentiality
- Secure storage
- Responsible sharing
- Retention and disposal

Personal information should not be publicly disclosed unnecessarily.

—

43. CONTINUOUS IMPROVEMENT FRAMEWORK

NCIE may follow:

MONITOR

→ **ANALYSE**

→ **LEARN**

→ **IMPROVE**

→ **IMPLEMENT**

→ **RE-MONITOR**

This creates a continuous programme improvement cycle.

–

44. M&E MATURITY MODEL

NCIE's monitoring systems may progressively develop through:

Stage 1 – Activity Monitoring

Tracking whether activities occurred.

Stage 2 – Output Monitoring

Measuring immediate programme results.

Stage 3 – Outcome Monitoring

Measuring changes among beneficiaries.

Stage 4 – Impact Assessment

Assessing longer-term effects.

Stage 5 – Evidence-Based Programme Management

Using data and evaluation findings to continuously improve programme design and resource allocation.

–

45. OVERALL RESULTS FRAMEWORK

NCIE programmes follow the broader pathway:

RESOURCES

↓

ACTIVITIES

↓

OUTPUTS



OUTCOMES



IMPACT

with the continuous cycle:

MONITOR → EVALUATE → LEARN → IMPROVE → SCALE

—

46. FRAMEWORK STATEMENT

The NCIE Monitoring & Evaluation Framework provides a systematic and outcome-oriented mechanism for tracking programme implementation, measuring performance, assessing outputs and outcomes, documenting evidence and evaluating the longer-term contribution of NCIE initiatives.

The framework is intended to strengthen transparency, accountability, programme quality and continuous improvement across NCIE's innovation, entrepreneurship, skill development, leadership, technology, institutional development and youth-focused initiatives.

NCIE M&E PATHWAY

**PLAN → IMPLEMENT → MONITOR → VERIFY → EVALUATE
→ REPORT → IMPROVE → IMPACT**

The ultimate objective of the framework is to ensure that NCIE programmes are implemented in a structured manner and that programme decisions are increasingly informed by measurable evidence, beneficiary outcomes and demonstrated impact.

NCIE Transparency & Public Disclosure Policy

NCIE TRANSPARENCY & PUBLIC DISCLOSURE POLICY

National Council for Innovation & Entrepreneurship (NCIE)

Policy Area: Transparency, Public Information, Disclosure, Accountability & Responsible Communication

–

1. INTRODUCTION

The **NCIE Transparency & Public Disclosure Policy** establishes the principles and procedures through which the **National Council for Innovation & Entrepreneurship (NCIE)** communicates institutional, programme, partnership, financial and operational information to students, educational institutions, Government and public-sector stakeholders, industry partners, CSR organisations, innovators, entrepreneurs, beneficiaries and the general public.

The policy is intended to promote **transparency, accountability, accuracy, responsible communication and public confidence** while protecting confidential, personal, commercially sensitive and legally protected information.

NCIE shall seek to ensure that information published through its official website, programme documents, notices, reports and other authorised communication channels is **accurate, appropriately classified and supported by relevant documentation**.

–

2. POLICY OBJECTIVES

The policy aims to:

- Promote institutional transparency.
- Provide accessible and meaningful public information.
- Improve accountability in programme implementation.
- Clearly communicate NCIE's programmes and activities.
- Distinguish approved information from proposals and planned initiatives.

- Promote responsible disclosure of funding and partnership information.
- Provide appropriate information regarding institutional collaborations.
- Support public understanding of programme eligibility and processes.
- Protect confidential and personal information.
- Establish a consistent public communication framework.
- Reduce the possibility of misleading or unverified representations.

—

3. SCOPE OF THE POLICY

This policy applies to information published or communicated through:

- NCIE official website
- Programme pages
- Institutional documents
- Annual reports
- Programme reports
- Public notices
- Press releases
- Official announcements
- Social-media communication
- Brochures and publications
- Institutional presentations
- Partnership communications
- Public programme documentation

—

4. TRANSPARENCY PRINCIPLES

NCIE's public disclosures shall be guided by the following principles:

Accuracy

Information should be factually accurate and appropriately verified before publication.

Clarity

Information should be presented in language that beneficiaries and stakeholders can reasonably understand.

Timeliness

Important programme updates should be published within an appropriate timeframe.

Accountability

Public statements concerning programmes, partnerships, funding or institutional activities should be traceable to appropriate records.

Consistency

The same programme or institutional information should not be represented differently across official communication channels without an appropriate explanation or update.

Responsible Disclosure

Only information appropriate for public disclosure should be published.

Privacy

Personal and sensitive information of beneficiaries, employees, partners and other individuals should be appropriately protected.

—

5. OFFICIAL INFORMATION CATEGORIES

NCIE may publicly disclose appropriate information under the following categories:

A. Institutional Information

- Institutional profile
- Vision and mission
- Objectives
- Organisational structure
- Governance framework
- Programme framework

- Institutional policies
- Official contact information

B. Programme Information

- Programme objectives
- Programme descriptions
- Eligibility
- Duration
- Delivery model
- Curriculum
- Registration process
- Programme fees, where applicable
- Certification criteria
- Important dates

C. Partnership Information

Where authorised and appropriately documented:

- Collaboration announcements
- Institutional partnerships
- MoUs
- Programme partnerships
- Industry collaborations
- Academic partnerships
- CSR partnerships
- Government or public-sector engagement

D. Financial & Resource Information

Where appropriate:

- Approved project budgets
- Funding received
- Project expenditure
- Annual financial information
- Funding utilisation information
- CSR-supported projects
- Resource mobilisation information

The level of disclosure shall depend on applicable legal, contractual and

confidentiality requirements.

–

6. OFFICIAL DOCUMENT DISCLOSURE

Where appropriate, NCIE may publish or provide access to:

- Institutional policies
- Programme guidelines
- Annual reports
- Programme reports
- Public notices
- Approved partnership documents
- Programme brochures
- Institutional reports
- Impact reports
- Public financial information
- Relevant certificates or registration documentation where lawful and appropriate

Confidential or sensitive portions of documents may be withheld or redacted where necessary.

–

7. GOVERNMENT & PUBLIC-SECTOR DISCLOSURE

Any reference to a **Government Ministry, Department, public authority or Government-supported programme** shall accurately describe the nature of the relationship.

NCIE shall distinguish between:

Official Collaboration

Supported by an appropriate formal document or authorised communication.

Programme Alignment

A programme is aligned with a Government policy, mission or national priority but is not necessarily operated by the Government.

Funding Facilitation

NCIE assists an eligible institution or project in identifying or pursuing a potential Government funding opportunity.

Funding Approval

Formal approval or sanction has been issued by the relevant authority.

These categories should not be represented interchangeably.

—

8. GOVERNMENT LOGOS & OFFICIAL IDENTIFIERS

Government emblems, logos, seals, official marks and institutional identifiers shall be used only where their use is legally authorised or otherwise permitted.

NCIE shall not use Government branding in a manner that could reasonably create the impression that NCIE itself is a Government department, ministry or statutory authority unless such status is formally established and supported by appropriate documentation.

Where a programme is merely **aligned with a Government initiative**, the communication should clearly state the nature of the alignment.

—

9. FUNDING DISCLOSURE POLICY

NCIE shall clearly distinguish different funding statuses.

Funding Opportunity

A potential funding source has been identified.

Funding Pipeline

A proposal or potential funding opportunity is under consideration or development.

Proposal Submitted

A formal proposal has been submitted to a funding organisation.

Under Evaluation

The proposal is being considered by the relevant organisation.

Approved / Sanctioned

Formal approval or sanction has been received.

Funds Received

The approved funds have actually been received.

Funds Utilised

Funds have been utilised for the approved purpose.

This classification is intended to prevent **proposed or potential funding from being represented as confirmed funding**.

—

10. CSR DISCLOSURE

CSR partnerships and funding shall be publicly represented only to the extent authorised and supported by appropriate documentation.

Where applicable, disclosures may include:

- CSR partner name
- Project name
- Project objectives
- Project period
- Nature of support
- Beneficiary group
- Approved project value, where publicly disclosable
- Implementation status
- Outcomes

Corporate confidential information shall not be disclosed without appropriate authorisation.

—

11. INVESTOR & STARTUP DISCLOSURE

NCIE may disclose information relating to startup ecosystem and investor connectivity where appropriate.

Any statement concerning potential investment shall clearly distinguish:

Investor Interest

from

Investment Discussion

from

Investment Commitment

from

Investment Completed

For example, an **indicative investment pipeline of up to ₹25 crore** shall be described as potential ecosystem connectivity or pipeline facilitation and shall not be represented as a guaranteed investment fund or committed capital unless formal documentation supports such a claim.

—

12. STARTUP SUPPORT DISCLOSURE

Where programmes provide indicative startup support such as:

Up to ₹5 Lakh

the public information should clearly state that such support is subject to:

- Eligibility
- Selection
- Evaluation
- Programme guidelines
- Availability of resources
- Approval
- Applicable conditions

Indicative support shall not be represented as an automatic entitlement.

–

13. INSTITUTIONAL FUNDING DISCLOSURE

Where NCIE facilitates eligible colleges and universities in pursuing institutional funding in an indicative range such as:

₹5 Lakh – ₹25 Lakh

the website and programme documents should clearly state that this represents a **potential funding-support or facilitation framework**.

It should not be represented as:

- Guaranteed Government funding
- Guaranteed Ministry funding
- Guaranteed CSR funding
- Automatic institutional grant
- Guaranteed NCIE funding

unless formally approved and supported by appropriate documentation.

–

14. PARTNERSHIP DISCLOSURE

NCIE may publicly announce partnerships only after appropriate internal authorisation and confirmation of the relationship.

Partnership information may include:

- Partner name
- Nature of partnership
- Programme
- Purpose
- Duration
- Responsibilities
- Geographic scope
- Publicly approved outcomes

Where a partnership is under discussion but not formally executed, it

should be described as **proposed, prospective or under discussion**, as appropriate.

—

15. MOUs & COLLABORATION DOCUMENTS

Where legally permissible, NCIE may disclose:

- MoUs
- Collaboration agreements
- Partnership letters
- Institutional collaboration documents
- Project agreements
- Government correspondence
- Sanction letters
- Approval documents

Publication shall depend on:

- Confidentiality clauses
- Consent of the parties
- Legal restrictions
- Commercial sensitivity
- Data-protection requirements

—

16. PROGRAMME FEE DISCLOSURE

Programme pages should clearly communicate:

- Registration fee
- Programme fee
- Payment conditions
- Refund policy where applicable
- Eligibility
- Duration
- Delivery mode
- Certification conditions

For example, where a programme has a **₹700 participation fee**, the

website should clearly state what the fee covers and whether any additional charges apply.

—

17. SCHOLARSHIP & BENEFICIARY DISCLOSURE

Public communication concerning scholarships and beneficiary programmes should provide appropriate information regarding:

- Eligibility
- Selection criteria
- Application process
- Important dates
- Scholarship amount where applicable
- Selection process
- Documentation requirements

Personal information of beneficiaries should not be publicly disclosed without appropriate consent or lawful basis.

—

18. PERSONAL DATA PROTECTION

NCIE shall seek to protect personal information including, where applicable:

- Names
- Contact details
- Identification information
- Bank information
- Academic records
- Photographs
- Addresses
- Personal documents

Personal data shall be disclosed only where necessary, authorised and legally permissible.

—

19. CONFIDENTIAL INFORMATION

The following categories may require restricted access:

- Personal information
- Bank details
- Confidential contracts
- Commercially sensitive information
- Proprietary technology
- Unpublished research
- Internal assessments
- Confidential Government correspondence
- Investor due-diligence information
- Sensitive employee information
- Security-related information

20. PUBLIC DISCLOSURE REGISTER

NCIE may maintain a public disclosure register containing appropriate records such as:

Category	Disclosure
Institutional	Institutional profile and policies
Programmes	Programme descriptions and guidelines
Partnerships	Confirmed public partnerships
Government	Documented engagements
CSR	Authorised CSR projects
Reports	Annual / programme reports
Finance	Publicly disclosable financial information
Impact	Programme outcomes and impact

Notices Official announcements

—

21. WEBSITE DISCLOSURE STRUCTURE

The NCIE website may provide dedicated sections for:

About NCIE

Institutional profile and organisational information.

Programmes

Programme descriptions, eligibility and participation information.

Government & Institutional Engagement

Documented collaborations and institutional engagements.

Partnerships

Academic, industry, CSR and ecosystem partnerships.

Reports & Publications

Annual reports, programme reports and public documents.

Financial & Funding Information

Appropriate public financial and funding information.

Policies

Institutional policies and guidelines.

Notices & Announcements

Official programme and institutional updates.

Contact & Grievance

Official communication and grievance channels.

—

22. PUBLIC DISCLOSURE REVIEW PROCESS

Before publication of significant institutional information:

INFORMATION PREPARATION



DOCUMENT VERIFICATION



PROGRAMME / DEPARTMENT REVIEW



LEGAL / COMPLIANCE REVIEW WHERE REQUIRED



AUTHORISATION



PUBLICATION



PERIODIC REVIEW



23. CONTENT VERIFICATION

Information should be reviewed for:

- Accuracy
- Source documentation
- Dates
- Names
- Funding status
- Partnership status
- Financial figures
- Programme eligibility
- Legal terminology

- Government references
- Contact information

—

24. CORRECTION & UPDATE POLICY

Where materially incorrect information is identified, NCIE should:

1. Review the information.
2. Verify the correct position.
3. Correct the publication.
4. Record the correction where appropriate.
5. Update related documents if necessary.

Material corrections should not be concealed where transparency requires acknowledgement.

—

25. VERSION CONTROL

Important public documents may include:

- Document title
- Version number
- Effective date
- Publication date
- Revision date
- Issuing authority

This enables stakeholders to identify the current version of a document.

—

26. PUBLIC NOTICE & ANNOUNCEMENT POLICY

Official announcements should, where applicable, contain:

- Announcement title
- Date
- Programme / subject
- Relevant details

- Effective date
- Contact information
- Issuing authority

Announcements should not contain unsupported claims.

—

27. SOCIAL MEDIA DISCLOSURE

NCIE's social-media communication should follow the same principles applicable to official website communication.

Social-media posts should not:

- Misrepresent Government affiliation.
- Claim unapproved funding as sanctioned.
- Present potential investment as guaranteed.
- Publish confidential information.
- Publish personal information without appropriate permission.
- Make unsupported claims concerning beneficiaries or outcomes.

—

28. MEDIA & PRESS COMMUNICATION

Press releases and public statements should be issued through authorised channels.

Major claims regarding:

- Government collaboration
- Funding
- CSR support
- Institutional partnerships
- Startup investment
- Programme achievements

should be supported by appropriate records.

—

29. ANNUAL TRANSPARENCY REPORT

Where appropriate, NCIE may publish an annual transparency or institutional report covering:

- Programmes implemented
- Beneficiary reach
- Institutional partnerships
- Government / public-sector engagements
- CSR-supported initiatives
- Resource mobilisation
- Programme outcomes
- Impact highlights
- Financial information where appropriate
- Major institutional developments

—

30. DISCLOSURE OF PROGRAMME PERFORMANCE

Programme performance may be reported through:

- Participation statistics
- Completion rates
- Training outputs
- Innovation projects
- Startup progression
- Institutional outcomes
- Partnership activities
- Impact indicators

Published statistics should be based on available records and should clearly identify the relevant reporting period.

—

31. PUBLIC ACCESS TO INFORMATION

NCIE shall seek to make relevant institutional and programme information reasonably accessible through its official communication channels.

Public information may include:

- Programme guidelines

- Eligibility
- Registration process
- Contact information
- Policies
- Notices
- Reports
- Confirmed partnerships
- Public institutional documents

Access may be restricted where information is confidential, legally protected or otherwise inappropriate for public disclosure.

—

32. GRIEVANCE & FEEDBACK

Stakeholders may be provided with channels to raise:

- Incorrect information concerns
- Programme-related complaints
- Registration issues
- Certification issues
- Partnership-related concerns
- Disclosure concerns
- Other institutional feedback

Complaints should be recorded and addressed through the appropriate internal mechanism.

—

33. ACCOUNTABILITY FOR PUBLIC INFORMATION

Responsibility for public disclosures may be distributed across:

AUTHORISED NCIE MANAGEMENT

↓

COMMUNICATION / DOCUMENTATION FUNCTION

↓

PROGRAMME MANAGEMENT



FINANCE / ADMINISTRATION



LEGAL / COMPLIANCE REVIEW WHERE REQUIRED



OFFICIAL PUBLICATION CHANNEL

No unauthorised individual should represent personal statements as official NCIE institutional positions.



34. TRANSPARENCY IN PROGRAMME CLAIMS

NCIE shall seek to use precise terminology such as:

- **“Implemented”** only where implementation has occurred.
- **“Approved”** where formal approval exists.
- **“Proposed”** for proposals.
- **“Planned”** for future activities.
- **“Facilitated”** where NCIE provides facilitation.
- **“Aligned with”** where a programme is aligned with a policy or national priority.
- **“In partnership with”** where a formal partnership exists.
- **“Potential”** for opportunities that are not confirmed.
- **“Indicative”** for planning or pipeline figures.



35. PROHIBITED OR RESTRICTED REPRESENTATIONS

NCIE public communications should not knowingly:

- Claim Government status without legal basis.
- Claim statutory authority without supporting documentation.
- Represent a proposed programme as an officially sanctioned

Government programme.

- Represent potential funding as confirmed funding.
- Represent investor pipeline figures as committed capital.
- Represent prospective partnerships as executed partnerships.
- Publish fabricated statistics.
- Misrepresent beneficiary outcomes.
- Use Government insignia without appropriate authority.
- Publish confidential information.
- Make guarantees that are not supported by programme terms.

—

36. TRANSPARENCY & FUNDING STATUS MODEL

IDENTIFIED

Potential opportunity identified.

↓

PROPOSED

Project or funding concept developed.

↓

SUBMITTED

Proposal submitted.

↓

UNDER REVIEW

Proposal under evaluation.

↓

APPROVED

Formal approval received.

↓

SANCTIONED

Formal sanction / agreement received.



RECEIVED

Resources received.



UTILISED

Resources utilised for the approved purpose.

This model should be used consistently in public funding communications.



37. PARTNERSHIP STATUS MODEL

DISCUSSION

Initial engagement.



PROPOSED

Partnership concept under development.



NEGOTIATION

Terms under discussion.



EXECUTED

Formal agreement completed.



ACTIVE

Partnership being implemented.

**COMPLETED**

Agreed activities completed.

—

38. DISCLOSURE & COMPLIANCE REVIEW

NCIE may periodically review its public information for:

- Accuracy
- Completeness
- Outdated information
- Government references
- Partnership claims
- Funding claims
- Programme information
- Legal notices
- Privacy compliance

—

39. RECORD RETENTION

Supporting records for significant public disclosures should be retained for an appropriate period in accordance with:

- Applicable law
- Funding requirements
- Partnership agreements
- Organisational policies
- Financial requirements
- Documentation requirements

—

40. TRANSPARENCY PERFORMANCE INDICATORS

NCIE may monitor:

- Number of public reports published
- Programme information updated
- Partnership disclosures completed
- Funding-status updates
- Financial reporting completion
- Grievances received
- Grievances resolved
- Public information corrections
- Website document updates
- Annual disclosure completion

—

41. POLICY REVIEW

This policy should be reviewed periodically to reflect:

- Changes in applicable law
- Regulatory developments
- Organisational changes
- New programme requirements
- Funding-partner requirements
- Data-protection requirements
- Lessons from implementation

—

42. OVERALL TRANSPARENCY MODEL

NCIE's public disclosure framework follows:

VERIFY

↓

CLASSIFY

↓

AUTHORISE



DISCLOSE



MONITOR



UPDATE



CORRECT



REPORT



43. POLICY STATEMENT

NCIE is committed to maintaining a transparent, accountable and responsible public-information system through which stakeholders can access appropriate information concerning its institutional profile, programmes, partnerships, funding frameworks, activities, outcomes and policies.

NCIE shall seek to distinguish clearly between confirmed information, approved activities, proposed initiatives, funding opportunities, facilitation activities, investment pipelines and future plans.

All public disclosures shall be subject to appropriate verification, authorisation, confidentiality requirements, privacy considerations and applicable legal and regulatory obligations.



44. FINAL TRANSPARENCY COMMITMENT

ACCURATE INFORMATION

DOCUMENTED CLAIMS

CLEAR FUNDING STATUS

RESPONSIBLE GOVERNMENT REFERENCES

AUTHORISED PARTNERSHIP DISCLOSURE

PROTECTED PERSONAL INFORMATION

ACCOUNTABLE REPORTING

CONTINUOUS UPDATES

The NCIE Transparency & Public Disclosure Policy is intended to strengthen public confidence by ensuring that institutional information is communicated accurately, funding and partnership claims are appropriately qualified, programme achievements are supported by evidence, and confidential or personal information is protected.

NCIE Grievance Redressal Policy

NCIE GRIEVANCE REDRESSAL POLICY

National Council for Innovation & Entrepreneurship (NCIE)

Policy Area: Grievance Handling, Complaints, Feedback, Appeals & Stakeholder Protection

—

1. INTRODUCTION

The **NCIE Grievance Redressal Policy** establishes a structured, accessible and transparent mechanism for receiving, registering, examining and resolving grievances and complaints relating to NCIE programmes, services, institutional activities, partnerships and authorised operations.

The policy is intended to provide students, trainees, innovators, entrepreneurs, educational institutions, faculty members, mentors, trainers, employees, partners, beneficiaries and other stakeholders with an appropriate mechanism to raise concerns and receive a fair and timely response.

NCIE shall seek to handle grievances in a manner that promotes **fairness, confidentiality, accountability, non-discrimination, transparency and continuous improvement**.

—

2. OBJECTIVES

The policy aims to:

- Provide an accessible grievance mechanism.
- Enable stakeholders to submit complaints and concerns.
- Ensure grievances are properly recorded and tracked.
- Establish a structured review and resolution process.
- Provide appropriate acknowledgement and responses.
- Protect complainants from retaliation for raising genuine concerns.
- Maintain confidentiality to the extent reasonably possible.
- Identify recurring issues and systemic weaknesses.

- Improve programme and institutional processes.
- Strengthen stakeholder confidence and accountability.

—

3. SCOPE

This policy may apply to grievances concerning:

- NCIE programmes
- Registration and applications
- Programme fees
- Attendance
- Training and curriculum
- Assessments
- Certification
- Scholarships and student support
- Mentorship
- Innovation and startup programmes
- Institutional onboarding
- Partner institutions
- Programme implementation
- Staff or programme conduct
- Communication and public information
- Funding-related programme processes
- Digital platforms
- Administrative services
- Other NCIE-authorised activities

Where a matter is governed by a separate statutory or specialised mechanism, it may be referred to the appropriate authority or mechanism.

—

4. WHO MAY FILE A GRIEVANCE

The grievance mechanism may be available to:

- Students
- Trainees
- Youth participants
- Innovators

- Entrepreneurs
 - Startup founders
 - Faculty members
 - Educational institutions
 - Trainers
 - Mentors
 - Employees
 - Volunteers
 - Beneficiaries
 - Institutional partners
 - CSR partners
 - Other programme stakeholders
-

5. TYPES OF GRIEVANCES

A. Programme Grievances

Concerns relating to programme implementation, schedule, participation or delivery.

B. Registration Grievances

Issues concerning registration, application, eligibility or documentation.

C. Academic / Training Grievances

Concerns relating to training, curriculum, trainers, assessments or learning activities.

D. Certification Grievances

Issues relating to certificate eligibility, completion status or certificate issuance.

E. Financial / Fee Grievances

Concerns relating to programme fees, payments, receipts or approved financial processes.

F. Institutional Grievances

Concerns relating to institutional onboarding, programme coordination or institutional participation.

G. Staff / Conduct Grievances

Complaints concerning inappropriate conduct, professional behaviour or violation of organisational procedures.

H. Digital Platform Grievances

Issues relating to registration portals, attendance systems, certificates, login access or digital services.

I. Partnership Grievances

Concerns relating to implementation of an authorised partnership or collaboration.

J. Public Information Grievances

Concerns regarding inaccurate, outdated or misleading information published through authorised NCIE channels.

—

6. GRIEVANCE REDRESSAL PRINCIPLES

NCIE grievance handling shall be guided by:

Accessibility

Stakeholders should have a reasonably accessible mechanism for raising concerns.

Fairness

Complaints should be considered objectively.

Impartiality

Where practical, a person directly involved in the complaint should not be the sole decision-maker regarding that complaint.

Confidentiality

Information should be handled confidentially to the extent reasonably possible.

Timeliness

Grievances should be processed within appropriate timelines.

Non-Retaliation

Good-faith complainants should not face retaliation merely for raising a legitimate concern.

Evidence-Based Review

Decisions should be based on available records and relevant information.

Documentation

Important actions and decisions should be appropriately recorded.

–

7. GRIEVANCE CHANNELS

NCIE may provide one or more authorised channels, including:

- Official grievance email
- Website grievance form
- Online complaint portal
- Institutional nodal officer
- Programme coordinator
- Written complaint
- Official communication channels

The currently authorised contact details should be displayed on the official NCIE website and programme documentation.

–

8. GRIEVANCE SUBMISSION

A grievance should, where possible, contain:

- Name of complainant

- Contact details
- Programme / institution
- Nature of grievance
- Description of the issue
- Relevant date
- Supporting documents, if available
- Expected resolution, where appropriate

Anonymous complaints may be considered where the nature of the matter permits meaningful examination.

—

9. GRIEVANCE REGISTRATION

Each grievance received through an authorised channel may be assigned a unique:

Grievance Reference Number

The reference may be used for:

- Tracking
- Internal review
- Communication
- Resolution
- Closure

—

10. GRIEVANCE REDRESSAL PROCESS

The standard process shall be:

GRIEVANCE SUBMISSION

↓

ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

↓

REGISTRATION & REFERENCE NUMBER



PRELIMINARY REVIEW



ASSIGNMENT TO RESPONSIBLE FUNCTION



FACT & DOCUMENT REVIEW



STAKEHOLDER RESPONSE, WHERE REQUIRED



DECISION / CORRECTIVE ACTION



COMMUNICATION OF OUTCOME



CLOSURE



APPEAL / REVIEW, WHERE APPLICABLE



11. ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

NCIE should, where technically and operationally feasible, acknowledge receipt of a grievance and provide a reference number.

The acknowledgement may communicate:

- Receipt of grievance
- Reference number
- Expected next step
- Additional information required, if any

12. PRELIMINARY REVIEW

The grievance may initially be reviewed to determine:

- Whether it falls within NCIE's scope.
- Whether sufficient information is available.
- Whether urgent action is required.
- Whether another authority is more appropriate.
- Whether additional documents are required.

13. PRIORITY CLASSIFICATION

Grievances may be classified according to their nature and urgency.

Routine

General programme or administrative concern.

Priority

Matter requiring relatively prompt intervention.

Urgent

Matter involving significant programme disruption, safety concerns, serious misconduct or other circumstances requiring immediate attention.

The actual response period may depend on the nature and complexity of the matter.

14. INVESTIGATION / FACT-FINDING

Where necessary, NCIE may conduct an appropriate fact-finding review involving:

- Relevant records
- Programme data

- Attendance records
- Registration information
- Financial records
- Statements
- Institutional records
- Digital system records
- Other relevant evidence

The extent of review shall depend on the nature of the grievance.

—

15. RESPONSE FROM CONCERNED PARTIES

Where appropriate, the person, team, institution or function concerned may be provided an opportunity to explain or respond to the issue.

The objective is to ensure that decisions are not based solely on an unverified allegation.

—

16. GRIEVANCE DECISION

Following review, the grievance may be classified as:

Resolved

Appropriate corrective action has been completed.

Partially Resolved

Some aspects have been addressed while other actions remain.

Not Substantiated

Available evidence does not establish the complaint.

Outside Scope

The matter does not fall within the applicable NCIE mechanism.

Referred

The matter has been referred to an appropriate authority or specialised mechanism.

Rejected

The grievance may be rejected where it is clearly frivolous, abusive, repetitive without new information or otherwise unsuitable for processing, subject to appropriate review.

—

17. CORRECTIVE ACTION

Corrective measures may include:

- Correction of records
- Reprocessing of an application
- Clarification of programme information
- Attendance correction where verified
- Certificate correction
- Administrative correction
- Additional communication
- Programme process improvement
- Staff guidance or training
- Institutional coordination
- Other appropriate corrective measures

—

18. GRIEVANCE RESPONSE

The response should, where appropriate, communicate:

- Issue considered
- Findings
- Decision
- Corrective action
- Further requirements
- Appeal or review option, where available

Confidential information concerning other individuals should not be disclosed.

19. TARGET REDRESSAL TIMELINES

NCIE may establish indicative internal timelines such as:

Stage	Indicative Timeline
Acknowledge ment	2–3 working days
Preliminary review	Up to 7 working days
Standard resolution	15–30 working days
Complex matter	Additional time where necessary
Appeal / review	As specified in the applicable mechanism

These are **indicative administrative targets**, not statutory deadlines, unless a specific law, agreement or programme guideline provides otherwise.

Where additional time is required, the complainant may be informed appropriately.

20. APPEAL / REVIEW MECHANISM

Where a complainant is dissatisfied with the outcome, an appeal or review may be submitted where such mechanism is available.

The appeal should normally identify:

- Original grievance reference
- Original decision
- Grounds for review
- Additional evidence, if available

An appeal should preferably be reviewed by an appropriate authority not

directly responsible for the original decision, where practical.

–

21. ESCALATION FRAMEWORK

The escalation pathway may be:

PROGRAMME COORDINATOR

↓

PROGRAMME / FUNCTION HEAD

↓

GRIEVANCE REDRESSAL OFFICER / DESIGNATED AUTHORITY

↓

AUTHORISED SENIOR MANAGEMENT

↓

EXTERNAL / COMPETENT AUTHORITY WHERE REQUIRED

The exact structure may vary depending on the nature of the grievance.

–

22. SPECIALISED GRIEVANCES

Certain matters may require separate handling under applicable laws or specialised institutional mechanisms.

Examples may include:

- Workplace-related statutory matters
- Sexual harassment complaints
- Child safeguarding concerns
- Financial fraud allegations
- Criminal allegations
- Data-protection matters

- Serious safety concerns

Such matters should be referred to the appropriate legally competent or specialised mechanism rather than being treated as ordinary programme complaints.

–

23. NON-RETALIATION

NCIE should seek to protect individuals who raise genuine concerns in good faith.

Retaliation, intimidation or adverse action solely because a person submitted a legitimate grievance should not be permitted.

This protection does not prevent appropriate action where a complaint is deliberately fabricated, malicious or submitted in bad faith.

–

24. CONFIDENTIALITY

Information concerning a grievance should be shared only with persons who reasonably require access for:

- Review
- Investigation
- Decision-making
- Legal or compliance purposes
- Resolution

Confidentiality shall be maintained subject to applicable law and legitimate disclosure requirements.

–

25. DATA PROTECTION

Grievance records may contain personal or sensitive information.

NCIE should implement appropriate controls concerning:

- Access
- Storage
- Confidentiality
- Data sharing
- Retention
- Secure disposal

Personal information should not be publicly disclosed unnecessarily.

—

26. FALSE OR MALICIOUS COMPLAINTS

NCIE may take appropriate action where there is credible evidence that a complaint was intentionally fabricated or submitted maliciously.

However, a grievance should not be treated as malicious merely because:

- It is not substantiated.
- The complainant is mistaken.
- The complainant disagrees with a decision.

Good-faith complaints should be treated fairly even when they are ultimately not established.

—

27. REPEATED GRIEVANCES

Repeated complaints concerning the same matter may be consolidated where appropriate.

However, a new grievance should be considered where:

- New evidence is presented.
- Circumstances have materially changed.
- A previous resolution has not been implemented.

—

28. GRIEVANCE MIS

NCIE may maintain a digital grievance management system containing:

- Reference number
- Date received
- Category
- Programme
- Institution
- Responsible function
- Status
- Actions taken
- Resolution
- Closure date
- Appeal status

Access should be restricted to authorised personnel.

—

29. GRIEVANCE STATUS

The system may use the following status categories:

RECEIVED

↓

ACKNOWLEDGED

↓

UNDER REVIEW

↓

INFORMATION REQUESTED

↓

UNDER INVESTIGATION

↓

ACTION REQUIRED

↓

RESOLVED



CLOSED



APPEAL / REVIEW



30. GRIEVANCE PERFORMANCE INDICATORS

NCIE may monitor:

- Number of grievances received
- Number acknowledged
- Number resolved
- Resolution rate
- Average resolution time
- Pending grievances
- Escalated grievances
- Appeals received
- Appeals resolved
- Recurring grievances
- Corrective actions implemented
- Stakeholder satisfaction



31. ROOT-CAUSE ANALYSIS

Recurring or significant grievances may be analysed to identify underlying causes.

GRIEVANCE



ROOT-CAUSE IDENTIFICATION



PROCESS GAP



CORRECTIVE ACTION



SYSTEM IMPROVEMENT

This ensures that grievance management contributes to continuous organisational improvement.



32. STAKEHOLDER FEEDBACK

Grievance trends and stakeholder feedback may be incorporated into:

- Programme redesign
- Curriculum improvement
- Staff training
- Digital platform improvement
- Institutional coordination
- Communication improvement
- Policy revision



33. PUBLIC GRIEVANCE INFORMATION

The NCIE website may publish:

- Grievance submission process
- Official grievance contact
- General categories of grievances
- Expected response process
- Escalation mechanism
- Relevant policy
- Frequently asked questions

Individual grievance details should remain confidential unless disclosure is legally required or appropriately authorised.



34. ANNUAL GRIEVANCE REVIEW

NCIE may periodically review:

- Total grievances
- Category-wise grievances
- Resolution performance
- Recurring issues
- Response timelines
- Appeals
- Corrective actions
- Process improvements

A summary of grievance performance may be incorporated into an annual institutional or transparency report where appropriate.

—

35. GOVERNANCE RESPONSIBILITY

The grievance mechanism may operate through:

NCIE GOVERNANCE / AUTHORISED MANAGEMENT

↓

DESIGNATED GRIEVANCE AUTHORITY

↓

PROGRAMME / FUNCTION HEADS

↓

INSTITUTIONAL NODAL PERSONS

↓

PROGRAMME TEAMS

The responsibilities of each function should be formally assigned according to organisational requirements.

—

36. RESPONSIBILITIES OF THE DESIGNATED GRIEVANCE AUTHORITY

The designated authority may be responsible for:

- Receiving or overseeing grievances.
- Maintaining grievance records.
- Assigning complaints.
- Monitoring timelines.
- Coordinating investigations.
- Communicating decisions.
- Monitoring corrective actions.
- Maintaining confidentiality.
- Preparing grievance reports.
- Identifying systemic issues.

—

37. RESPONSIBILITIES OF PROGRAMME TEAMS

Programme teams should:

- Respond to assigned grievances.
- Provide relevant records.
- Cooperate with fact-finding.
- Implement approved corrective actions.
- Maintain accurate programme documentation.
- Prevent recurrence of identified process failures.

—

38. GRIEVANCE REDRESSAL FLOW

STAKEHOLDER

↓

GRIEVANCE SUBMISSION

↓

REFERENCE NUMBER

**PRELIMINARY ASSESSMENT****FACT VERIFICATION****DECISION****CORRECTIVE ACTION****STAKEHOLDER RESPONSE****CLOSURE / APPEAL****39. INTEGRATION WITH NCIE TRANSPARENCY POLICY**

The Grievance Redressal Policy complements the **NCIE Transparency & Public Disclosure Policy** by providing a mechanism through which stakeholders can report:

- Incorrect public information
- Programme communication concerns
- Partnership representation concerns
- Funding communication concerns
- Administrative issues
- Other legitimate institutional concerns

Verified corrections may be reflected in public information where appropriate.



40. INTEGRATION WITH MONITORING & EVALUATION

Grievance information may form part of NCIE's broader **Monitoring & Evaluation Framework**.

Grievance trends can provide evidence for:

- Programme quality assessment
- Service improvement
- Institutional performance
- Risk identification
- Process redesign
- Beneficiary satisfaction

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41. INTEGRATION WITH GOVERNANCE & COMPLIANCE

The grievance mechanism forms part of NCIE's broader governance system alongside:

- Transparency
- Accountability
- Financial controls
- Programme monitoring
- Risk management
- Internal review
- Compliance
- Data protection

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42. GRIEVANCE RECORD RETENTION

Grievance records should be retained for an appropriate period based on:

- Applicable legal requirements
- Programme requirements
- Funding agreements
- Organisational policies
- Nature of the grievance

Records should be securely maintained and accessible only to authorised

personnel.

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43. POLICY REVIEW

This policy should be reviewed periodically to consider:

- Changes in applicable law
- Regulatory developments
- Organisational changes
- Programme expansion
- Stakeholder feedback
- Grievance trends
- Lessons learned

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44. POLICY COMMITMENT

NCIE is committed to providing a fair, accessible, transparent and accountable grievance redressal mechanism through which stakeholders can raise legitimate concerns relating to programmes, services, institutional activities and authorised operations.

NCIE shall seek to acknowledge, examine and resolve grievances in a timely and impartial manner while maintaining appropriate confidentiality and protecting personal information.

The grievance mechanism is intended not only to resolve individual concerns but also to identify recurring issues, strengthen institutional processes and continuously improve the quality and effectiveness of NCIE programmes.

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45. OVERALL GRIEVANCE REDRESSAL MODEL

LISTEN → REGISTER → REVIEW → VERIFY → RESOLVE → RESPOND → IMPROVE

NCIE's grievance redressal system is intended to strengthen stakeholder confidence, institutional accountability and continuous improvement by ensuring that legitimate concerns are appropriately received, examined, documented and addressed through a structured process.